

TEACHING THE MULTIPARAGRAPH ESSAY:
**Analytical Response to Literature
Paragraph and Essay**



FOURTH EDITION

Composition Guide
GRADES 6-12

Analytical Response to Literature

FOURTH EDITION

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To Noah and Sam

Your grandmother created a portal in which teachers of writing entered. We learned from her how to help our students express their thoughts successfully through the written word. Her tireless efforts made us better teachers, better people. She reminded us -- with her words, her wit, and her wisdom -- why we had chosen this honorable and thrilling profession.

We are forever indebted to her.

Jane's #1 Non-Negotiable: All Students Can Think; All Students Can Write.



LITERARY

CONCRETE DETAIL (1)

Most Often Comes from Your
Reading, Observation,
Experience

What happened?

facts

examples

support

quotations

citations

paraphrase

illustrations

evidence

plot summary

plot references

What happens in the story?

"play-by-play announcer"

COMMENTARY (2+)

Comes from Your Head

The "so what"

The "spin"

analysis

significance

importance

implications

interpretation

feelings

inference

insight

reasons

human nature

universal truth

theme

The "why"

"color commentator"

"All Students Can Think; All Students Can Write."

Jane Schaffer, Founder, All-Student-Can-Write, Inc.



Jane Schaffer's ALL-STUDENT-CAN-WRITE PROGRAM

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Preface

How Does This Fourth Edition Differ from the Third?

Jane Schaffer Writing Program® (“JSWP”) thanks you for purchasing *Teaching the Multiparagraph Essay: Response to Literature*. In writing this fourth edition of the guide, originally entitled *Teaching the Multiparagraph Essay: a Sequential Nine-Week Unit*, we made several decisions that differentiate this edition from the third edition:

- **We focused on one genre only: response to literature writing.**

It may be called *the literary analysis paper* or *the literature essay*. It is the backbone of writing in the English Language Arts (ELA) classroom. Argumentation, Expository/Informational, Narrative, and Style Analysis are sold separately.

- **We developed curriculum materials for both middle school/junior high and high school students.**

Many teachers have asked us to address middle school/ junior high students, so we have included a number of sections that do so. Our readers will see that the middle school content is quite similar to that of the high school sections, but the pacing is slower and the scaffolding more frequent. Middle schoolers especially benefit from many of the new steps because they are just beginning to see themselves as analytical thinkers.

- **We aligned with the Common Core State Standards and the Texas Essential Knowledge and Skills.**
- **We increased the scaffolding for everyone, especially special education students and English Language Learners (ELL).**

Scaffolding is one of the most important concepts to consider in lesson plan and unit plan design. What we may see as the first step is often, for our students, step #3 or #7 or #11. Scaffolding includes new prewriting strategies, Web-off-the-Word™, and color-coding.

- **We integrated technology.**
 - Electronic graphic organizers are available with orders and are in the process of becoming apps for tablets and smart phones.
 - Our trainers made a series of videotapes for English I, II, and III
 - Online courses are in the works.
 - Clients may now request webinars.

The Formula Issue

We would like to comment on the formulaic nature that underlies the Jane Schaffer Writing Program®. Our philosophy is guided by three beliefs, and these beliefs have become Jane's #2 Non-Negotiable:

- 1) **Formula is a place to start for students who need it.**
- 2) **Some students don't need it at all, not even for a minute. If teachers take those writers backward into a formula, they are violating the integrity of the Jane Schaffer Writing Program® in particular and the writing process in general.**
- 3) **Our goal is for all students to leave the structure as soon as they are ready.**

Rationale

1. **Formula is a place to start for students who need it.**

Just as novice cooks need a recipe or beginning riders need training wheels, some students benefit from having a layout to follow until they master the basics of paragraphs and essays. It is one more example of scaffolding.

Some say that the program stifles creativity. A music teacher reminded us, however, that musicians don't play jazz unless they know scales and arpeggios. In a discussion with a class, a former student said that even Picasso knew representational figures before he moved into abstract art.

2. **Some students don't need it at all, not even for a minute. If teachers take those writers backward into a formula, they are violating the integrity of the Jane Schaffer Writing Program in particular and the writing process in general.**

With naturally gifted writers or those who come to us well-trained in composition, we just label what they're doing already, clarify the ratio for them, and set them free. We identify these students on the first day's diagnostic sample.

3. **Our goal is for all students to leave the structure when they are ready.**

The formula doesn't bother us because, unlike other formulaic approaches, we want and expect students to leave it after they have mastered it. We do not hold students to the formula once they are ready to make the leap out of it. Some students ask about leaving it behind in the first week; others hold onto it throughout high school as a guideline to make sure they don't go off-track. You, the teacher, the expert, however, must not make the same mistakes others have made by putting your students in a box and making them stay there.

The most noticeable change when students leave the formula occurs in what students call *weaving* – mixing concrete detail and commentary thoughts in the same sentence. The structure is a means to an end, not the end in itself. Our end is and always will be the same: a process-driven, product-oriented piece of writing that makes sense to the reader.

The following scoring guide is repeated in the “Teacher’s Toolbox” handouts in full size. It has been placed here, however, following the “formula issue,” as a reminder to teachers to move students beyond the formula as soon as the latter are able to discern, truly discern CD and CM. See how the “A” and “B” scores no longer refer to the ratio, word counts, CDs, CMs, or format.

TEACHING THE MULTIPARAGRAPH ESSAY

ESSAY SCORING GUIDE

A Excellent

- ☐ Excellent concrete detail; correct and skillful use of transitions and lead- ins
- ☐ Insightful commentary
- ☐ Finds connections
- ☐ Organization is clear and logical
- ☐ Very few, if any, mechanical errors
- ☐ Powerful vocabulary
- ☐ Excellent sentence variety
- ☐ Repeats little or not at all

B Good

- ☐ Good concrete detail; correct use of transitions and lead- ins.
- ☐ Good commentary but less so than an “A”
- ☐ Organization is clear but not as skillfully done as the “A” papers
- ☐ Some mechanical errors may be present, more than the “A” papers
- ☐ Good vocabulary
- ☐ Above- average sentence variety
- ☐ Repeats more than the “A” paper but less than the “C” paper

C Adequate

- ☐ Follows format (ratio; word counts; sentence layout, if required)
- ☐ Acceptable CD; generic CD
- ☐ Obvious, superficial, irrelevant, or generic commentary (GC)
- ☐ Organization is present but less skillfully done than the “B” papers
- ☐ Some mechanical errors present , more than a B paper
- ☐ Average vocabulary or odd word choice
- ☐ Limited sentence variety
- ☐ Repeats are a problem

D Demonstrates Problems

- ☐ Too many mechanical errors (run- ons, fragments, spelling, contractions, apostrophes)
- ☐ Did not copy correctly from the story or the board
- ☐ Uses past tense instead of literary present tense (LP)
- ☐ Does not follow the format (ratio; word counts; sentence layout)
- ☐ CD problems: weak CD (WCD); factual errors; problems with MLA citation format; problems with TLCD; no lead- in; weak lead- in.
- ☐ CM problems: weak CM (WCM); not commentary (NCM); mainly plot summary or restatement of CD; CM doesn’t fit the CD, generic CM.
- ☐ Chunk doesn’t fit TS (not coherent).
- ☐ Filler
- ☐ Organization is unclear.
- ☐ Simple vocabulary and word choice (WC), odd word choice; slang (SL); wrong word (WW); odd phrasing
- ☐ Little sentence variety
- ☐ Repeats are a bigger problem than with the “C” paper
- ☐ Uses no- no words, including *you, your, yours, would, should, could, may, might; I, me, my* in a literature paper

F Fails to meet standards

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

The posthumous publication of the fourth edition could not have occurred without Jane Schaffer's family: Dr. Daniel Schaffer and Ms. Sarah Schaffer Cooper. Thank you, Dan and Sarah, for trusting me to continue Jane's legacy by presenting Jane's 4th edition, in publications, in workshops, and most of all, in the spirit in which she shared her knowledge with teachers.

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Thank you to Ms. Lauren Roedy-Vaughn and Mr. Robert J. Nicholson, both of whom were trained by Jane Schaffer and who became part of her team of national trainers. They have been available at all hours and have always kept Jane's first non-negotiable in mind when answering my questions. To the distinguished Jane Schaffer® presenters since 2007 who have piloted parts of the fourth edition in workshops, thank you for your support and encouragement, especially Jackie Arnold, Karen Buxton, Ellen Gilmore, Skip Nicholson, Barbara Ostarch, and Marcia Tomlin.

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Jane and I thank and acknowledge the following people for allowing the Jane Schaffer Writing Program® to include excerpts of their works:

"Both Sides of the Fence" by Teresa Bateman

"The Confrontation" from *The Plum Plum Pickers* by Raymond Barrio

"Priscilla and the Wimps" from *Sixteen* by Richard Peck

"To Sleep under the Stars" by Carol Shaw Graham

"A White Heron" by Sarah Orne Jewett from *The Country of the Pointed Firs and Other Stories*

**Most of all, a heartfelt thanks to the thousands of teachers
who believe in their students' ability, understand Jane's philosophy of writing,
and implement the Jane Schaffer Writing Program® in their classrooms.**

The Jane Schaffer Writing Program®	Common Core State Standards (CCSS.ELA-Literacy) Grades 6-12				
	College and Career Readiness Anchor (CCRA) Standards for Reading (R) and for Writing (W)	Reading Literature (RL); Reading Informational Text (RI)	Writing (W)	Speaking & Listening (SL) (Class Discussions, Teacher Conferences, and Peer Review)	Language (L)
Teaching Argumentation	W1,4-10; L1-6; R1-6,8; SL3;	RL1; RI 1-10	W1a-e, W4-10; RH1,3,6,7,9; WHST1, 4-10	SL1A-D,SL3,4,6	L1-6
Teaching Expository/Informational Writing, including Expository, Summary, Research	R1-4; W2,4-10; L1-6	RL1,2; RI 1-10	W2a-f*; W4-9b, W10; RH1,2,7; RST1,2,4-6, 8,9; WHST2,4-10	SL1A-D, SL3,4,6	L1-6
Teaching the Analytical Response to Literature Paragraph and Essay	R1-7,9; W2;4-10; L1-6	RL1-7,9	W2a-f*, W4-9a, W10	SL1A-D, SL3,4,6	L1-6
Teaching the Narrative Essay, Personal and Fictional	R2-3;W3,4-10; L1-6		W3a-e	SL1A-D, SL3,5,6	L1-6
Teaching Pre-AP® and Advanced Placement® (AP®) English Writing: Style Analysis and Argumentation	W1,2,4-10; R1-10; SL3; L1-6	RL1-7,9; RI1-10	W1a-e, W2a-f*, W4-10; RH1-9; WHST 1, 2, 4-10	SL1A-D, SL3, 4,6	L1-6
All – Interactive Graphic Organizers	W6	RL1-7,9; RI1-10	W1-10; RH1-9; RST1,2,4-6, 8,9; WHST1,2,4-10		L1-6

*In 1984, Jane Schaffer® coined the writing term “concrete details,” now being used in CCSS W2b.

Texas Essential Knowledge and Skills (TEKS)											
The Jane Schaffer Writing Program®	K-2	3	4 Tested	5	6	7 Tested	8	English I Tested	English II Tested	English III	English IV
		17A-E; 21	15A-E; 19; 20; 21; 22	15A-E; 19; 20; 21; 22	14A-E; 18; 19; 20; 21	14A-E; 18; 19; 20; 21	14A-E; 18; 19; 20; 21	14A-E; 18; 19; 20; 21	1B, E; 9A; 13A-E; 16A-F; 17; 18; 19	1B, C, E; 9A,-D; 13A-E; 16A-E; 17; 18; 19; 23A-E	1B, C, E; 9A-D; 13A-E; 16A-G; 17; 18; 19; 23A-E
	K - 13A, B; 1 st and 2 nd – 17A-D; 18A	17A-E; 18A; 19; 23;24	15A-E; 16A; 17; 20; 21; 22	15A-E; 16A; 17; 20; 21; 22	14A-E; 15A; 16; 19; 20; 21	14A-E; 15A; 16; 19; 20; 21	14A-E; 15A; 16; 19; 20; 21	14A-E; 15A; 16; 19; 20; 21	1B, E; 13A-E; 14A; 17; 18; 19	1B, C, E; 13A-E; 14A; 17; 18; 19	1B, C, E; 15B; 13A-E; 14A; 17; 18; 19
	Teaching Expository/Informational Writing, including Summary, Research	17A-E; 20A,C; 23;24	15A-E; 18A,C; 20; 21; 22	15A-E; 18A, C; 20; 21; 22; 26B, C, D	14A-E; 17A, C; 19; 20; 21; 25B, C, D	14A-E; 17A, B, C; 19; 20; 21; 25A-D	14A-E; 17A, C; 19; 20; 21; 22B; 25	14A-E; 17A, C; 19; 20; 21; 22B; 25	1B, E; 9A; 13A-E; 15A, Ci, ii; 17; 18; 19; 23 A, B, E	1B, C, E; 9A; 13A-E; 15A, C; 17; 18; 19	1B, C, E; 9A; 13A-E; 15A, Ci-v; 17; 18; 19
	Teaching the Analytical Response to Literature Paragraph and Essay	17A-E; 20C; 23;24	15A-E; 18C; 20; 21; 22	15A-E; 18A, C; 20; 21; 22	14A-E; 17A, C; 19; 20; 21	14A-E; 17A, C; 19; 20; 21	14A-E; 17A, C; 19; 20; 21	14A-E; 17A, C; 19; 20; 21	1B, E; 9A; 13A-E; 15A, Ci-iii; 17; 18; 19; 23A, B, E	1B, C, E; 9A; 13A-E; 15A, C; 17; 18; 19	1B, C, E; 9A; 13A-E; 15A, Ci-v; 17; 18; 19; 23A-E
	Teaching Pre-AP® and Advanced Placement® (AP®) English Writing: Style and Rhetorical Analysis; Argumentation/Synthesis						14A-E; 17A, C; 19; 20; 21	14A-E; 17A, C; 22B; 25	1B, E; 9B; 13A-E; 15A, Ci-iii; 17; 18; 19; 23A-E	1B, C, E; 9A-D; 13A-E; 15A, Ci-iii; 17; 18; 19; 23A-E	1B, C, E; 9A-D; 13A-E; 15A, Ci-v; 17; 18; 19; 23A-E
STAAR®			26-line Narrative Essay Workshop			26-line Narrative and Expository Essays Workshop		Short Answer and 26-line Expository Essay Workshop	Short Answer and 26-line Persuasive Essay Workshop		

Introduction

Overview

Jane Schaffer earned her degree in French and English at UCLA in 1968 and her secondary teaching credential from San Diego State College in 1969 and started teaching English, French, and Latin later that year. Since then, her quest has always been to find a way to teach all students how to write. She developed her writing program for students at all levels from special education and English Language Learners (ELL) through honors, Pre-AP®, and Advanced Placement® (AP®).

She taught at Santana High School in Santee, California, for eighteen years. In 1987, she and a colleague helped to open West Hills High School in Santee, a new school in the same district.

They had the opportunity to teach paragraph and essay writing to freshmen rather than to juniors and seniors as had been done at her previous school. The program led their students at all grade levels to the #1 spot (of ten comprehensive high schools) on the annual district writing assessment, a place held for many years.

The inspiration for this guide springs from Schaffer's own experiences as a student in school. Like many teachers, she didn't learn how to write in high school and did poorly as a college freshman. Her college professors made comments such as "It's obvious you can't write." She met many teachers who were treated similarly. To borrow from William Faulkner, they all not only endured; they prevailed.

Ever since, we wanted to spare our students the same embarrassment and humiliation that we felt when our essays earned Ds and Fs. The goal of this guide is to demystify the blank page and enable every student to master the elements of composition. Students often think that writing is a mystery, and only the teacher has the solution. It isn't a secret; it's just hard work. Teaching writing is teaching thinking. Our goal is to break the process into digestible steps that all students can follow.

Over the years, we have conducted many workshops in many states and countries to share our writing program, and we continue to do so. In 1984, we started offering workshops in Advanced Placement Literature and Composition in San Diego and have branched out since then to include Program Improvement districts, schools with 900 API, and grades ranging from kindergarten to college. Currently, we employ national trainers who conduct our workshops.

In all our workshops and in this guide, we strive to give the *why* as well as the *how*. This guide represents three days of response to literature training.

The Early Years

As young teachers in the early 1970s, we adopted a structured approach to writing because we were desperate. Our students' writing was chaotic. It had no sense of beginning, middle, or end,

with no order to the thoughts and no higher-order thinking at all. It was filled with what we call *concrete detail* -- *who, what, when, where*, but no *how* or *why*. Students simply grabbed sentences out of the air and wrote just enough to fill the page.

For several years, we used the ideas in *Power Writing* by J. E. Sparks, professor at the University of Southern California. He developed a numbered paragraph structure guided by a main idea supported with details. We liked the increased organization in students' writing but thought the paragraphs were missing something. They lacked a "so what?" That "so what?" turned out to be a concept called *commentary*.

How Commentary Began

The missing piece, the "so what?", was born one day during a one-to-one conference with a gifted junior. He was writing an essay in 1975 about how Lake Erie had changed since he had been a young boy living there. He brought his prewriting to the teacher at her desk. The teacher looked over the list of concrete details and told the boy to analyze his examples — pollution, dead fish, oil slicks on the beach, the fire when the Cuyahoga River burned. The teacher said, "These look good – now go analyze them."

The boy said, "I have no idea what you teachers mean by *analyze*." This was a reasonable statement; he wanted to do the assignment but didn't know how to begin or what it should look like when he was finished. Then the teacher asked him to say how the experience had changed or affected him. He thought for a few seconds and said, "I realized my past was lost. The cherished days of my childhood were ruined. The halcyon days were behind me." The boy really said "halcyon." Schaffer was speechless that a student knew the word and used it correctly.

The teacher said, "You did it — what you said to me was analysis. And we're going to call it *commentary* because you *commented* to me about your details." It's a far more user-friendly word for teenagers than *analysis* and *interpretation*. That day began a department conversation about what it means to analyze a topic and how to lead teenagers away from plot summary — the bane of English teachers' existence — and toward deeper thought. Most teachers don't remember how they learned to write. They often taught themselves and alone made the leap from plot summary to analysis. Some know a certain person who helped them, but most of us have no memory of the moment. We just did it.

That student's reactions made us realize two points:

- 1) Talking is the missing link in thinking. Students can say what they are thinking but need help getting it down on paper.
- 2) We assumed far too much about both content and mechanics, and that has rung true ever since. We thought students knew about topic sentences and indentations and analysis, but we were wrong on every count. We like to think we've made unwarranted assumptions less frequently since then.

Jane's #3 Non-Negotiable: The Consistency of a Departmental Program Outweighs Individual Teacher Preference. Everyone Abides by Majority Vote.

As beginning teachers, we saw the lack of consistency within our English departments. One person required outside reading; another didn't. One taught a great deal of writing; another taught speeches; another focused only on the research paper. That was in 1969, but things haven't changed much. As one principal observed, "Everyone does his/her own thing with writing."

But we have seen what happens when consistency is achieved, and we cannot recommend it enough. Both students and teachers reap the benefits. The department doesn't have to agree to all of the shared agreements that we've included below, but it does have to agree to be consistent.

Following are some examples of consistency adopted by a variety of departments. No one department chose all of them. They are all phrased in terms of behavior, of what the group agrees to implement. The list is provided to begin a conversation:

We will all...

- teach writing, not just assign it.
- use a common terminology for the paragraph and essay.
- use the writing process that includes the agreed-upon steps. All of these steps are required unless the teacher indicates otherwise.
- require that all pieces involved in the assignment are turned in with the final draft.
- use a cover sheet, scoring guide, and grading codes list.
- schedule regular meetings to examine and discuss student work.
- use color coding in beginning direct instruction and continue using it with individual students, as appropriate.
- develop and use a department-wide scoring guide for all major writing assignments.
- see students in one-to-one conferencing.
- institute multiyear, cumulative writing folders for each student that we pass on to the next teacher each fall.
- write with each other and with our students.
- do most, if not all, of the writing in class, not as homework, for as long as students need it.

To Establish Consistency

First, the department has to agree to operate by majority vote, and that means having an initial vote to function by that agreement. Consistency of the program outweighs individual teacher preference. It's better for kids.

We realize that this approach is revolutionary in a field where the maverick mentality can hold sway. But we've observed what happens when consistency is in place: students learn better. When a teacher told her sophomore class that she would be using the same essay terminology as the ninth-grade teachers had used, one girl said, "You mean I don't have to

un-learn and re-learn and un-learn and re-learn with each one of you?” Her obvious sense of relief was overwhelming.

This agreement includes the idea that all members will abide by majority vote. Teachers don’t get to “do their own thing.” If they are in the minority, they are expected to abide by majority vote and adjust to the decisions of the group as a whole.

Part of being consistent is abiding by **Jane’s #6 Non-Negotiable: Sharing of ideas and student work is essential.**

Teachers need to discuss what they are doing in their classes for feedback and suggestions. Ultimately, though, monitoring can become an administrator responsibility beyond the realm of the department head and colleagues.

Second, the group can discuss which policies are to be adopted and publicized to department members, administrators, students, and parents. If they aren’t publicized, they won’t be implemented as they should.

- Adaptations for Special Education/ELL Students

We make one exception: we do narrative writing with ELL students until their academic English is broad enough to do response to literature writing.

- Adaptations for Advanced Placement® Students

While the AP® students benefit greatly from the program, the teachers of AP students must present the language of the test so that students won’t be surprised on exam day. Therefore, some of the terminology might be different for those courses. In addition, whereas a department might ask for process papers, AP classes need to practice timed writings. In the Lang and Comp course, nonfiction rules; so, departmental policies regarding modes might need to be altered while at the same time keeping vertical alignment and scaffolding in mind. These are just a few discussion points that a department might address as they differentiate for their students and the curricula.

The Place of Writing in the Curriculum

People have discussed the pressures we all share about covering the curriculum. Our answer: treat the writing part of the curriculum as center stage, and all of the ELA standards across the county will fall under that umbrella. If writing doesn’t get the attention and time it needs, it will never be taught well.

Too often, writing is assigned as homework instead of classwork, and then teachers complain that students can’t write. One problem we face as teachers is that our students don’t do much homework. We can’t remember a time that an entire AP® class turned in a homework assignment. We don’t think it’s malicious; students just don’t think of school much after 3:00 (or earlier). If teachers assign writing as homework, odds are that it won’t be done correctly or done at all (of course, we know those students who always do their work, and we are so

proud of them and the work ethic they have been taught by their parents and teachers). However, when students don't do homework, chaos can follow. If a teacher assigns a reading assignment for homework, and the next day's lesson plan is built on that reading, what are we to do when $\frac{3}{4}$ of the class hasn't done it?

We believe wholeheartedly that students will never learn to write if it is always assigned as homework. In class, students need us to monitor their work carefully, over their shoulders, in one-to-one conferences, at the moment of writing, and teach and re-teach constantly. Furthermore, unfortunately, students plagiarize from the internet, from their friends, and from their parents.

We do allow students to write at home as they become more skilled and trustworthy. Some pieces of the process work well as homework, such as the pre-writing steps. We have devised writing-based practices for homework and have made them as uncheatable as we can. If they are working at a computer, we require all work to be printed before each day and brought to class. If students don't do this, they forfeit the privilege of writing at home. We do not allow students to e-mail their work or bring a flashdrive to school for us to print their work. If they submit it electronically, it's the final draft that will be placed in their electronic portfolio.

There is an exception: some teachers like to use the "Tracking Changes" function from Microsoft® Office® Word®. In that case, the students e-mail their draft, and the teacher makes comments and suggests changes. Once s/he has done that, the document is saved as a .pdf so there exists substantive proof of the resulting grade. The teacher e-mails the original document and the .pdf so that 1) the student can make the suggested revisions, and 2) the student will have the scored essay. The teacher maintains the scored document in an electronic folder.

When teachers allow typed final drafts,

- some have the students do the final in handwriting in class and then send it home for typing and MLA formatting. The two drafts have to match. If students have "lost" their handwritten draft, they have to start over on a new topic. We alert them to the consequences beforehand, so this problem hasn't happened to us yet. Students don't want to take that risk;
- in other cases, schools purchase plagiarism detection software, such as turnitin.com. They check their students' original work through this method; and
- with our new interactive graphic organizers, students may copy and paste from their prewriting into a final draft.

Different teachers have different policies. You're the expert and know your students. Do what's best for the students – Writing is Thinking.

The Training Unit

The training unit describes the weeks of direct instruction that take place when students learn the program for the first time. There are two sample timelines here, one for 9th grade general classes (also called *on-level*, *regular*, *standard*, and *general*, to name a few) and another for the same level of middle schoolers. These pacing guides are too fast for special education and English Language Learners (ELL) and too slow for honors, gifted, and advanced, Pre-AP® and AP® classes. To model the adaptations for these two different levels, we have annotated each day to illustrate the differences. See Addendum A.

In addition to these two other timelines, we have also posted others on our website for you to download. They include samples for block schedule (rotating, 3x3, 4x4, accelerated, and Copernican); one for older students (11th-12th grades); one for special education/ELL students; and one for gifted/honors classes. The content is the same; the difference is pacing and scaffolding. Honors students, for example, don't need us to play the Gary Sinise audiotape of *Of Mice and Men* and tend more often to do their homework. Those classes can move more quickly than others that need frequent in-class modeling and more detailed monitoring.

The timing may strike teachers as slower than they have done in the past. After observing teachers over the years in all subjects, not just English, we have come to this realization: **We teach too fast.** We don't give students enough rehearsal or reinforcement time. We don't provide enough practice because we know it so well. We forget that students need an average of seven (7) cycles to lay down new information.

Overview

Our timelines are based on a time lasting forty-five or fifty minutes. For each day, there are accompanying lesson plans with five sections: Overview, Rationale, Goals, Materials and Activities, and Assessment. Teachers may use our literature selections or those in the textbook. Please check our website to download teacher models for these and other short stories, and feel free to recommend stories for us to develop into step-by-step models.

People have asked us whether or not the training unit is successful if they don't work on it every day. Some teachers, for example, like to do vocabulary on Mondays, grammar on Tuesdays, and so on. Our answer is -- students lose learning overnight, and to fragment the instruction only increases that loss and slows instruction down. That being said, some students, such as honors, Pre-AP®, and AP®, can sustain lengthy periods of writing instructions; others need a break in the action. You know your students and their learning styles. Our bottom line: we recommend that students write every day, even if for only ten to fifteen minutes. We see writing as center stage, one that includes all the ELA standards across the country (word choice, academic vocabulary, grammar, and sentence variety, for example).

Diagnostic Writing Assignment

We give a diagnostic writing assignment to every student every year. The diagnostic piece goes into the writer folder. It serves as a pre-test. During the year, we give formative

assessments and follow with a summative post-test for comparison at the end of the year. Here is a typical prompt for a regular or on-level class:

From a book you've ever read or a movie or television show you've ever watched, think of a character that makes a decision. You have until the bell to write the best essay you can, discussing the consequences of the decision for the character and anyone else in the story.

Some students say the first day that they have never read a whole book. To forestall that conversation, we decided to include television shows and movies and have yet to find a teenager who can't find someone to write about. Students receive points for completing the diagnostic assignment with the cover sheet and scoring guide (Addenda B and C, respectively). We don't grade it, although teachers may choose to. Even if students are not finished at the bell, we collect whatever they have written and give completion credit, assuming they have been working productively during the period.

The Trade-off

Some teachers have asked us about our recommendation that we spend the beginning weeks on the training unit. This is our philosophy regarding the number of days dedicated to initial direct instruction in our writing program: We are willing to trade off six weeks in ninth grade to establish the foundations of paragraph and essay writing for the rest of high school. After the training unit, we start what our students call "regular old English."

Length of the Unit

Teachers will see on the sample timeline that we have described a thirty-day unit, but we know that it usually takes us more than that to complete. Stuff happens at school. Freshmen must attend the drug assembly to see dogs sniffing marijuana through coffee grounds; counselors need to check every student's schedule and often use English classes to herd groups into the counseling office; the librarian conducts orientation during the first three weeks of school and does it through English. All of these take teaching minutes away from the English curriculum.

Timing

People have asked us about shortcuts to decrease the length of the training unit. We can only say that **teaching writing means teaching thinking**, and we have not found a short way to do that at all. It just takes time. And if we don't allow the necessary time, our students will not learn how to write.

Paragraph First, Essay Later

We used to start with the essay on the second day of school. One year, a girl said, "I've never done essays before and am going crazy learning so many new things at once. Is it possible to teach us only a few new things at first, and then some more new things later?"

In teacher talk, she was asking, "Can you teach us the paragraph first, and when we learn that, teach us the essay later?" We figured that we had nothing to lose and tried it. The girl was right. The body paragraphs do the hard work of the essay. And when students learn the

paragraph first, they only have to learn four new things later for the essay: identifying themes, writing the introduction to open the paper, the thesis to focus the entire essay with transitions, and the conclusion to close the paper. They've learned the middle already and are pleased when they realize what they've accomplished so far.

Credit for Completion for Process Work

Teachers will see that much of the work in the training unit calls for credit upon completion. Many assignments don't merit a letter grade, but if we don't assign some worth to it, students won't do it or will do a haphazard job at best. We've all had students ask, "Are you going to collect this?" We think, "Well, we hadn't planned on it, but...." What they are really asking is "Can I ignore it now and ask to do it as homework?" So we collect everything as formative assessment and hone in on a special focus for that particular assignment.

Writing in Class vs. Writing as Homework

Once the training unit is completed, we recommend that all writing be done in class for groups other than honors. This is a revolutionary idea. I know, we just had to say it one more time.

Cover Sheet

All major paragraph and essay assignments, both process and on-demand (timed writing) pieces, have a cover sheet. We issue the cover sheets the day the assignment is due. If we give them out beforehand, many students lose them.

The routine of the order is this:

- cover sheet on top
- final draft next
- all pieces of the first draft in order next
- the scoring guide next
- grading codes at the end

For students who haven't done the assignment, we give them two copies of the cover sheet to complete -- one for their writing folders and another for us to keep in case the writing folder version disappears. We had a problem with students taking the first copy as if the assignment never existed. We haven't needed to use the duplicate since then to show parents; requiring it has stopped the problem. We staple the cover sheet in front of any pieces of the process that the students may have completed and put it in the writing folder. Otherwise, the cover sheet goes into the folder by itself. Sometimes, we print a red cover sheet for incomplete work (the "Scarlet Letter" version) and blue for summer school papers.

Sometimes the reason that the student gives at the bottom is serious and needs immediate attention. One girl wrote that her father had died recently. She couldn't bring herself to say it, but the cover sheet allowed her a chance to write it to us. Most of the time, though, students say, "I forgot" or "I didn't do it."

Four Stages of Teaching

We have watched our own teacher behaviors over the last four decades, observed other teachers in grades kindergarten through college, and read teaching theory in *English Journal*, *Voices from the Middle*, and works by Nancie Atwell, Anne Berthoff, Madeline Hunter, Ken Macrorie, James Moffett, and Donald Murray. All of these sources have guided us to recognize four stages of teaching behavior. Our sample timelines indicate the appropriate stage for each day's lesson, recognizing that the stages usually overlap and need teacher direction.

#1	Model
#2	Collaborative Writing
#3	Pair/Small Group
#4	Independent

The Model (M)

We always supply a model (M) for an assignment. We learn by models; we need to know what an assignment should resemble when we submit it to our teachers. In addition, as teachers, creating models helps us to troubleshoot our prompts and allows us first-hand knowledge of what students will encounter. We know the model has done its job when a student looks at it and says, “Oh, *that's* what you meant!”

We know there are two issues regarding models: first, they take time to write; and, second, students sometimes write clones of our model. We would rather help students avoid the “clone” issue than read some of the chaotic writing we've seen in the past.

Unfortunately, most of the teachers we have observed do not offer models to their students because of the time involved. When a teacher complains about a class set of papers and we ask to see the model, we often hear that there was no model provided or prompt tested. Students need more guidance than just the prompt. We know that we pay with time before, creating the model, or time after, in correcting the inevitable mistakes. We encourage all teachers to use models and create a bank of them for use with their and their colleagues' classes. We provide models for various literary works in our workshops.

Collaborative Writing (CW)

Collaborative Writing (CW) means that we write something together as a whole class. It is one of the many scaffolding steps that we use constantly. The teacher leads the lesson, using the chalk board, an interactive white board, a document camera, tablet, or laptop (Prior to a workshop, let JSWP know what technology you use, so we can model our system using your devices.)

For most teenagers, going from the model to small-group work or, even worse, from model to independent work is far too great a leap.

We first saw CW in elementary classrooms where it is a dominant vehicle for instruction. In talking among ourselves, we discussed whether we had ever been taught Collaborative Writing as secondary teachers and realized we had not. Everyone loses. Collaborative Writing provides a mid-step that has unbelievable benefits. There is no grade at stake other than copying and annotating correctly, so students speak up who otherwise wouldn't. They feel safe. Teachers can constantly check for understanding as the class offers ideas and asks questions. We rely upon collaborative writing all year long whenever a new concept is introduced or an old concept needs revisiting.

What we can't tell others is how long or how often they will do this type of writing with their classes. We do know we use it with every new concept until we see that the class is ready to move on. We use it in revisiting an area that may be giving the class some trouble, such as making topic sentences all commentary with no concrete detail in response to literature paragraphs and essays.

Pair/Small Group (PSG)

To make PSG work, teachers must be involved. I row run constantly when doing PSG. If I try to go to my desk to work on something, I get very poor results.

Pair/Small Group work (PSG) is common in classrooms across the country. Some prefer only pairs because it ensures, mostly, that students are actively doing something productive. When a group grows to three, one student is often ignored; the problem increases with groups of four or more. We prefer pairs because we have a better chance of seeing what is called "attending behavior," students are actually participating instead of sitting back and watching.

Many of us remember being in groups in school where we, as individuals, did all the work. We wanted the "A" badly enough to carry the group along, and everyone knew this, so why should anyone else contribute? Pairs make it easier for us to monitor student behavior as well.

Sometimes we move to the PSG level and realize we moved too quickly, that the class was not ready for this mid-level of independence. Students ask more than the usual questions and seem confused. We can see it in their eyes and notice their apprehension. We return immediately to Collaborative Writing until we decide that the class is ready to try PSG again.

Independent (I)

One of the integral components that truly marks your program is that teachers must be involved at every step in the writing process. I use myself as the bad example here. Before I created Jane Schaffer®, I taught writing by giving assignments and going to my desk to do other work. I discouraged questions. My standard response was "Just keep writing."

Actually, I wasn't quite that bad, but it makes the point. Those kids who needed help didn't get it and in many cases, they just gave up.

The Jane Schaffer Writing Program® does not make teaching writing easy. I work much harder now, but I get results for all of my kids.

The Independent level (I) is the one most familiar to teachers and students. Each student does the assignment by him- or herself and turns it in for a grade.

What concerns us greatly is the speed of teachers' lessons. As one woman observed during a workshop, "We teach too fast." We've said it before and will repeat it. We are all racing to cover a scope and sequence, to prepare students for the next state test, or to get through the whole textbook. We have seen districts where the scope and sequence is beyond what the finest teachers could accomplish in one school year. But moving too quickly, moving ahead to another mode of writing before students master the current one, only compounds students' confusion. We have a new credo: Slow Down.

Where is the Jane Schaffer Writing Program Headed Now?

Since its inception, it has moved across the curriculum to include content-area paragraphs and essays and toward other genres more common to the English curriculum, such as expository, narrative, and persuasive. In student teaching, people still don't always receive instruction in ways to teach writing, so this guide continues to fill that gap. Based on the feedback we receive from our students, from other schools, from our graduates in college, and from our students in the world of work, we know we are achieving our goal. The following reveal just a few of hundreds of testimonials:

- *I am the English Department Chair for a diverse-ability, multi-ethnic high school with 1,100 students. Jane's program is the best I've seen to use with these students, because it reaches all ability levels; once they master the basics, they can go on to "weaving," as Jane calls it, and soar! But they need a format they can understand, and this works! We are implenting her program department-wide next year, after having had great results piloting it this year.*
- *As a Director of Curriculum for a large school district, I am now sold on the Schaffer model. Teachers attending the workshops have a good time, think hard, and leave with something they can use in their classroom the next day. The program has also been successful with our "Writing across the Curriculum" implementation.*
- *Each year my former high school students return from college excited that the Jane Schaffer Writing Program prepared them so well for university-level work. The multiparagraph essay unit works with all levels of students.*
- *I love you, Jane Schaffer!!!!*

On Sunday, August 22, 2010, when schools all over the nation and the world were preparing for the first day of school, we lost Jane Schaffer after her courageous battle against cancer. She was 65 years old. She left a family who loved her and teachers who remember her sense of humor and direction toward empowering us with the tools to teach writing to their students. Every August she reminds us that all students can think, and all students can write. The program continues to evolve, based on questions and suggestions from workshops, working with students, team meetings, and our own writing. It will always be process-driven but product-oriented.

JANE SCHAFFER'S NON-NEGOTIABLES

Philosophical Points

- NN#1. All students can think, and all students can write.
- NN#2. Formula/structure is a place to start for students who need it; some don't need it at all. We want students to leave the formula behind when they are ready to do so. Breaking the formula is called *weaving* - mixing fact and opinion/concrete detail and commentary.
- NN#3. Consistency of program outweighs individual teacher preference. Everyone abides by majority votes.
- NN#4. Common terminology for the paragraph and essay helps students learn.
- NN#5. Writing is a process that includes the prompt, prewriting, T-charts, webbing pages, graphic organizers/shaping sheets, drafting, revisions, and rubrics. All of these steps are required.
- NN#6. Meeting regularly to talk about student work is critical.

What We Do in Class

- NN#7. We color-code the paragraph and the essay on the overhead or a whiteboard (black, blue, red, and green pens).
- NN#8. We use a department-wide scoring guide for all writing assignments. You can Google *rubrics* and click on *Kathy Schrock* to find a wealth of information.
- NN#9. We see students in one-on-one conferencing as often as possible.
- NN#10. We have multiyear, cumulative writing folders for each student that we pass on to the next teacher each fall.
- NN#11. We write with each other and with our students (Shared Writing); "We can't teach what we don't do" (Carol Jago).

STAGES IN THE TEACHING SEQUENCE OF WRITING

Argumentation, Expository / Informational, Narrative, Response to Literature

1.	Teacher Model “Guided Writing” “I Do”	➤ Teacher gives the class a completed example--from the writing prompt to the prewriting to the shaping to the final draft. ➤ Equipment and Materials: ○ hard graphic organizers and pens for each student and teacher (students copy as teacher presents each step and the thinking behind each step) ○ hard copy of the model from start to finish for all students (give this clean copy of all steps after the students copy and submit for grade) ○ chalkboard, dry erase board, interactive whiteboard, or document camera ○ if digital, use Google Docs, JSWP App, BYOD, laptop, digital graphic organizers ➤ Assessment: Credit is given for copying precisely the model either on paper or digitally; ▪ on-task behavior, focus ▪ asking questions, clarification ▪ color-coding correctly ▪ correct grammar, mechanics, usage
2.	Class Collaborative “Shared Writing” “We Do”	➤ The teacher and the students write collaboratively in class. ➤ The teacher guides a thoughtful and multimedia discussion. Shared resources. ➤ Everyone is writing on the same, specific topic. Mutual goal. ➤ Equipment and Materials: see above (no model; hard copies or digital graphic organizers) ➤ Assessment ○ Everyone offers two comments for each part of the process through the final draft. ○ Teacher frequently assesses individuals and group (definitions, colors, purpose) ○ Group processing after each step in the process: “reflecting on the group’s work to clarify and improve the effectiveness of the members in working together to achieve the group’s goals by (a) describing what member actions were helpful and unhelpful and (b) making decisions about what actions to continue or change” (Johnson, et.al). ○ Everyone submits entire process (after each step).
3.	Small Group “Shared Writing” “You Do Together”	➤ Students write in pairs. Use same materials as “We Do.” Analog* only. ➤ Promotive interaction: “Students promote each other’s learning by helping, sharing, and encouraging efforts to learn. Students explain, discuss, and teach what they know to classmates. Teachers structure the groups so that students sit knee-to-knee and talk through each aspect of the assignment” (Johnson, Johnson, & Holubec). ➤ Interpersonal and small group skills: leadership, decision-making, trust-building, communication, conflict management ➤ Assessment: Combining individual accountability with positive interdependence ○ Teacher evaluates ▪ Content – Individual accountability • CDs – list CDs separately; then decide best one(s) together • CMs – list CMs separately; then create sentences together • Student 1 – TS; Student 2 – CS ▪ Interpersonal dynamics and 12-inch voices ○ Each student self-evaluates (positive comments; critique for improvement)
4.	Independent Writing “I Do”	➤ Provide rubric with prompt before process begins ➤ Each student completes the process from start to finish ➤ Publish on walls or in clouds ➤ Assessment – See rubric

*Analog will be used in this document to mean anything not digital

The Methodology: “Cinderella” and the Paragraph Form

Writing Prompt: The original “Cinderella” is a longstanding folk tale with origins dating to 1 B.C. The hundreds of versions of the story differ in details, but in most versions the story begins with a young woman who lives in poor and unfortunate conditions and among cruel and abusive people. However, the story ends with her realizing great fortune and happiness. In 1950, Walt Disney released Cinderella as an animated film which has become one of Disney’s classics. Please read the tale or rent the film. Then, in a one-chunk paragraph (1:2+), explain how Cinderella feels at the beginning of the story.

[illegible]

Topic Sentence Development

Type	<u>Subject</u> Plus	Task Part of a Prompt without the Ratio	Possible Topic Sentence for a Body Paragraph
Process	<u>Subject</u> Plus - How to do something How something works	Explain the digestive process in a human being	<u>The digestive process</u> occurs in the digestive tract and three accessory organs .
Classification	<u>Subject</u> Plus Parts Characteristics	Classify the parts of a Broadway musical.	<u>The parts of a Broadway musical</u> include the libretto, score, lyrics, and choreography .
		Examine the differences between Romanticism and Realism.	Many writers of the <u>Romantic era</u> personify Nature and focus on the individual .
Exemplification	<u>Subject</u> Plus Examples	Discuss the effects of satire in the novels and dramas you have read.	<u>In <i>The Adventures of Huckleberry Finn</i>, Twain's satire</u> results in the transformation of Jim from fool to friend to father figure in Huck's eyes.
Cause and Effect	<u>Subject</u> Plus Causes that lead to an effect The effect that results from a cause If . . . , then . . .	Investigate how torn muscles occur in the body.	<u>A fatigued muscle</u> will tear .
		Explore how students would benefit from a new elective class.	<u>A one-semester course about finances and budgets</u> could help prepare students for living within their means .
Summarization	<u>Subject</u> Plus Main Idea	Summarize what you learned today in math class.	<u>The four kinds of angles</u> are determined by their relationship to 90 degrees .
Analysis	<u>Subject</u> Plus Opinion	Interpret how Cinderella feels at the beginning of the fairytale.	<u>Cinderella</u> feels mistreated .
Description	<u>Subject</u> Plus Specific details using the five senses/movement Imagery, connotation	Describe the phenomenon of a hurricane.	When the sky turns a deep, dark green , <u>a hurricane</u> could be looming .
Comparison and Contrast	<u>Subject</u> Plus - Similarities Differences	Compare state sovereignty under the Articles of Confederation and under the Constitution.	<u>Under the Articles of Confederation</u> , states have more control than they do under the Constitution .
Definition	<u>Subject</u> Plus - Clarification Quality	Define the meaning of success.	<u>Parental success</u> comes from watching one's child excel in school . (Another paragraph could be "experiencing love.")

A “Topical” Storm: Sample Topic Sentences

Type	<u>Subject</u> Plus	Task Part of a Prompt without the Ratio	Possible Topic Sentence for a Body Paragraph
Process	<u>Subject</u> Plus - How to do something How something works	Explain the process of hurricane development.	<u>The process of hurricane development involves several different stages.</u>
Classification	<u>Subject</u> Plus Parts - Characteristics	Classify the structure of a hurricane.	<u>The center of the hurricane has a strong centrifugal force. (Other paragraph topics: eye, eye wall, pinwheel formation, etc.)</u>
Exemplification	<u>Subject</u> Plus Examples	Investigate where most hurricanes occur.	Thesis: The Atlantic Coast, the Gulf of Mexico, and the Hawaiian islands are the most vulnerable to hurricanes. Topic Sentence: <u>The Gulf of Mexico has produced some of the most devastating of hurricanes. Examples follow: Ivan, Dennis, Katrina, Rita</u>
Cause and Effect	<u>Subject</u> Plus Causes that lead to an effect	Explain the causes a hurricane.	<u>Water vapor causes a hurricane.</u> (explicit cause) <u>Water vapor fuels a hurricane.</u> (implied cause – advanced)
Summarization	<u>Subject</u> Plus Main Idea	Summarize what you learned in class about wind speeds regarding a hurricane.	Hurricanes have <u>strong winds that spiral inward and upward at great speeds.</u>
Analysis	<u>Subject</u> Plus Opinion	In the aftermath of Hurricane Katrina, analyze the nation’s response to this natural disaster.	TS: <u>Government response was slow.</u> TS: <u>Media coverage helped to illustrate the devastation.</u> TS: <u>Housing continues to be a problem years later.</u> TS: <u>Displaced people were abandoned by the government.</u>
Description	<u>Subject</u> Plus Specific details using the five senses/movement Imagery, connotation	Describe the phenomenon of a hurricane.	When the sky turns a deep, dark green, a hurricane could be looming.
Comparison and Contrast	<u>Subject</u> Plus Similarities Differences	Determine the difference between a hurricane, a cyclone, and a typhoon.	<u>Hurricanes, cyclones, and typhoons are the same phenomena in different locations.</u>
Definition	<u>Subject</u> Plus Clarification - Quality	Define and describe the eye of a hurricane.	The most recognizable feature found within a hurricane is the eye.

Jane's #4 Non-Negotiable: Common Terminology

We spent ten years' time asking teachers about the terms they used when they taught writing. To describe the specific information in a story, for example, teachers' answers ranged from *support* to *citations* to *details* and beyond. We were astonished by the number of synonyms that abound in English classes across the country. Those conversations led to our current list of terms on page 30.

Common terminology helps students learn better. As one girl said, "You mean I don't have to un-learn and re-learn and un-learn and re-learn with each teacher?" Students don't always understand that concrete detail, for example, is the same as plot reference, evidence, and proof. They think they are learning entirely different concepts and don't realize that the terms are just synonyms.

To achieve consistency in the curriculum, the first step we took, and the simplest one, was to standardize the terminology within the department. We agreed to operate by majority vote; people in the minority were expected to abide by all department votes. Our philosophy on this approach is quite clear: Consistency of program outweighs individual teacher preference.

It doesn't matter if teachers use different terms. What does matter is that every teacher in the department uses the same terms in every English class and that all students learn the terms during the training unit.

Materials and Activities

1. For Chart #1 that focuses only on concrete details (CDs) and commentary (CMs), we print copies of this page for each student on colored paper for permanent residence and reference in their binders. It takes many practices for them to differentiate between the two concepts and produce good commentary. Having the chart helps them to learn the difference.
2. Two terms deserve explanation. *Play-by-play announcer* and *color commentator* come from sports events and have been extremely valuable in helping students learn to differentiate CDs and CMs. The play-by-play announcer describes the action on the field: *The quarterback just made a 10-yard pass.* The color commentator interprets the play: *He's got a better throwing arm than that and has the skill to make it to the wide receiver.* Even with students who don't follow sports, they understand the reference because our society is permeated with athletics. We provide more analogies in our workshops regarding how to discern CD and CM in various cultural and social settings.



Critical Terms in the Program

Five terms deserve attention here as unique parts of the Jane Schaffer Writing Program®. Other terms in the program, such as *introduction*, *body*, and *conclusion*, are commonly used everywhere. Our unique terms are illustrated in Fig. 1 and include:

- *topic sentence* (abbreviated as *TS*)
- *concrete detail* (abbreviated as *CDs*)
- *commentary* (abbreviated as *CMs*)
- *chunk*
- *ratio of CDs to CMs*

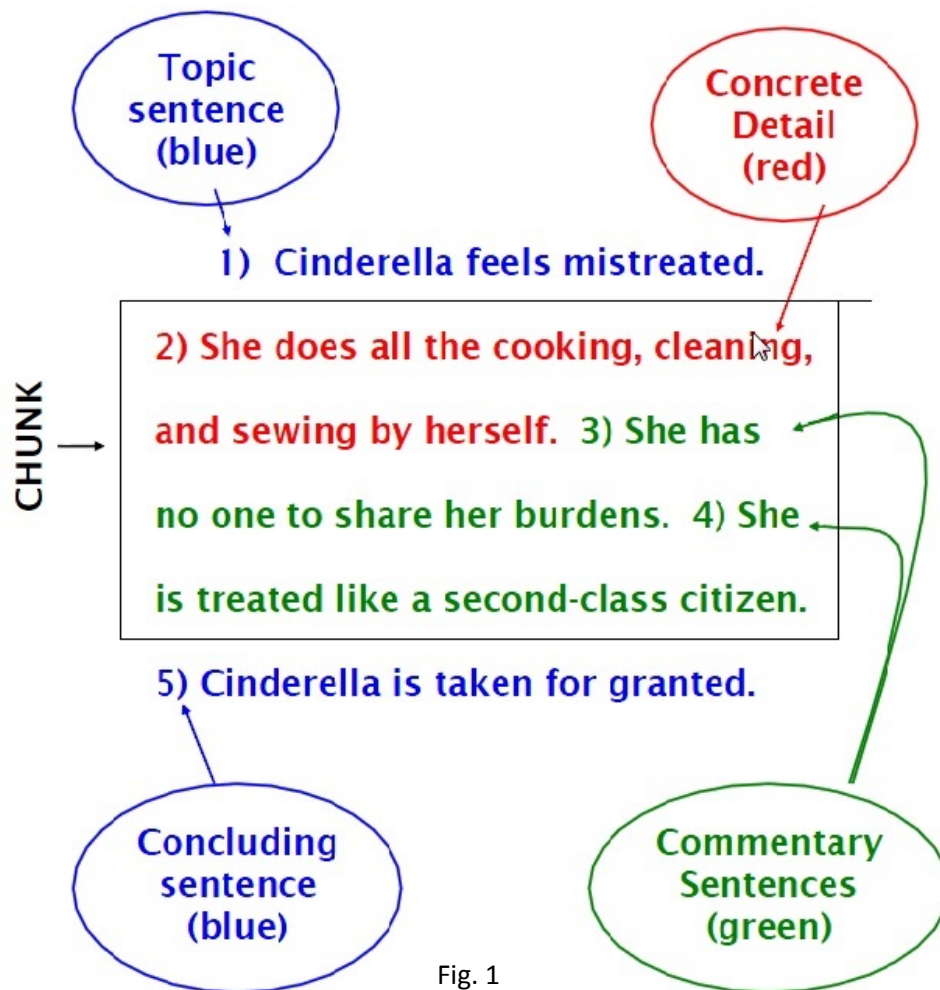


Fig. 1

1. *Topic sentence* (commonly abbreviated as *TS*)

Our topic sentence is not a summary sentence that starts a report, as many students have done before they come to us. Here's an example of an incorrect topic sentence, one that does not meet our requirements for the following prompt:

Prompt: Write a paragraph that discusses George and Lennie's goal.

Incorrect topic sentence: In *Of Mice and Men*, George and Lennie save money to buy a farm.

This topic sentence is all plot summary, all concrete detail with no commentary. We are looking for an analytical topic sentence with a subject and an opinion, which we call *commentary*, and no, or virtually no, concrete detail. Any connotative word counts as a commentary word. This topic sentence is better:

Correct topic sentence: In *Of Mice and Men*, George and Lennie yearn to buy a place of their own.

Our model has two commentary points: *yearn* and *place of their own*. Both have feelings that students can identify (can point to): *yearn* conveys a deep longing or wanting; a *place of their own* suggests an ownership of something personal, something that belongs to them alone, somewhere they belong.

It turned out to be as simple as counting the number of commentary words in the sentence to show us that this topic sentence works. We ask students to circle the commentary words and then show us the sentence. Our minimum requirement for a paragraph assignment is one commentary point or word. Students may include more than one -- two or three and sometimes more. Here are examples for Cinderella:

- Topic sentence with one commentary point:

Cinderella feels sad.

- Topic sentence with two commentary points:

Cinderella feels sad and lonely.

- Topic sentence with three commentary points:

Cinderella feels lonely, catering to everyone's needs but her own.

2. *Concrete detail* (abbreviated by our students as *CDs*)

These sentences answer the questions, *Who? What? When? Where? What happens in the story?* They are facts, not opinions. The words and phrases describe anything that is in the story. They do not answer the questions *Why?* and *How?*

The easiest concrete details for students to practice in the beginning state literally what a character does. Every student has something to say; it's what they talk about at school all the time when they discuss their day there. We start with paraphrased concrete details because they avoid the punctuation and capitalization issues associated with quotation CDs. Students learn those later on.

Here are examples from *Cinderella*:

After her father dies, she does all the cooking and cleaning by herself
(2).

3. *Commentary* (abbreviated by our students as *CMs*)

Commentary means any word that has connotations, or feelings, that students can explain to us. We show them three words to model our thinking: *walk*, *stroll*, and *strut*.

The word *walk* has no connotation; it means literally to place one foot in front of the other in order to move. The word *stroll*, though, has feelings attached to it. It has the feeling, or connotation, of slowness, a casual feeling, taking your time. The word *strut* is another connotative word; it conveys feelings of “say it loud, say it proud,” a sense of arrogance or cockiness.

We tell students that a topic sentence with *walk* would not do the job, but one with *stroll* or *strut* would. This helps them begin to understand the concept. If we need more examples, we use *eat*, *inhale*, and *gobble*; *look*, *stare*, and *glare*; and so on.

4. *Chunk*

A *chunk* describes the part of the response to literature paragraph that includes one part concrete detail and two or more parts of commentary. It isn't the whole paragraph; it is the section that comes between the topic sentence and the concluding sentence. One student remembered it as the part between the blue bookends. This chart, also available in poster form on our website, has helped to clarify students' thinking.

5. *Ratio of concrete detail (CD) to commentary (CM) in a body paragraph*

Ratio compares the amount of concrete detail to the amount of commentary in a body paragraph. The ratio we are looking for in a response to literature paragraph is 1:2+. In other words, for every sentence of concrete detail, we want two or more sentences of commentary. The plus (+) is critical. Students may always write more than two commentary thoughts.

Students will try to write two other ratios:

- 1:1 (one part CD to one part CM)

The ratio of 1:1 is a good beginning (and for the AP United States History DBQ, it is recommended), but English teachers instructing students in literary analysis have said that the commentary felt undeveloped and needed more thought to elaborate on the first point. The second commentary has always been the harder of the two to produce but the one that adds richness to the overall thought.

- 1:0 (only concrete detail with no commentary at all)
If students write 1:0, we call that plot summary, a reading check, or a book report.

People have asked how the *ratio between concrete detail and commentary* came about. We had scored essays at holistic sessions, including the Advanced Placement® (AP®) English exam; the old SAT writing test (now part of the SAT I); the California state writing assessments for middle and high school; and, local district writing assessments. We wondered if there were magic numbers we could teach students to give them signposts — number of words, sentences, paragraphs. So we started counting everything and discovered that there was, indeed, a numerical yardstick that could guide students. The ratio turned out to be this:

1 : 2+

Papers that held to this ratio earned higher scores than those that did not. Again, students can always develop their thoughts more; the plus (+) in the ratio means they can include more than two points of commentary. After one student asked, “Is it OK if I have a third thought?” we laughed at ourselves and learned to encourage them even more. However, the textual evidence is important, and novice writers tend to go off topic if they write too many commentary sentences. What happens is that they become so far removed from the CD that they 1) leave the point they were trying to make; and 2) have a difficult time returning to their original thought. Simply monitor.

The 1:2+ ratio applies to response to literature writing but changes for other genres of writing which is found on page ____ of this document.

We still analyze paragraphs and essays on released exams to make sure the ratio hasn’t changed, and it hasn’t. It still applies for response to literature paragraphs and essays.

Jane's #7 Non-Negotiable: Color Coding

We color-code the paragraph and the essay. Along with Collaborative Writing, we learned it from elementary teachers. The kinesthetic approach to learning is well documented and helps students to master content. We asked one seventh-grade boy why he liked using the colored pens. He said, “They help me remember what kind of thoughts I need to include and where to put them.”

Here is a chart of the colors and their applications:

COLOR	APPLICATION
blue	topic sentence and concluding sentence in a body paragraph
red	concrete detail in a body paragraph
green	Commentary in a body paragraph
black	the entire introduction and conclusion in an essay

We chose our four colors because they were the least expensive ballpoint pens available at office supply stores. Colored pencils work as well but are more expensive and need sharpening often; however, many elementary teachers prefer them. We wanted four separate pens that students could pick up and use because we saw a greater engraving of the concepts on the brain when they did this. We like students to use those pens made of a single piece of plastic, not the two-tone ones with a color at the top and a white barrel. Students, who are sometimes mischievous, can break them or change the colors to another pen.

We don't recommend the pens with four colors in one. They are less expensive but don't ensure the same results that we see with four different pens. When we are reading a nonfiction piece, we have the students underline the parts of a paragraph, using the correct color. Or, we have them purchase highlighters – blue for TS and CS; pink for CD; green for CM; and yellow for thesis statement. Caution: Highlighters will dry out overnight if not capped properly.

Students will wean themselves from the colored pens when they are ready; we do not recommend requiring them *ad nauseum*. Some students leave the colored pens behind on the second or third day of class; others want to use them throughout high school. One senior said, “They help me think thoughts.” We encourage students to use whatever tools will help them think clearly. Some teachers like the final drafts color-coded, but we recommend that final drafts for high school students be typed or written in black/blue ink.

There are many ways to organize the pens. Our preferred approach is to put the pens in quart-size lock-top baggies for each student. Some teachers number the baggies with a Sharpie and assign each bag to a specific student each class period or block. We leave the bagged sets in a basket by the door and train our students to pick one up each day when they come in and return it to the basket on their way out. Deborah Louis assigns Materials Managers each cycle. These students not only pick up the baggies five minutes before the bell without being told, checking to make sure all pens are accounted for, but also she has them pass out papers, pick up papers, run administrative-type errands, and block the door so no one will interrupt (Just kidding on “blocking the door.” We sure would like to do that sometimes, wouldn’t we?)

In some classes, students have a set of pens of their own and bring them each day, but we like to be prepared for as many situations as possible. We sometimes decide to remove the caps to prevent harm to people and damage to desks.

TERMS

CONCRETE DETAIL	COMMENTARY	RATIO
stuff from the story on the surface paraphrase CD quotation CD	stuff from your head under the surface connotative words-- words with feelings you can describe to me	amount of CD:CM in a body paragraph
the “what” facts examples illustrations evidence support plot references paraphrases citations quotations plot summary What really happens/happened in the story? play-by-play announcer	the “so what?” the “why?” the “spin” analysis interpretation evaluation a character’s feelings George feels (felt) ----- opinion inference insight significance reasons How does/did __ feel on the inside? Why did ___ do that? color commentator	English 1:2+ - style, rhetorical, and literary analysis 2+:1 - narrative, expository, synthesis, argument Social Studies 2+:1 3+:0 Science and Math 2+:1 3+:0 All others Varies with the assignment

THE JANE SCHAFER WRITING PROGRAM™
Teaching the Multiparagraph Essay

TERMS AND DEFINITIONS

PARTS OF AN ESSAY		
1.	WHAT IS AN ESSAY?	A piece of writing that gives your thoughts (concrete details and commentary) about a subject. All formal essays include the following paragraphs: introduction, body paragraph(s), conclusion. The different types of essays are also known as Modes of Discourse, “modes” meaning “a method” and “discourse” meaning “conversation” (a method of conversation between a writer and his/her audience). The Jane Schaffer Writing Program® teaches students in the following modes: Narration, Exposition, Information, Summarization, Persuasion, Argumentation, Analytical (Literary Analysis), Style Analysis.
2.	THE INTRODUCTION	The first paragraph in an essay. It includes the thesis, most often at the end. It begins broadly and narrows to the thesis.
3.	THESIS STATEMENT	A statement with a subject and opinion (<i>commentary</i>). This comes somewhere in your introduction and most often at the end of your introduction. It acts as a roadmap to the entire essay.
4.	BODY PARAGRAPH(S)	Paragraphs between the introduction and conclusion. Each paragraph develops a point you want to make which supports your thesis statement. Each body paragraph includes a topic sentence (TS), facts and opinions (CDs and CMs), and a concluding sentence (CS).
5.	THE CONCLUSION	The last paragraph in your essay. It begins narrowly with a restatement of the thesis (not a repeat) and broadens. It may sum up your ideas, reflect on what you said in your essay, provide more commentary about your subject, or give a personal statement about the subject. Your conclusion for literary analysis is all commentary and does not include concrete detail. It does not repeat key words from your paper and especially not from your thesis and introductory paragraph. It gives a finished feeling to your whole essay. Non-literary writing may include CDs. Ask your teacher.
6.	TRANSITIONS	Words, phrases, and sentences that link ideas and provide a smooth and logical flow to your thoughts so that your reader will follow your logical progression of ideas. Moving from one point or idea to another is done successfully with the use of transitions.

TERMS AND DEFINITIONS

PARTS OF AN ESSAY		
1.	WHAT IS AN ESSAY?	
2.	THE INTRODUCTION	
3.	THESIS STATEMENT	
4.	BODY PARAGRAPH(S)	
5.	THE CONCLUSION	
6.	TRANSITIONS	

**PARTS OF A PARAGRAPH AND THE JANE SCHAFER CHUNKING TECHNIQUE**

1.	TOPIC SENTENCE (TS)	The first sentence in a body paragraph. For literary analysis and personal narrative, the TS includes the subject and the writer's opinion (commentary) that leads the paragraph. For argumentation, expository/informational, the TS includes the subject of the paragraph, but, depending on the assignment, might include something other than a commentary. The TS does the same thing for a body paragraph that the thesis does for the whole essay.
2.	CONCRETE DETAIL (CD)	Also known as CD, specific details that form the backbone or core of your body paragraphs. Synonyms for concrete details include facts, specifics, examples, descriptions, illustrations, support, proof, evidence, quotations, paraphrasing, or plot references. A concrete detail is one complete sentence. "What I read," "What I have seen," What I/others have done," and dialogue.
3.	TRANSITIONAL LEAD-IN TO A CONCRETE DETAIL (TLCD)	This is usually a phrase that introduces a quotation so that the quotation does not abruptly appear out of nowhere. Usually, this phrase or sentence illustrates what is happening in the scene, and it sets up the quotation. For advanced writers, the lead-in may be a CD or a CM.
4.	COMMENTARY (CM)	Also known as a CM, one commentary equals one sentence. It is your opinion or comment about something; not concrete detail. Synonyms include opinion, insight, analysis, interpretation, inference, personal response, feelings, evaluation, explication, and reflection.
5.	A CHUNK	It is the smallest unified group of thoughts in a paragraph that combine CDs and CMs. The combination depends on the <i>RATIO</i> for each mode. A paragraph may have multiple "chunks."
6.	RATIO CD:CM	The RATIO of concrete detail (CD) to commentary (CM). Typically, for literary, style, and rhetorical analysis, the ratio is (1:2+): 1 sentence of concrete detail plus <u>2 or more</u> sentences of commentary equals one "chunk." Typically, for argumentation, expository/informational, and narrative, the ratio is (2+:1): 2 or more sentences of concrete detail plus 1 commentary sentence equals one "chunk." For summary, typically (3+:0).
7.	TRANSITIONS	Words, phrases, and even sentences that link ideas and provide a smooth and logical flow to a writer's thoughts. It helps the reader understand the writer's logic. Transitions are important within and between body paragraphs.
8.	CONCLUDING SENTENCE (CS)	The last sentence in a body paragraph. For literary responses, the CS is all commentary; for expository and summary paragraphs, it depends on the assignment or purpose of the piece and may include concrete detail, such as: predictions, connections, inferences, clarifications, and evaluations. Do not repeat key words from the paragraph. Provide a finished feeling.

PARTS OF A PARAGRAPH AND THE JANE SCHAFER CHUNKING TECHNIQUE		
1.	TOPIC SENTENCE (TS)	
2.	CONCRETE DETAIL (CD)	
3.	TRANSITIONAL LEAD-IN TO A CONCRETE DETAIL (TLCD)	
4.	COMMENTARY (CM)	
5.	A CHUNK	
6.	RATIO CD:CM	
7.	TRANSITIONS	
8.	CONCLUDING SENTENCE (CS)	

THE PROCESS OF WRITING AND THE JANE SCHAFER STEPS IN THAT PROCESS		
1.	PRE-WRITING	Traditional prewriting includes mapping, clustering, bubbling, webbing, brainstorming, free writing, and outlining. The Jane Schaffer method of prewriting includes Gathering CDs, T-charting, the WOW exercise, and the shaping sheet.
2.	GATHERING CDS	The Jane Schaffer “Gathering CDs”™ think-sheet helps you to determine what concrete details you will use in each paragraph in response to a writing prompt that your teacher gives you. It also helps you to provide preliminary CMs based on the CDs selected which will also help with your initial topic sentence (TS).
3.	T-CHARTING	The Jane Schaffer “T-Chart”™ is a think-sheet that helps you to begin forming a paragraph with a Topic Sentence, CDs, CMs, and a Concluding Sentence.
4.	WEB-OFF-THE-WORD™	The Jane Schaffer “WOW”™ think-sheet helps you when you want to figure out a different way of saying something. It also helps you to develop your vocabulary and own style of writing.
5.	WEB-OFF-THE-TOPIC-SENTENCE™	The Jane Schaffer “WOW”™ think-sheet helps you to create a concluding sentence for your paragraph by selecting the most important words, phrases, and ideas surrounding your topic sentence and webbing off of them in order to stay focused but not repeat yourself.
6.	WEAVING	Jane Schaffer’s integral step of blending concrete details and commentary. Once you and your teacher feel confident in your ability to identify and understand CDs and CMs, and you are able to apply the concept/ratio correctly, then you are ready to move beyond the structured format to weaving. Remember—all formal essays reveal the author’s voice and style and are organized and logical. They include the introduction, body paragraphs (TS, CDs/CMs, CS), and a conclusion.
7.	THE SHAPING SHEET	The Jane Schaffer step performed after prewriting and before the first draft of the essay; this is where you make sure you do the following for each paragraph: 1) include transitions between ideas; 2) vary your sentence openings; 3) include different types of sentences (simple, compound, complex, compound-complex); 4) correct spelling, punctuation, and capitalization errors; and 5) add or delete words, phrases, and sentences to create your voice and your own personal writing style.
8.	PEER RESPONSE	Written responses and reactions to teacher-directed components of your partner's paper. Peer response usually occurs with shaping sheets and first drafts.
9.	FIRST DRAFT	The first version of your essay (also called the rough draft) where you combine the introduction, body paragraphs, and conclusion, editing and revising along the way.
10.	FINAL DRAFT	The final version of your essay. At this point, you’re ready to submit your essay. By the way, good writers can always make a draft better, but a deadline is a deadline!

THE PROCESS OF WRITING AND THE JANE SCHAFFER STEPS IN THAT PROCESS		
1.	PRE-WRITING	
2.	GATHERING CDS	
3.	T-CHARTING	
4.	WEB-OFF-THE-WORD™	
5.	WEB-OFF-THE-TOPIC-SENTENCE™	
6.	WEAVING	
7.	THE SHAPING SHEET	
8.	PEER RESPONSE	
9.	FIRST DRAFT	
10.	FINAL DRAFT	

STAGES IN THE TEACHING SEQUENCE OF WRITING

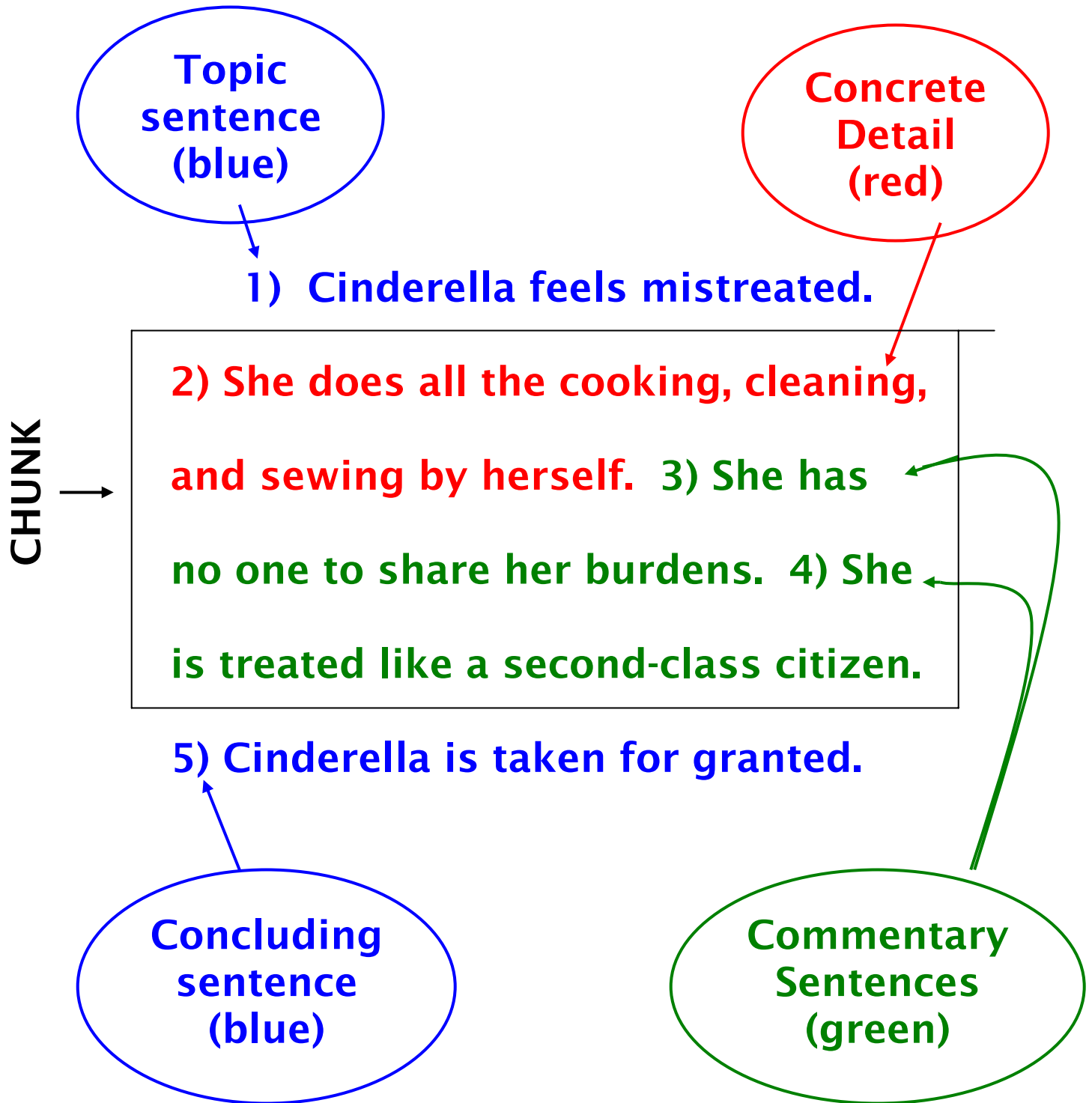
Argumentation, Expository / Informational, Narrative, Response to Literature

1.	Teacher Model “Guided Writing” “I Do”	➤ Teacher gives the class a completed example--from the writing prompt to the prewriting to the shaping to the final draft. ➤ Equipment and Materials: ○ hard graphic organizers and pens for each student and teacher (students copy as teacher presents each step and the thinking behind each step) ○ hard copy of the model from start to finish for all students (give this clean copy of all steps after the students copy and submit for grade) ○ chalkboard, dry erase board, interactive whiteboard, or document camera ○ if digital, use Google Docs, JSWP App, BYOD, laptop, digital graphic organizers ➤ Assessment: Credit is given for copying precisely the model either on paper or digitally; ▪ on-task behavior, focus ▪ asking questions, clarification ▪ color-coding correctly ▪ correct grammar, mechanics, usage
2.	Class Collaborative “Shared Writing” “We Do”	➤ The teacher and the students write collaboratively in class. ➤ The teacher guides a thoughtful and multimedia discussion. Shared resources. ➤ Everyone is writing on the same, specific topic. Mutual goal. ➤ Equipment and Materials: see above (no model; hard copies or digital graphic organizers) ➤ Assessment ○ Everyone offers two comments for each part of the process through the final draft. ○ Teacher frequently assesses individuals and group (definitions, colors, purpose) ○ Group processing after each step in the process: “reflecting on the group’s work to clarify and improve the effectiveness of the members in working together to achieve the group’s goals by (a) describing what member actions were helpful and unhelpful and (b) making decisions about what actions to continue or change” (Johnson, et.al). ○ Everyone submits entire process (after each step).
3.	Small Group “Shared Writing” “You Do Together”	➤ Students write in pairs. Use same materials as “We Do.” Analog* only. ➤ Promotive interaction: “Students promote each other’s learning by helping, sharing, and encouraging efforts to learn. Students explain, discuss, and teach what they know to classmates. Teachers structure the groups so that students sit knee-to-knee and talk through each aspect of the assignment” (Johnson, Johnson, & Holubec). ➤ Interpersonal and small group skills: leadership, decision-making, trust-building, communication, conflict management ➤ Assessment: Combining individual accountability with positive interdependence ○ Teacher evaluates ▪ Content – Individual accountability • CDs – list CDs separately; then decide best one(s) together • CMs – list CMs separately; then create sentences together • Student 1 – TS; Student 2 – CS ▪ Interpersonal dynamics and 12-inch voices ○ Each student self-evaluates (positive comments; critique for improvement)
4.	Independent Writing “I Do”	➤ Provide rubric with prompt before process begins ➤ Each student completes the process from start to finish ➤ Publish on walls or in clouds ➤ Assessment – See rubric

*Analog will be used in this document to mean anything not digital



ONE-CHUNK PARAGRAPH FORMULA/STRUCTURE





Gathering CDs and CMs: One-Chunk Response to Literature Paragraphs

PROMPT:

The original “Cinderella” is a longstanding folk tale with origins dating to 1 B.C. The hundreds of versions of the story differ in details, but in most versions the story begins with a young woman who lives in poor and unfortunate conditions and among cruel and abusive people. However, the story ends with her realizing great fortune and happiness. In 1950, Walt Disney released Cinderella as an animated film which has become one of Disney’s classics. Please watch the Disney film. Then, in a one-chunk paragraph (1:2+), explain how Cinderella feels at the beginning of the story.

GATHERING CDs:

1. Think of 3 or more CDs that would fit the prompt and write them below.
2. Then circle the one CD you think is the best.

- father has died
- does all the cooking, cleaning, and sewing by herself
- sleeps by the fireplace

GATHERING CMs:

3. Brainstorm 5 or more CMs you can for your CD and write them below.

Using one of these CM helpers might help you

_____ feels ____ on the inside.

_____ feels like _____.

Why does the character do this?

4. Pick the biggest, most important thought and label it **TS** in blue.
5. Next, label the 2 best CM thoughts in green as **CM1** and **CM2**.
6. Last, pick the idea that will finish the paragraph and label it **CS** in blue.

- lonely -- CM1
- mistreated -- TS
- ignored -- CM2
- scared
- upset -- CS



The T-Chart: Prewriting for Response to Literature Paragraph

Ratio: (1:2+)

1. Write your topic sentence here:

Cinderella feels mistreated.

2. Complete the following T-chart:

CDs
What did the character do?
What happened in the story?

CMs
 _____ felt _____.
 _____ felt like a _____.
 Why . . . ?

• She does all the cooking, cleaning, and sewing by herself.

• CM1: lonely

• CM2: ignored

3. Write your concluding sentence here:

Cinderella is upset.

WEB OFF THE WORD™: Commentary Sentences

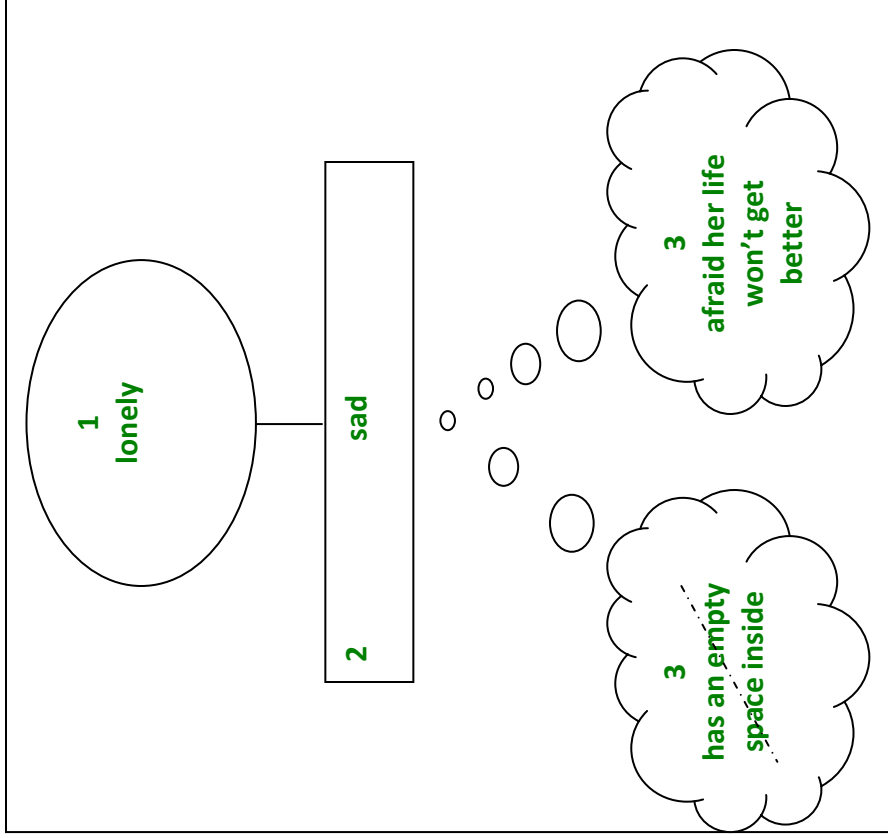
Sequence to fill out the Web off the Word page:

- In the #1 circle in the middle, copy the **CM** idea from your T-chart.
- In the #2 box, write down a synonym for the #1 word. This can be a single word..
- In the #3 clouds, write down phrases.
 - Phrases are 2 or more "meaty" words.
 - Remember not to include any concrete details.
 - To help you think of phrases, ask yourself, "What does it mean to _____?"
- Create your *CM* sentence by what Jane calls "picking and stitching" one or more ideas from your web.



WEB OFF THE WORD™ (WOW) 1ST Commentary Sentence

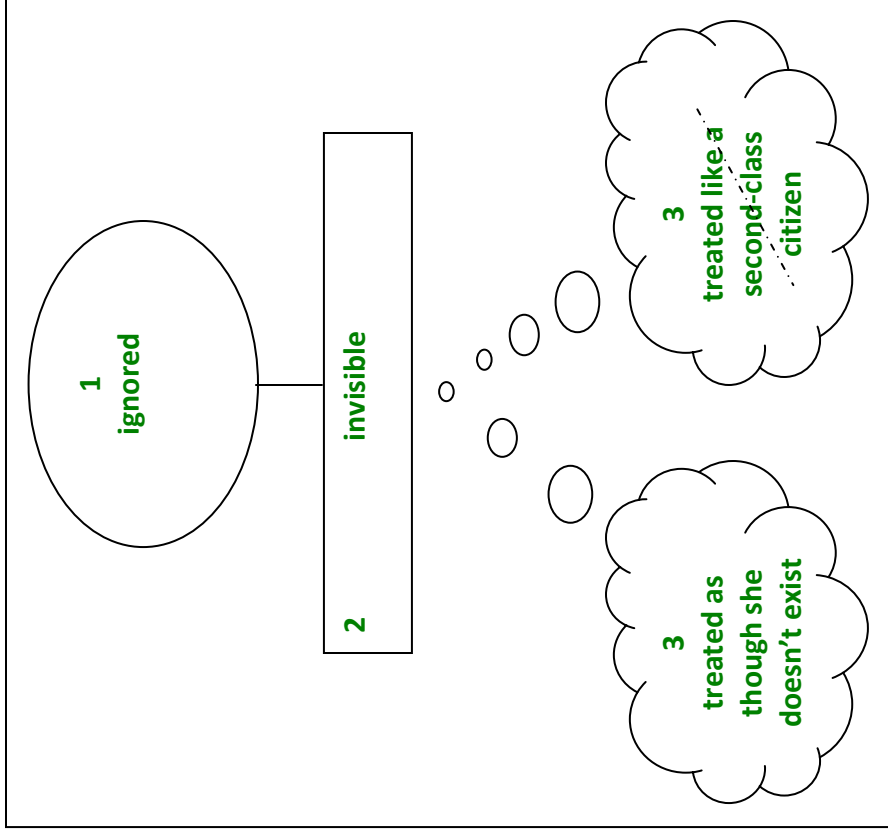
CD: She cooks, cleans, and sews by herself.



CM #1: She has an empty space inside.

WEB OFF THE WORD™ (WOW) 2ND Commentary Sentence

CD: She cooks, cleans, and sews by herself.



CM #2: She is treated like a second-class citizen.



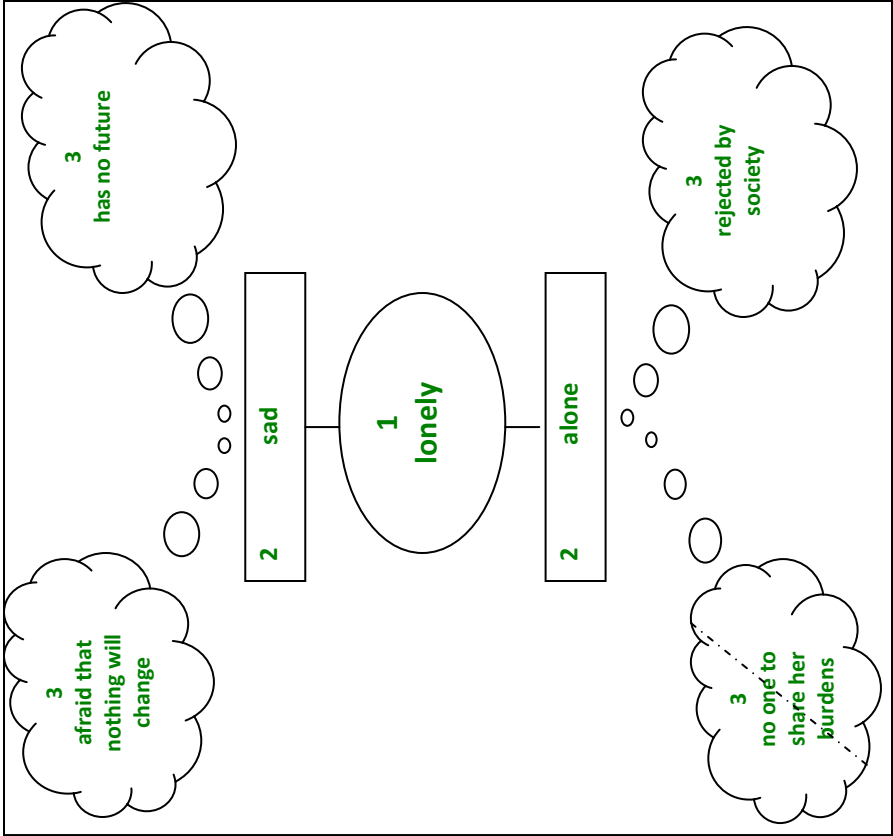
WEB OFF THE WORD™ (WOW)
1ST Commentary Sentence

WEB OFF THE WORD™ (WOW) 2ND
Commentary Sentence

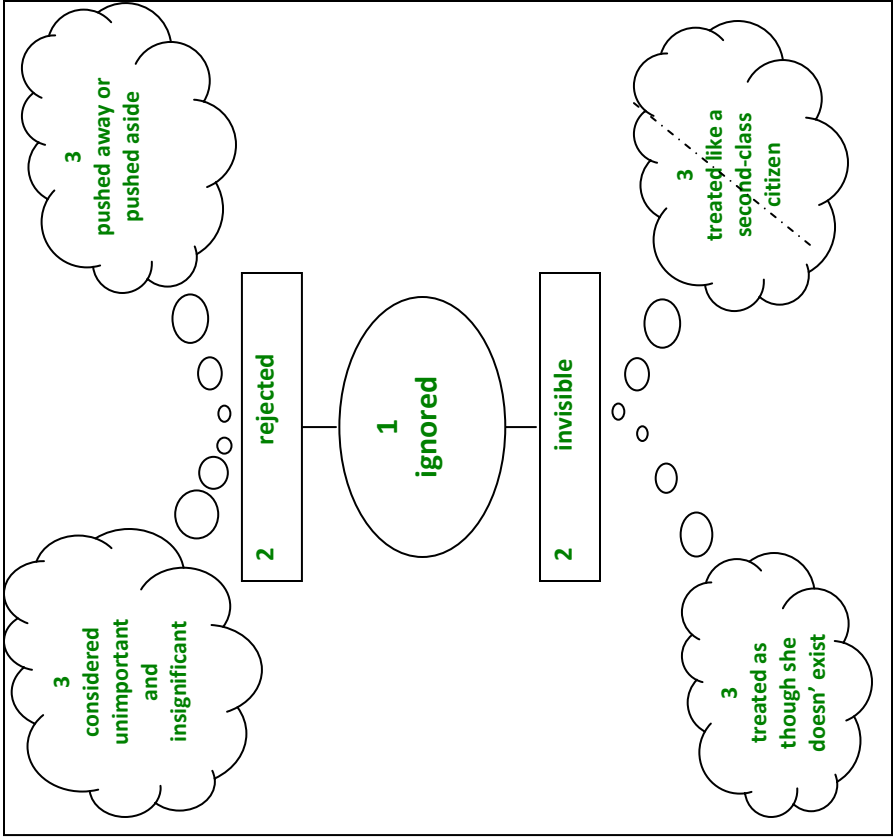
(intermediate)

CD: **She cooks, cleans, and sews by herself.**

CD: **She cooks, cleans, and sews by herself.**



CM #1: **She has no one to share her burdens.**



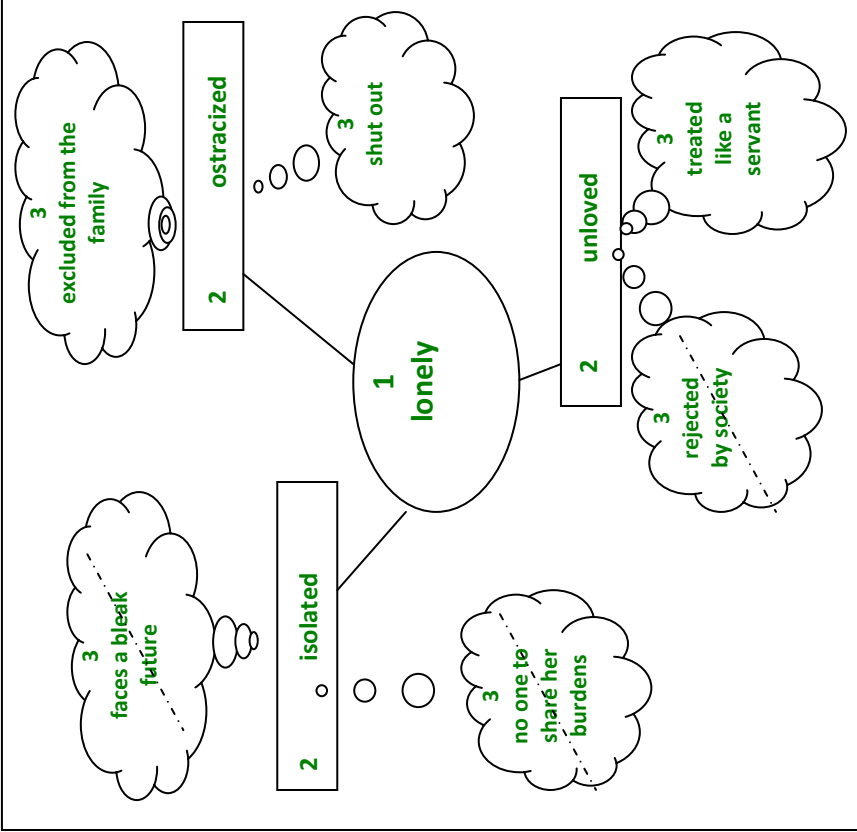
CM #2: **She is treated like a second-class citizen.**



WEB OFF THE WORD™ (WOW) 1ST Commentary Sentence

(advanced)

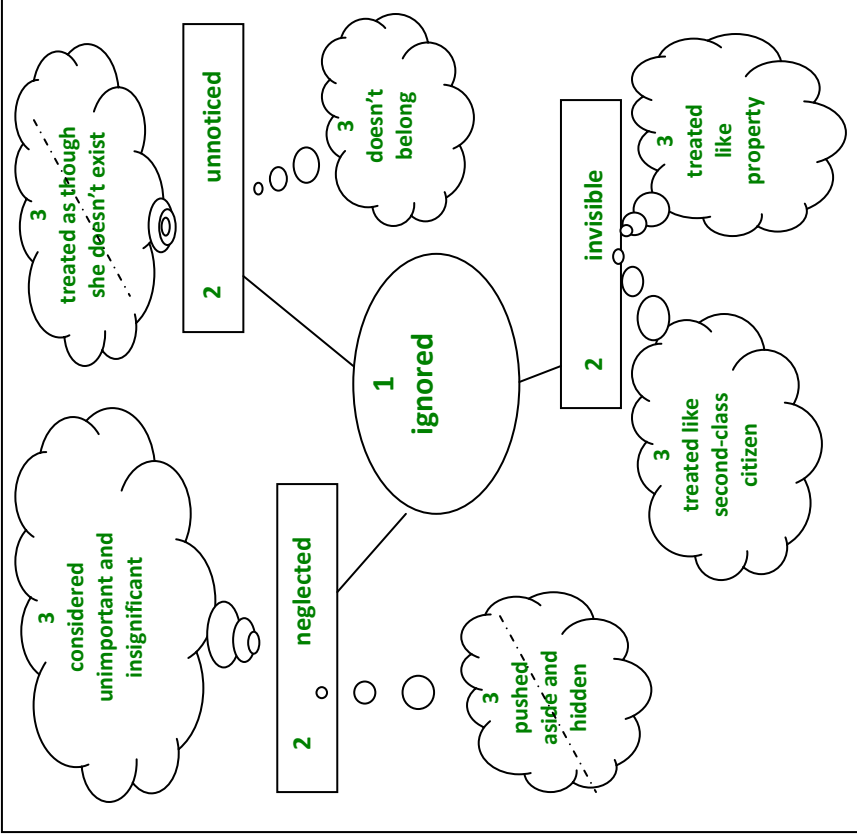
CD: She cooks, cleans, and sews by herself.



CM #1: Rejected by society, she has no one to share her burdens and faces a bleak future.

WEB OFF THE WORD™ (WOW) 2ND Commentary Sentence

CD: She cooks, cleans, and sews by herself.



CM #2: She is pushed aside literally and metaphorically and treated as though she does not exist.

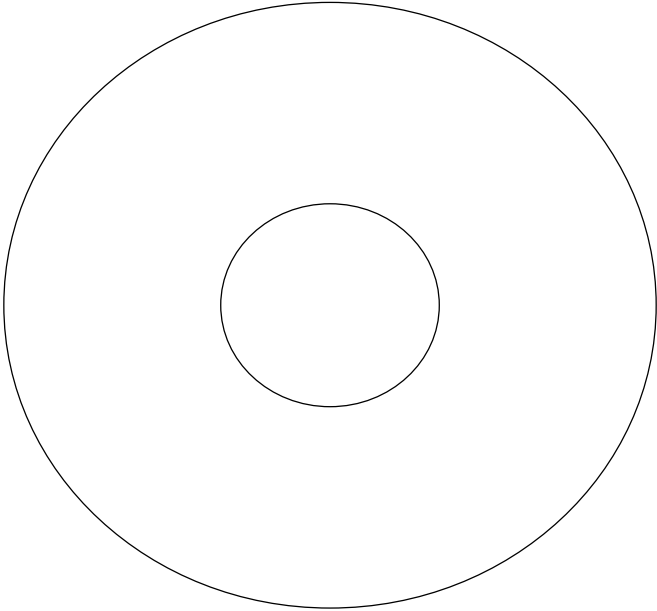
WEB OFF THE TOPIC SENTENCE TO CREATE THE CONCLUDING SENTENCE

Sequence to fill out the Web off the Topic Sentence page:

1. In the circle in the middle, copy the CM idea(s) from your topic sentence.
2. Think of 3 or 4 ideas for your web. These can be single words or short phrases.
3. Remember not to include any concrete details. To help you think of ideas, ask yourself, "What does it mean to the character to _____?"
4. Create your concluding sentence, using one or more ideas from your web. The only thing you can't use is the idea in the middle circle since you've already written that in your topic sentence.

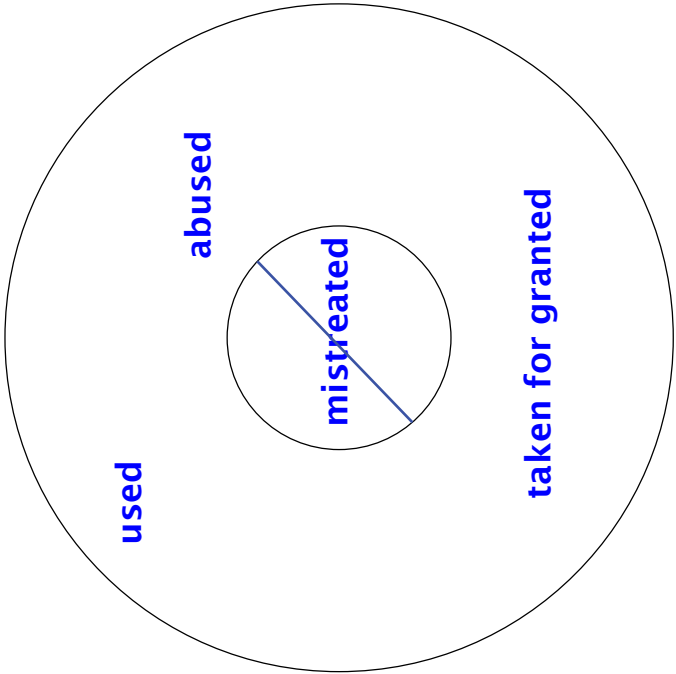


WEB OFF THE WORD™
Web Off the Topic Sentence
for the Concluding Sentence



CS: _____

WEB OFF THE WORD™
Web Off The Topic Sentence
for the Concluding Sentence



CS: Cinderella is taken for granted.



1:2+

TS

Proper Noun

Cinderella feels mistreated.

CD

Personal Pronoun

**She does all the cooking,
cleaning, and sewing by
herself.**

1ST
CM

Personal Pronoun

**She has no one to
share her burdens.**

2ND
CM

Personal Pronoun

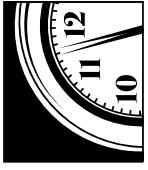
**She is treated like a
second-class citizen.**

CS

Proper Noun

**Cinderella is taken for
granted.**

TRANSITIONS THAT . . .

 ADD	 COMPARE & CONTRAST	 SITUATE PEOPLE, PLACES, THINGS, & IDEAS	 CONSIDER TIME	 ARGUE / DISCUSS	 EMPHASIZE	
• Additionally,** • Again, • also • and • and then • as well as • besides • further • Furthermore, • in addition • Moreover, • next • nor • or • Secondly, • too <u>Introduce an Example</u> • For example, • For instance, • in particular • namely • specifically • such as • that is • to illustrate	<u>Introduce a Similarity</u> • In like manner • Likewise, • Similarly, <u>Introduce a Difference</u> • Alternatively, • And yet • at the same time • but • Conversely, • even so • for all that • ; however, • in contrast • in the same way • Nevertheless, • Nonetheless • notwithstanding • On the contrary, • on the other hand • or • otherwise • still • yet	• aboard • about • above • across • adjacent to • against • ahead of • along • alongside • amid • among • apart from • around • at • back of • before • behind • below • beneath • between • beyond • down • in-/outside • juxtaposed to • nearby • next to • opposite • throughout • underneath	• after • Afterward, • as soon as • at least • at the same time • at this point • before • during • earlier • eventually • finally • First, • formerly • in the beginning • in the end • in the meantime • in the past • Later, • Meanwhile, • moments later • now • presently • since • soon • sooner or later • then • until • when • while	<u>Introduce a Concession</u> • Admittedly, • Granted, • Although true . . . <u>Introduce a Refutation</u> • And yet, • but • Even so, • However, • Nevertheless, • notwithstanding • regardless • yet <u>Introduce a Purpose</u> • For this purpose, • To this end, • With this __ in mind,	• above all • assuredly • certainly • clearly • especially • equally important • even more important • In fact • Indeed, • No one denies • Of course, • The fact remains • the greatest • the worst • to be sure • undoubtedly • unquestionably	<u>Introduce a Result</u> • Accordingly, • as a result • because • Consequently, • for • For this reason, • Hence, • so • then • therefore • thereupon • thus <u>Introduce an Ending</u> • as has been noted • in any event • In brief, • In fact, • in other words • in short • in the end • indeed • on the whole • that is • to be sure

**"In conclusion," and "To sum up," to be used sparingly, please.

*** Capitalization and punctuation marks assist in normal placement of sentence structures, but many constructions exist.

Mini Lessons for Middle School Shaping Sheets

6 th Grade	• use capitalization for: ○ abbreviations; ○ initials and acronyms; and ○ organizations; • recognize and use punctuation marks including: ○ commas in compound sentences; ○ proper punctuation and spacing for quotations; and ○ parentheses, brackets, and ellipses (to indicate omissions and interruptions or incomplete statements); • use proper mechanics including italics and underlining for titles of books. • differentiate between commonly confused terms (e.g., its, it's; affect, effect); • use spelling patterns and rules and print and electronic resources to determine and check correct spellings; and • know how to use the spell-check function in word processing while understanding its limitations.
7 th Grade	• identify, use, and understand the function of the following parts of speech in the context of reading, writing, and speaking: ○ verbs (perfect and progressive tenses) and participles; ○ appositive phrases; ○ adverbial and adjectival phrases and clauses; ○ conjunctive adverbs (e.g., consequently, furthermore, indeed); ○ prepositions and prepositional phrases and their influence on subject-verb agreement; ○ relative pronouns (e.g., whose, that, which); ○ subordinating conjunctions (e.g., because, since); and ○ transitions for sentence to sentence or paragraph to paragraph coherence; • write complex sentences and differentiate between main versus subordinate clauses; and • use a variety of complete sentences (e.g., simple, compound, complex) that include properly placed modifiers, correctly identified antecedents, parallel structures, and consistent tenses. • use conventions of capitalization; and • recognize and use punctuation marks including: ○ commas after introductory words, phrases, and clauses; and ○ semicolons, colons, and hyphens. • spell correctly, including using various resources to determine and check correct spellings.
8 th Grade	• use and understand the function of the following parts of speech in the context of reading, writing, and speaking: ○ verbs (perfect and progressive tenses) and participles; ○ appositive phrases; ○ adverbial and adjectival phrases and clauses; ○ relative pronouns (e.g., whose, that, which); and ○ subordinating conjunctions (e.g., because, since); • write complex sentences and differentiate between main versus subordinate clauses; and • use a variety of complete sentences (e.g., simple, compound, complex) that include properly placed modifiers, correctly identified antecedents, parallel structures, and consistent tenses. • use conventions of capitalization; and • use correct punctuation marks, including: ○ commas after introductory structures and dependent adverbial clauses, and correct punctuation of complex sentences; and • semicolons, colons, hyphens, parentheses, brackets, and ellipses. • spell correctly, including using various resources to determine and check correct spellings.

Mini Lessons for High School Shaping Sheets

9 th Grade	• use and understand the function of the following parts of speech in the context of reading, writing, and speaking: ○ more complex active and passive tenses and verbals (gerunds, infinitives, participles); ○ restrictive and nonrestrictive relative clauses; and ○ reciprocal pronouns (e.g., each other, one another); • identify and use the subjunctive mood to express doubts, wishes, and possibilities; • use a variety of correctly structured sentences (e.g., compound, complex, compound-complex). • use conventions of capitalization; • use correct punctuation marks including: ○ quotation marks to indicate sarcasm or irony; ○ comma placement in nonrestrictive phrases, clauses, and contrasting expressions; and ○ dashes to emphasize parenthetical information. • spell correctly, including using various resources to determine and check correct spellings.
10 th Grade	• use and understand the function of the following parts of speech in the context of reading, writing, and speaking: ○ more complex active and passive tenses and verbals (gerunds, infinitives, participles); ○ restrictive and nonrestrictive relative clauses; and ○ reciprocal pronouns (e.g., each other, one another); • identify and use the subjunctive mood to express doubts, wishes, and possibilities; and • use a variety of correctly structured sentences (e.g., compound, complex, compound-complex). • use conventions of capitalization; and • use correct punctuation marks including: ○ comma placement in nonrestrictive phrases, clauses, and contrasting expressions; ○ quotation marks to indicate sarcasm or irony; and ○ dashes to emphasize parenthetical information. • spell correctly, including using various resources to determine and check correct spellings.
11 th Grade	• use and understand the function of different types of clauses and phrases (e.g., adjectival, noun, adverbial clauses and phrases); and • use a variety of correctly structured sentences (e.g., compound, complex, compound-complex). • write legibly and use appropriate capitalization and punctuation conventions. • correctly and consistently use conventions of punctuation and capitalization. • spell correctly, including using various resources to determine and check correct spellings.
12 th Grade	• use and understand the function of different types of clauses and phrases (e.g., adjectival, noun, adverbial clauses and phrases); and • use a variety of correctly structured sentences (e.g., compound, complex, compound-complex). • write legibly and use appropriate capitalization and punctuation conventions. • correctly and consistently use conventions of punctuation and capitalization. • spell correctly, including using various resources to determine and check correct spellings.



ONE-CHUNK PARAGRAPH FORMULA/STRUCTURE

1) Cinderella feels
mistreated. 2) She does all
the cooking, cleaning, and
sewing by herself. 3) She has
no one to share her burdens.
4) She is treated like a second-
class citizen. 5) Cinderella is
taken for granted.

ONE-CHUNK PARAGRAPH WEAVING

1) Cinderella feels mistreated.
2) With no one to share her
burdens, she is doomed to do
all the cooking, cleaning, and
sewing by herself. 3) She is
treated like a second-class
citizen. 4) Cinderella is taken for
granted.



CINDERELLA, 5 VERSIONS

① Simplest Version, Formula, for Beginning ELL and Special Education Students and K-5 Beginning Instruction

Cinderella felt sad. For example, she did the cooking and cleaning by herself. She was lonely. She felt ignored. Cinderella was taken for granted.

② Simplest Version, Formula, for Upper ELL and Special Education Students and Grades 2-5

Cinderella felt mistreated. For example, she did the cooking and cleaning by herself. She had an empty space inside. She was treated unfairly. Cinderella was upset.

③ Medium Version, Formula

Cinderella felt mistreated. For example, she did all the cooking, cleaning, and sewing by herself. She had no one to share her burdens and saw only a lonely future. Treated like a second-class citizen, she did not exist to the others. Cinderella was taken for granted.

④ Advanced Version, Formula

Cinderella feels mistreated by an unfeeling and uncaring world. By the fire with no one to help, she does all the cooking, cleaning, and sewing by herself. Rejected by society, she has no one to share her burdens and faces a bleak future. She is pushed aside literally and metaphorically and treated as though she does not exist. Cinderella is used and abused by a system that has failed her.

⑤ Advanced, Weaving Version

Cinderella feels mistreated by an unfeeling and uncaring world. Pushed aside literally and metaphorically, she does all the cooking, cleaning, and sewing by herself. Society has rejected her, and she faces a bleak future as she sits alone by the fire. As her burdens consume her, she sees herself as a second-class citizen. Cinderella is treated as though she does not exist, abandoned by a system that has failed her.

Introduce

Title: Cinderella

Writing Prompt: The original “Cinderella” is a longstanding folk tale with origins dating to 1 B.C. The hundreds of versions of the story differ in details, but in most versions the story begins with a young woman who lives in poor and unfortunate conditions and among cruel and abusive people. However, the story ends with her realizing great fortune and happiness. In 1950, Walt Disney released Cinderella as an animated film which has become one of Disney’s classics. Please watch the Disney film. Then, in a one-chunk paragraph (1:2+), explain how Cinderella feels at the beginning of the story.

Title: “To Sleep under the Stars”

Author: Carol Shaw Graham

Writing Prompt: In the short story “to Sleep under the Stars,” a seventh grader named Cecilia experiences what many tweens have experienced: the desire to make one’s own decisions instead of following parents’ demands. Read the short story carefully. Then, write a one-chunk paragraph (1:2+) that discusses how Cecilia feels about her life in the first half of the story

Writing Prompt: In the short story “to Sleep under the Stars,” a seventh grader named Cecilia experiences what many tweens have experienced: the desire to make one’s own decisions instead of following parents’ demands. Read the short story carefully. Then, write a one-chunk paragraph (1:2+) that discusses how Cecilia feels about her life in the second half of the story.

Title: “Both Sides of the Fence”

Author: Teresa Bateman

Writing Prompt: One of the greatest lessons we learn is how to look at situations in our and others’ lives from different perspectives. Carefully read Teresa Bateman’s short story “Both Sides of the Fence.” Then, in a well written essay (two body paragraphs; one to two chunks each), discuss how Alberto’s feelings change toward his neighbor.

Title: “The Confrontation” (an excerpt from The Plum Pickers)

Author: Raymond Barrio

Writing Prompt: Justice and Injustice are subjects discussed in many literary works and are developed into themes by many authors. In “The Confrontation,” a migrant farm worker realizes his own worth. Read the excerpt carefully. Then, in a well-written essay (two, one-chunk body paragraphs; 1:2+), trace the protagonist’s realization.

PROMPT CONSTRUCTION

1. **Features of good prompts:**
 - a. written as statements, not questions.
 - b. quantifies the assignment (length and ratio)
 - c. uses a verb that fits your subject and the assignment (e.g., *discusses, comments on, explores, analyzes, interprets, evaluates, investigates, describes, explains, states, defines, summarizes*)
 - d. narrows the focus of the topic
2. **Model:** Write a one-chunk paragraph (1:2+) that discusses how Friar Laurence feels in the first half of the play.
4. **How to Test Your Prompts**
 - a. Do the T-chart.
 - b. Do a little more (webbing, first draft) if you think you need to.
5. **Sample prompts to discuss:**
 - a. Write an essay that analyzes bullying.
 - b. Science: Write a one-chunk 2+:1 paragraph that describes the process of natural selection and connect/apply it to real life.
 - c. Write a compare-contrast essay in which you explore the similarities and differences between two subjects of your choice.
 - d. Discuss the causes of the Civil War.
 - e. Write a one-chunk paragraph comparing and contrasting parallel and perpendicular lines.
 - f. Analyze the significance of the story of the Garden of Eden.

PROMPT WRITING PRACTICE

1. **Features of good prompts:**
 - a. **written as statements, not questions.**
 - b. **quantifies the assignment (length and ratio)**
 - c. **uses a verb that fits your subject and the assignment (e.g., *discusses, comments on, explores, analyzes, interprets, evaluates, investigates, describes, explains, states, defines, summarizes*)**
 - d. **narrows the focus of the topic**

2. **Write a _____ that _____**

_____.

3. **Write a _____ that _____**

_____.

4. **Write a _____ that _____**

_____.

Writing Prompts

Instructions: Write prompts with the following ingredients:

- 1-3 background sentences that start the students thinking (Aristotle called this the Occasion for writing or speaking – engage the students’ thinking from the start)
- Either name your Audience or use diction in your prompt that implies the level of sophistication expected. Talk with your students about how writers select words based on the audience they are attempting to reach;
- A trigger sentence or stem (Read the passage carefully, Write a well-developed essay that . . .
- Purpose (Jane’s verbs – explains = expository; persuades = persuasive; tells a story = narrative; analyzes = literary analysis, style analysis, research, etc.; describes the process (lab) = description
- Length (# of paragraphs, words, pages –)
- Scope (chunks in paragraphs / ratio; some teachers give ranges – 1-3 chunks per paragraph)
- Formatting Expectations - typed or handwritten, MLA, font and size

After you have read some sample prompts in the following pages, take the one sentence you wrote on the previous page and now make an elaborated prompt that includes the above suggestions:

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Course	Prompt Designer(s)	Title	Author	Prompt
English I	Brian Sira	<i>Tangerine</i>	Edward Bloor	In Edward Bloor's <i>Tangerine</i> , the narrator portrays two communities: Lake Windsor Downs and Tangerine. Though these two communities share many commonalities, they are also very different from one another.
English I	Carla Taddeo			In a well-developed (minimum of 2 chunks) literary analysis (1:2+), compare and contrast Paul's community (Lake Windsor Downs) with Victor's community (Tangerine). Be sure to focus on the residents, their behaviors and attitudes, family relationships, and economic differences.
		<i>To Kill a Mockingbird</i>	Harper Lee	We often think of the definition of prejudice as being the negative judgment of a person of one race against another race. Prejudice however, exists whenever there is intolerance of differences among people. In the literary work, <i>To Kill a Mockingbird</i> by Harper Lee, many types of prejudice are presented. In at least a 2 chunk paragraph (1:2+), discuss two other types of prejudice (other than racism) shown in the novel.
English I	Kim Moore	<i>The Tragedy of Romeo and Juliet</i>	William Shakespeare	In William Shakespeare's tragedy, <i>Romeo and Juliet</i> , a long standing feud exists between the two families, the Capulets and the Montagues. Using a 2 chunk literary response paragraph (1:2+), compare and contrast the feud between these two families to the specter of gang violence that exists today.
		"The Lady or the Tiger" by Frank Stockton; "The Lottery" by Shirley Jackson; "The Necklace" by Guy de Maupassant		In life, people face difficult situations that force them to make tough decisions. In the short stories "The Lady or the Tiger," "The Lottery" and "The Necklace," the reader learns about the consequences that an individual's choices can have. Each protagonist's fate is negatively affected by the decisions that he or she makes. Write a multi-paragraph literary analysis (1:2+) with one chunk per body paragraph in which you discuss the detrimental, unwelcomed consequences that each choice brings to the lover, Tessie Hutchinson and Madame Loisel, respectively. Explain the other options these people had and how drastically they would have changed the character's fates.

Course	Prompt Designer(s)	Title	Author	Prompt
English I	Susan Hayles	<i>The Odyssey</i>	Homer	<u>Prompt:</u>
				In Homer's ancient epic, The Odyssey, the hero Odysseus faces numerous adventures during his voyage from Troy to Ithaca. He is challenged by supernatural beings, by nature, by monsters, and by greedy interlopers. These fantastic exploits provide readers with more than exciting narratives. Each adventure symbolizes challenges that man faces today.
				<u>Write:</u>
				Plan and write a multi-paragraph essay on challenges Odysseus faces during his travels and their relevance to readers today. Describe at least three challenges and cite and explain examples of what each challenge symbolizes in man's struggles today as he travels his own odyssey through life.
				In each body paragraph you will begin with a topic sentence. Then provide a chunk of literary analysis (1:2+) and a chunk of exposition (2+:1). In the literary analysis section, cite one challenge Odysseus faces during his travels and analyze its significance to the epic as a whole. The expository chunk will consist of an incident or situation in our contemporary society that compares with the challenge faced by Odysseus.
				End with a concluding sentence.
				<u>What your Essay Should Look Like:</u>
				Introduction (with engaging "hook" and a well-crafted thesis)
				Body Paragraph 1 – First adventure
				TS (Topic Sentence)
				LTCD (Lead-in/Transitional as a part of the CD 1—quotation from text)
				CM
				CM
				Transition
				CD (CD 2—example from contemporary society)
				CM
				CM
				CS (Concluding Sentence)
				Body Paragraph 2 – Second adventure
				Body Paragraph 3 – Third adventure
				Conclusion

Course	Prompt Designer(s)	Title	Author	Prompt
English II	Kristin Brownell, Kassidy Harper, Scott Tarlton	<i>All Quiet on the Western Front</i>	Erich Maria Remarque	During World War I, nurses and orderlies often helped wounded soldiers through days and sometimes long weeks of recovery before returning to the front lines or going home. Being in close proximity to the soldiers, hospital attendants were often able to understand how the war affected the soldiers' lives physically and emotionally. Pretend that you are either a nurse or an orderly in World War I and discuss in a multi-paragraph essay with one to two-chunk paragraphs (1:2+) how the war affected three characters from Erich Maria Remarque's novel, <i>All Quiet on the Western Front</i> .
English II	Kristin Brownell, Kassidy Harper, Scott Tarlton	<i>Three Titles - Student Selection</i>	Varies	Throughout literary history, authors have made important statements about the nature of society and mankind. These universal themes exist in what are considered to be works of classic literature. It is this idea of universality that allows people to relate to literature from different cultures and historical periods. Occasionally, readers even discover something about themselves while reading the stories of others. In a multi- paragraph essay with two to three chunk (1:2+) paragraphs, discuss the theme of _____ in three works we read this semester.
English II	Kristin Brownell, Kassidy Harper, Scott Tarlton	<i>Oedipus Rex</i>	Sophocles	The Greek philosopher Aristotle's definition of a tragic hero includes a character of high esteem whose personal flaw leads to his eventual downfall. Oedipus, the central character in Sophocles' play <i>Oedipus Rex</i> (400 B.C.) is a classic example of a tragic hero. Discuss what makes Oedipus a tragic hero in an essay with three chunk (1:2+) paragraphs.

Course	Prompt Designer(s)	Title	Author	Prompt
English II	Cindy Hellmich	<i>Lord of the Flies</i>	William Golding	* Answer one of the following essay prompts from the <i>Lord of the Flies</i> based on the literal level of what happens to a group of boys stranded on an island with no adult supervision. Or, based on a symbolic level investigating what happens to civilized people when the structures of civilization disappear.
				* Develop a well-thought out, multi-paragraph essay using a 3-chunk format for each body paragraph which includes 1 concrete detail (CD) to 2+ commentary statements (CM). Begin with a topic sentence (TS) and end with a concluding sentence (CS). The format for each body paragraph should look like this:
				* TS; CD/CM/CM; CD/CM/CM; CD/CM/CM; CS - 3 chunks of information between the topic sentence and the concluding sentence.
				* Paper should be between 850-1000 words.
				* Essay must be written in MLA format: 12-point font; double-spaced; header w/pagination; original title; indent paragraphs.
				* Include a thesis statement in your introduction, and background information which investigates ideas that follow your prompt and my serve as your topic sentences in each subsequent paragraph. Textual evidence, plot references, and examples (CD), should illustrate your ideas through supporting details, such as a character's feelings, reasons why he acts the way he does based on inference, your interpretation, evaluation, or insight (CM) with regard to the situation of the boys' being stranded on the island without adult supervision. You may include lead-in commentary as you present your evidence, and transitions between the chunks of information. Finish with a conclusion that restates your thesis, summarizes the main points in each body paragraph, states what you have learned from your analysis, and closes with a final thought that may make your reader ponder your ideas.
				* No personal pronouns will be used in formal writing to convey your point.

Course	Prompt Designer(s)	Title	Author	Prompt
				As a result of the plane crash, a group of boys from England become stranded on an island. The pilot and any adults are presumed dead. One of the older boys, Ralph is elected leader and designates duties to be performed by the boys in order to be rescued. Jack hunts for food and neglects his assigned duties. Dissension develops between Ralph and Jack and both want to be the leader of the boys on the island. Additionally, the boy, Piggy, is important because he wears thick glasses that serve to keep a fire going on the island in hopes of attracting a rescue. However, Piggy is fat. Soon the boys begin to reject Piggy just because he is an easy target for them to pick on.
				1. Based on your decision to choose sides of either Ralph or Jack before reading the novel, compare and contrast these two characters.. Consider their personalities, motivations and relationships. Align your point of view to show who was the better leader? What motivated each of them? What kind of relationship did they have with the others? How were their views on life and leadership similar or different. Use examples from the text to support your response. If you chose to act as the audience of adult judges, and other authority figures, take a stand for one character or the other in your comparison.
				1.2. Based on your predisposition to represent Ralph, Jack, or the audience of adult judges, evaluate how the novel would have changed if there had also been an adult or several adults on the island. Rewrite a portion or portions of the novel, adding a character or characters to illustrate the effect these adults might have ultimately had on the novel. Consider some of the signs that appear, albeit unnoticed by the boys, of their eagerness to have adult intervention, such as keeping the fire going on the mountain top.
				1.3. Write a journal from Ralph, Piggy, or Jack's point of view about what has been happening on the island. A minimum of ten entries should be included in the journal. Entries should focus on major events in the character's life and how he response to each event. Remember, you are Ralph, Piggy, or Jack while you are writing in this journal. Finally, create a unique cover for the journal depicting a scene from the novel. Be sure to reflect the feelings of the writer as they affect the emotional response of the reader. Help the reader to hear the voice of the character in the reader's head supplying the emotional appeal of the writer of the journal.

Course	Prompt Designer(s)	Title	Author	Prompt
English III	Robin Myers-Li	<i>The Adventures of Huckleberry Finn</i>	Mark Twain	In the novel, <i>The Adventures of Huckleberry Finn</i>, Huck is faced with a moral dilemma when he has to choose between turning Jim, the runaway slave, into authorities, as required by law, or protecting him from authorities. Write a 5 paragraph essay that compares and contrasts Huck Finn's moral dilemma with a dilemma you faced in your own life. Introduction: Discuss the definition of moral dilemma, Huck Finn's moral dilemma, and your moral dilemma. In your thesis statement, discuss that you are comparing and contrast the two moral dilemmas. Body Paragraph #1: Compare Huck Finn's dilemma (1:2+) and your dilemma (2+:1). Body Paragraph #2: Contrast Huck Finn's dilemma (1:2+) and your dilemma (2+:1). Body Paragraph #3: Discuss Huck Finn's choice (1:2+) and your choice. Discuss if you agree with Huck Finn's choice and if you feel you made the right choice and why (2+:1). Conclusion: Restate your thesis. Summarize your ideas in the three body paragraphs. Personal/reflective sentence. 1. It was never so uncivilized to be 'sivilized'. In a 1-2 chunk (1:2+) literary analysis, explain how this statement is true in Mark Twain's novel, <i>The Adventures of Huckleberry Finn</i>. Consider 'sivilized' society's views of slaves, in addition to Huck's changing attitude towards Jim as they sail down the Mississippi River. 2. Despite all of its literary acclaim, many critics of <i>The Adventures of Huckleberry Finn</i> argue in support of Huck's failure to overcome the racial hegemony underlying the novel. These critics often refer to the final episode, or the evasion chapters, as evidence that Huck loses any credibility of ever having learned the value of Jim's humanity. Write a 1-2 chunk (1:2+) literary analysis that counters the critics' claims against Huck, and asserts the notion that Huck truly does mature through his newfound understanding of Jim's humanity. 1. Even though Fitzgerald has titled his novel, <i>The Great Gatsby</i>, explain in a 1-2 chunk (1:2+) literary analysis how the story has really been about Nick Carraway and his educational process. As you prepare to write, consider the reasons behind Nick's decision to return home last autumn, as well as Gatsby's role in helping Nick to accurately judge his time in the East. 2. Choose a character from <i>The Great Gatsby</i> and explain in a 1-2 chunk (1:2+) literary analysis how he/she personifies one of the three motifs listed below: a. Materialism and idealism in America b. The perversion of the American Dream c. Appearance vs. Reality In his essay, "Tragedy and the Common Man," Arthur Miller argues "It is time, I think, that we who are without kings took up this bright thread of our history and followed it to the only place it can possibly lead in our time--the heart and spirit of the average man." According to Miller, the common/average man is as apt a subject for tragedy as kings. In a 1-2 chunk (2+:1) persuasive essay, argue the case for Willy Loman's status as a tragic figure.
English III	Nic Lim, Rayleen Downes, Teresa Griffin, Nick Woods	<i>The Adventures of Huckleberry Finn</i>	Mark Twain	
English III	Nic Lim, Rayleen Downes, Teresa Griffin, Nick Woods	<i>The Great Gatsby</i>	F. Scott Fitzgerald	
English III	Nic Lim, Rayleen Downes, Teresa Griffin, Nick Woods	<i>Death of a Salesman</i>	Arthur Miller	

Course	Prompt Designer(s)	Title	Author	Prompt
				Writing Situation: Written in the aftermath of WWII and during the early years of the Cold War, an era (1950's – 1960's) in which many people were concerned about the devastating effects of nuclear weapons, Nevil Shute's novel <i>On the Beach</i> depicts a world in which human beings have been destroyed by nuclear force. The central irony of the plot is that humans have been destroyed rather than saved by their own technology. This central irony serves as a warning to people of all decades.
				Prompt #1: In 5 - 7 paragraphs (1:2+) and 2-3 chunks in each paragraph, write a literary analysis of 1000 words that reveals Nevil Shute's theme, the dehumanization of mankind, as evidenced through the characters' relationships with machines and technology.
English IV	Patricia Angus	<i>On the Beach</i>	Nevil Shute	Prompt #2: In 5 - 7 paragraphs (1:2+) and 2-3 chunks in each paragraph, write an essay of 1000 words that explains how Nevil Shute's nature imagery sets the tone of this science fiction novel, <i>On the Beach</i> .
				Prompt# 3: In a novel or play, a <i>confidant</i> (male) or a <i>confidante</i> (female) is a character, often a friend or relative, whose role is to be present when that character needs a sympathetic listener to confide in. Frequently, the result is, as Henry James remarked, that the <i>confidant</i> or <i>confidante</i> can be as much "the reader's friend as the protagonist's." However, the author sometimes uses this character for other purposes as well.
				Choose a <i>confidant</i> or <i>confidante</i> from Nevil Shute's <i>On the Beach</i> , and in 5 - 7 paragraphs (1:2+) and 2-3 chunks in each paragraph, write an essay of 1000 words that discusses the various ways this character functions in the novel.
English IV	Asya Dadabhoy	<i>The Tragedy of Macbeth</i>	William Shakespeare	Supernatural beings are portrayed in some pieces of literature as being harbingers of misfortune. In the drama <i>The Tragedy of Macbeth</i> , by William Shakespeare, the Weird Sisters are supernatural beings that trigger Macbeth's desire to become the King of Scotland. In a multi-paragraph essay (one to three chunk (1:2+) paragraphs) discuss the tone or mood the supernatural occurrences create and how they contribute to the themes in <i>The Tragedy of Macbeth</i> .
English IV Resource	Jill Hollerbach	<i>On the Beach</i>	Nevil Shute	On the Beach is a 1950's novel which, uncharacteristic of that period in history pessimistically predicts our future. Write a multi-paragraph literary analysis (1:2+) that argues the significance of the novel in today's world. Each paragraph must include a topic sentence, two-three chunks, and a concluding sentence.

“Through the Tunnel” By Doris Lessing

Adolescence is a time during which children begin to break away from the safe and nurturing environment of their parents’ care and break out in a world of independence and challenge. This type of “coming of age” idealism is evident throughout the short story, “Through the Tunnel,” by Doris Lessing, in which she depicts a young boy’s struggle to overcome his fears. One technique that Lessing uses to characterize her protagonist’s plight is symbolism. Symbolism refers to the meaning attributed to tangible objects (for our purposes) used to represent ideas or qualities. In a **two-chunk paragraph (1:2+)**, analyze how the young man’s change from innocence to maturity is depicted through two symbols.

Steps in the writing process:

1. Read & decode the prompt.
2. Read the story, underlining examples in the text (CDs) in red pen.
3. Make annotations (CMs) in the margins in green pen. Answer “What is the effect of this CD?”
4. Gather CDs, and then choose the strongest CDs. Focus on which ones best answer the prompt.
5. Complete a T-chart.
 - a. Focus on embedding direct quotations in CDs with proper punctuation and no CM mixed in with the lead-in.
 - b. Focus on insightful CM that (a) does not contain paraphrase, (b) comments directly on the CD provided, and (c) supports the TS.
6. Complete a shaping sheet. Revise for transitions, repetition, and word choice.
7. Type a rough draft in MLA format.
8. Teacher gives feedback.
9. Revise & submit a final draft in color to turnitin.com. Submit all pre-writing to your teacher.

	A-Day	B-Day
Rough draft due in class		
Final draft due by 10pm on turnitin.com		

Response to Literature Essay

Unit 4: Theme

The themes of a short story can be developed using a variety of literary methods. Authors may choose to use imagery, symbolism, characters, irony, or other techniques to make clear the message or theme they want to express to the reader. Choose one of the short stories listed below that we have read this year. Read the story carefully, and identify the main theme and the literary techniques used by the author. **Then, in a well-organized (1:2+) multi-paragraph essay, analyze the author's use of literary elements to explore a specific theme in the story.**

Choose one of the following short stories from Units 1-4:

- "Harrison Bergeron" by Kurt Vonnegut Jr.
- "Everyday Use" by Alice Walker
- "Searching for Summer" by Joan Aiken
- "Shoofly Pie" by Naomi Shihab Nye
- "The Possibility of Evil" by Shirley Jackson
- "Two Friends" by Guy de Maupassant

I. Parts of the Essay

- a. Creative Title
- b. Introduction paragraph with thesis statement as the last sentence
- c. A minimum of 3 well-developed body paragraphs (2-3 chunks for each paragraph; 1:2+ ratio)
 - i. Concrete Details (CD) - Embedded quotations with MLA citations
 - ii. Commentary (CM) – Connecting the CD and TS, showing insightful analysis
- d. Conclusion paragraph
- e. Works Cited page in MLA format

II. Length and Format of the Essay

- a. 3 to 4 typed pages, not including the Works Cited page.
- b. MLA formatted header; font must be "Times New Roman," size 12.
- c. Margins – 1" top, bottom, left, right
- d. Double-space the whole essay – no extra spaces between paragraphs

III. Point of View: The paper must be written in third person-objective point of view. First and second person pronouns are unacceptable in a formal project such as this.

IV. The Process

- a. I must be able to observe the student's planning on a daily basis in order to accept and evaluate the final draft. Observing the process assures me of a student's personal involvement.
- b. Prewriting will include gathering CD's, T-Chart, and Shaping Sheet for at least one body paragraph prior to submitting the final draft and Works Cited.
- c. Work which (1) I have not seen in progress, (2) fails to meet length requirement, or (3) is submitted without prewriting or drafts will not be graded.

V. Due Dates

- Pre-writing (Gathering CDs, T-chart, Shaping Sheet) for at least one paragraph due _____ in class
- Rough draft due **to turnitin.com** by midnight on **December 18** (Printed copy in class on _____)
- Final draft due **to turnitin.com** by midnight on _____.

STAGES IN THE TEACHING SEQUENCE OF WRITING

Argumentation, Expository / Informational, Narrative, Response to Literature

1.	Teacher Model “Guided Writing” “I Do”	➤ Teacher gives the class a completed example--from the writing prompt to the prewriting to the shaping to the final draft. ➤ Equipment and Materials: ○ hard graphic organizers and pens for each student and teacher (students copy as teacher presents each step and the thinking behind each step) ○ hard copy of the model from start to finish for all students (give this clean copy of all steps after the students copy and submit for grade) ○ chalkboard, dry erase board, interactive whiteboard, or document camera ○ if digital, use Google Docs, JSWP App, BYOD, laptop, digital graphic organizers ➤ Assessment: Credit is given for copying precisely the model either on paper or digitally; ▪ on-task behavior, focus ▪ asking questions, clarification ▪ color-coding correctly ▪ correct grammar, mechanics, usage
2.	Class Collaborative “Shared Writing” “We Do”	➤ The teacher and the students write collaboratively in class. ➤ The teacher guides a thoughtful and multimedia discussion. Shared resources. ➤ Everyone is writing on the same, specific topic. Mutual goal. ➤ Equipment and Materials: see above (no model; hard copies or digital graphic organizers) ➤ Assessment ○ Everyone offers two comments for each part of the process through the final draft. ○ Teacher frequently assesses individuals and group (definitions, colors, purpose) ○ Group processing after each step in the process: “reflecting on the group’s work to clarify and improve the effectiveness of the members in working together to achieve the group’s goals by (a) describing what member actions were helpful and unhelpful and (b) making decisions about what actions to continue or change” (Johnson, et.al). ○ Everyone submits entire process (after each step).
3.	Small Group “Shared Writing” “You Do Together”	➤ Students write in pairs. Use same materials as “We Do.” Analog* only. ➤ Promotive interaction: “Students promote each other’s learning by helping, sharing, and encouraging efforts to learn. Students explain, discuss, and teach what they know to classmates. Teachers structure the groups so that students sit knee-to-knee and talk through each aspect of the assignment” (Johnson, Johnson, & Holubec). ➤ Interpersonal and small group skills: leadership, decision-making, trust-building, communication, conflict management ➤ Assessment: Combining individual accountability with positive interdependence ○ Teacher evaluates ▪ Content – Individual accountability • CDs – list CDs separately; then decide best one(s) together • CMs – list CMs separately; then create sentences together • Student 1 – TS; Student 2 – CS ▪ Interpersonal dynamics and 12-inch voices ○ Each student self-evaluates (positive comments; critique for improvement)
4.	Independent Writing “I Do”	➤ Provide rubric with prompt before process begins ➤ Each student completes the process from start to finish ➤ Publish on walls or in clouds ➤ Assessment – See rubric

*Analog will be used in this document to mean anything not digital

ENGLISH LANGUAGE ARTS

Steps in Writing the One-Chunk Response to Literature Paragraph Ratio 1:2+

You will be doing a one-chunk paragraph on the following prompt:

Write a one-chunk paragraph (1:2+) that discusses how Cecilia feels about her life in the first half of the story (up to the ride to Gran's).

- ☐ Step 1: Read and annotate the text.

- ☐ Step 2: Gather the CDs and CMs.

- ☐ Step 3: Write your topic sentence in BLUE on your T-chart.
- ☐ Step 4: Copy your CM1 and CM2 ideas to the T-chart in GREEN in the right order.
- ☐ Step 5: On your 1st CM webbing page, copy your CM1 word in the middle circle in GREEN. Then Web off the Word and write your CM1 sentence in GREEN at the bottom, using any ideas from your web.

"To Sleep Under the Stars"

Carol Shaw Graham

"But Mom, everybody's going."

"Cecilia, you know that isn't true. All 300 kids in the 7th grade cannot be going." Cecilia's mother looked across the kitchen at her. "And I truly am sorry---but this is the only weekend your father has off until after Christmas. We're going to your Grandmother's. This is very important, Cecilia. Uncle Frank and Aunt Ellen have been taking care of Grandma ever since her surgery, but we need to help out too. There will be other class trips. This time, family has to come first."

"But . . ." Cecilia searched quickly for another reason to stay home.

"Cecilia. I'm disappointed in you. It is time to be unselfish." Her mother turned sadly back to the sink.

Cecilia slowly left the kitchen and wandered out to the porch. "It's not fair," she thought. "My first class trip. I really wanted to see the planetarium." She flopped into a chair and gave herself up to self-pity.

Cecilia was still unhappy when the time came to head for Grandma's. The three-hour trip took the family east through beautiful farmland and several small towns. Usually Cecilia enjoyed the ride, but this time she didn't. Her friends were on a bus heading three hours west towards the Bay City Planetarium.

Grandma looked tired, but she was so happy to see them that Cecilia felt a little better. "Stay and keep me company," requested Grandma when Cecilia's parents went to unpack. "You've grown so tall since the summer!" Grandma exclaimed. "Sit down here next to me ---I'm getting a crick in my neck looking up at you! Now tell me, where do you buy the beauty cream you must put on your face every night? I need some!"

Cecilia laughed. "Oh, Grandma. You're just saying that."

Grandma smiled. "You are getting so grown-up and so busy. I've missed you. Your mother told me about your report card. Almost all A's! That's wonderful. What is your favorite subject this year?"

"Science, I guess. We're doing astronomy."

"I loved astronomy. The stars are fascinating. I still love to look up at the sky and find the constellations."

"Really? Maybe I inherited it from you," said Cecilia. "I wish I could sleep out under the stars. Mom says I'd freeze!"

Gran smiled. "I know a way you can sleep under the stars every night and still be warm. Help me down the hall to my room."

Cecilia gently helped Gran stand. She seemed so frail. Together they slowly walked to Gran's bedroom. Gran sank into the little chair in the corner with a sigh.

"Are you all right?" Cecilia asked anxiously.

"I'm feeling stronger every day! Now open the cedar chest there."

Cecilia lifted the heavy lid, and then turned to Gran. "What's in here, Gran?" she asked.

"Memories. Your mother's baby shoes, a curl from your first haircut---all sorts of things." Cecilia pulled out items one by one, and Gran told their stories. They laughed and cried and Cecilia learned about her family. Finally, Cecilia pulled out a big, cloth-wrapped bundle.

"A quilt! Oh Gran, did you make it?"

"A long time ago. When I was in high school, my mother became ill. The doctor sent her to the desert to avoid the cold winter weather. I went with her---I had to miss a year of high school. I was so disappointed at first. The teachers sent me work through the mail, but I missed all the fun. But in the desert, I discovered that the stars seem to jump out of the sky. My mother and I worked this quilt that winter." She shook the quilt open over her lap. White stars shone out of a dark blue background. A pearly moon hung in the corner.

"Gran, it's beautiful," said Cecilia, smoothing the quilt. "There's Orion's belt---and Cassiopeia."

"We put all my favorites in. My mother and I really enjoyed those times together. I learned that winter how important family is. Now I want to pass the quilt on to you."

Cecilia wrapped her arms around Grandma. "Oh, Gran. Thank you!" she said. "I'm so glad I came to see you, and I'll love the quilt forever."

GATHERING CDS AND CMS ONE-CHUNK RESPONSE TO LITERATURE PARAGRAPHS

PROMPT: _____

GATHERING CDS:

Think of 3 or more CDs that would fit the prompt and write them below. Then circle the one CD you think is the best.

-
-
-
-
-

GATHERING CMS:

Now brainstorm 5 or more CMs you can for your CD and write them below. Then pick the biggest, most important thought and label it *TS* in blue. Next, label the 2 best CM thoughts in green as *CM1* and *CM2*. It may make it easier for you to use one of these CM helpers:

- _____ feels ___ on the inside.
- _____ feels like _____.
- Why does the character do this?
-
-
-
-
-
-



CD Analysis **(How to Generate Commentary)**

1. Why is this CD important (to the story/to the TS)?
2. What does the CD show (in terms of the story/ in terms of the TS)?
3. Tell me more about that...
4. The character feels _____ on the inside. (List as many words as possible.)
5. Using the thesaurus, find synonyms for the words you listed above.
6. Describe in your own words what it means to feel like that.
7. Have you ever felt _____? What was it like? What caused it? Can you make a comparison between how you felt and how the character feels?
8. What does it mean for the character to feel _____? Is it a change from how he or she used to be on the inside? What might that mean to the character?
9. What is the character trying to feel by speaking these particular words or by taking this action? Why do you think he or she might want that?
10. Is the character being influenced by anyone or trying to influence anyone?
11. What moral or ethical strength or weakness is the character exhibiting in this moment?
12. What strong connotative/feeling words does the author use in this quote? What images and ideas come to mind when you think of those words? How might those words shed some light on the character's current state of mind?
13. Defend your choice of CD. Why is it a good CD? Why is it perfect for this paragraph?



Learning the CM Questioning Process

Gather CDs together as a class or provide students with appropriate CDs for the lesson.

Asking questions about each CD generates commentary and teaches students how to analyze CDs.

Students have an easier time generating commentary about concrete details that show action. CDs that show action also typically make the best CD choices within a paragraph. However, for this exercise, you can analyze all different kinds of concrete details.

Example of a Concrete Detail about Winnie Foster from Chapter 3 in *Tuck Everlasting*

“Winnie had found some pebbles at the base of the fence and, for lack of any other way to show how she felt, had flung one at the toad” (13).

Commentary Questions

“Winnie had found some pebbles at the base of the fence and, for lack of any other way to show how she felt, had flung one at the toad” (13).

- What does it show that Winnie flung pebbles at the toad?
- Is it worse “to throw” or “to fling” a stone? Why?
- How do you think Winnie feels?
- What does it show about Winnie that she “lack[s] any other way to show how she felt” except to fling a stone at a toad?

Commentary Questions with Sample Responses

“Winnie had found some pebbles at the base of the fence and, for lack of any other way to show how she felt, had flung one at the toad” (13).

- What does it show that Winnie flung pebbles at the toad? She’s frustrated, annoyed, bored, mad, not satisfied with her life
Follow-up question: Why might she have those feelings? She has nothing to do; she’s stuck behind a fence; no one to confide in; lonely
- Is it worse “to throw” or “to fling” a stone? Why? Flinging connotes that she does not care; she’s not trying to hurt the toad, she’s doing it absentmindedly – like “whatever . . .”



Follow-up questions: So what does that show about Winnie? That she doesn't want to really hurt the toad; she's just in a bad mood

Why else might she fling stones at the frog? She's jealous he's outside the fence; his freedom upsets her

· How do you think Winnie feels? Unhappy, dissatisfied, confined, envious

Follow-up questions: How do you know? Flinging stones is something kids do when they are passing time, not focused, or bored; it is a way to let off steam without much effort; it is also a petulant act toward a creature that did nothing to her, revealing her inner conflict of some kind; she must be bothered about something or unhappy

Explain "unhappy" more; what is that like? Nothing is right; the world isn't what I want; no joy; no good energy; it feels heavy

· What does it show about Winnie that she "lack[s] any other way to show how she felt" except to fling a stone at a toad? She's childish/immature; isn't able to fully understand how she feels; she's limited; she can't express her complicated feelings in words

Follow-up question: Have you ever been unable to show or explain how you felt? What was that like? Frustrating, confusing, unsettling, stuck, didn't know what to do

PREWRITING FOR RESPONSE TO LITERATURE

RATIO: 1:2+

1. Write your topic sentence here:



2. Complete the following T-chart:

CDs
What does the character do? What happens in the story?

CMs
_____ feels/felt ____.
_____ feels/felt like a ____.
Why...?

•

• CM1:

• CM2:

WEB OFF THE WORD™

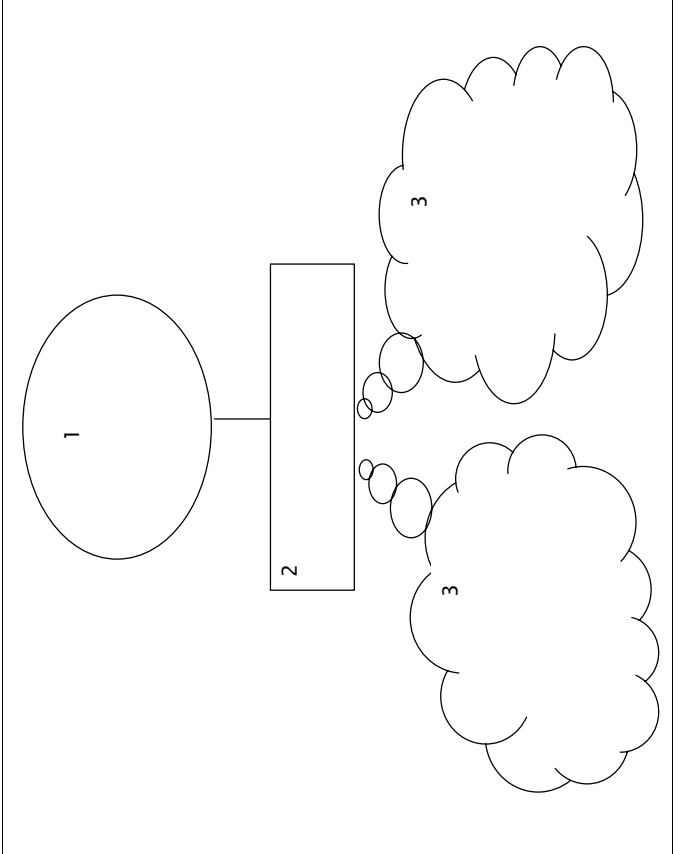
Commentary Sentences

Sequence to fill out the Web off the Word page:

1. In the #1 circle in the middle, copy the *CM* idea from your T-chart.
2. In the #2 box, write down a synonym for the #1 word. This can be a single word or a short phrase.
3. In the #3 clouds, write down phrases.
 - Phrases are 2 or more “meaty” words.
 - Remember not to include any concrete details.
 - To help you think of phrases, ask yourself, “What does it mean to the character to _____?”
4. Create your *CM* sentence, using one or more ideas from your web.

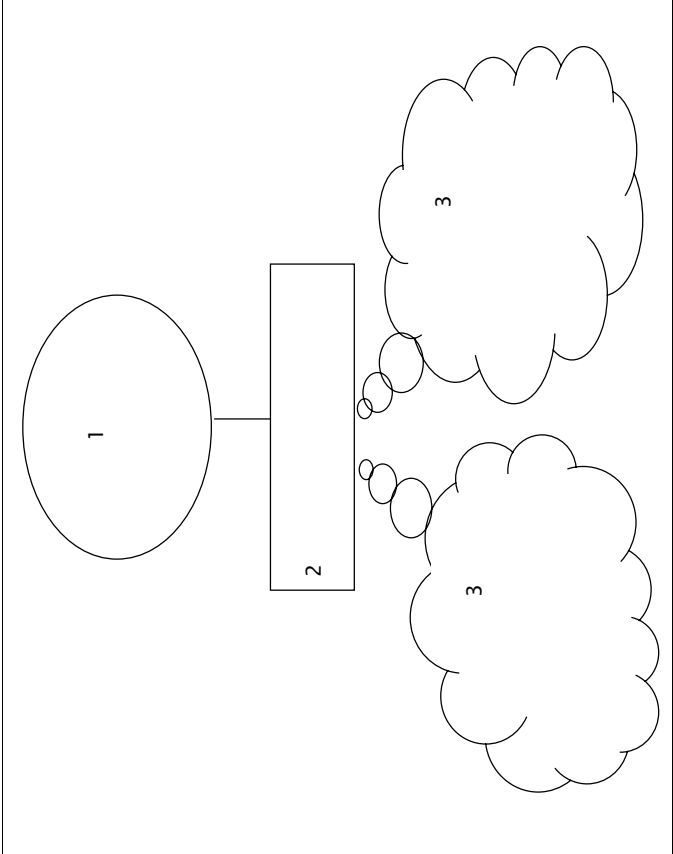
WEB OFF THE WORD™
1st COMMENTARY SENTENCE

CD: _____



CM #1: _____

WEB OFF THE WORD™
2nd COMMENTARY SENTENCE



CM #2: _____

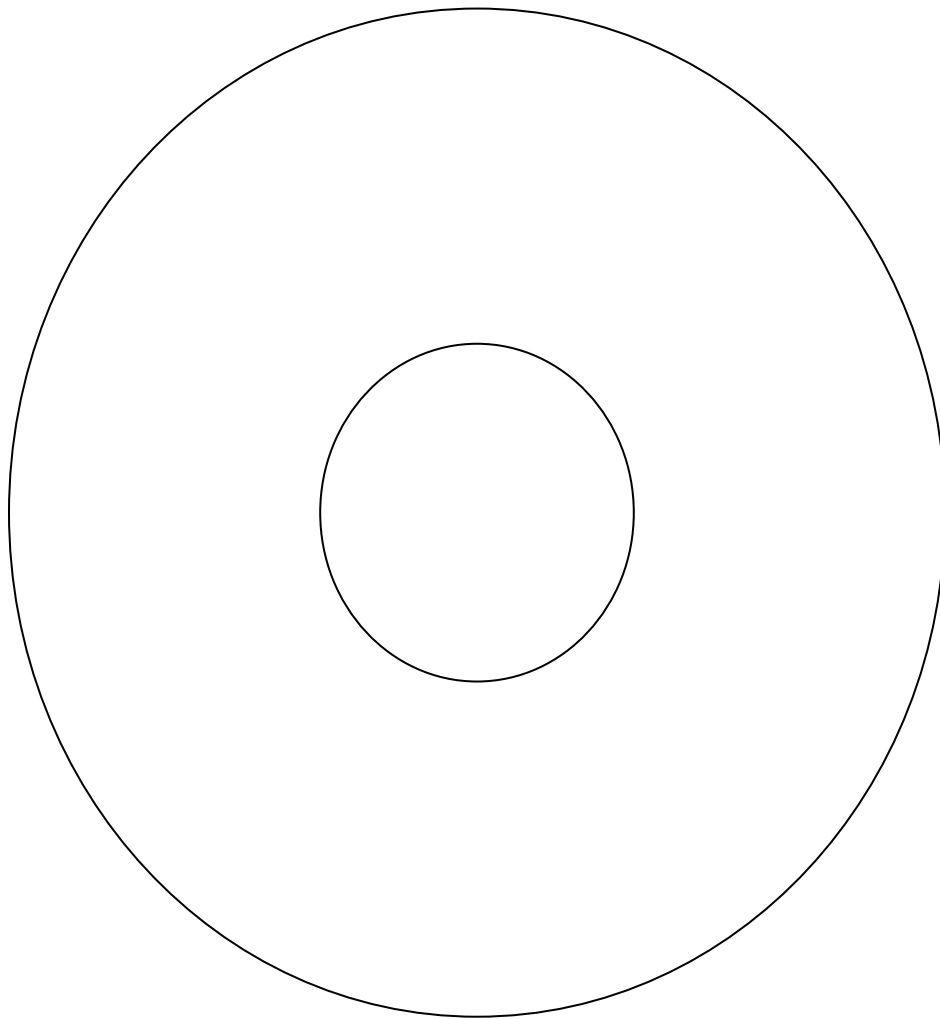
WEB OFF THE TOPIC SENTENCE TO CREATE THE CONCLUDING SENTENCE

Sequence to fill out the Web off the Topic Sentence page:

1. In the circle in the middle, copy the CM idea(s) from your topic sentence.
2. Think of 3 or 4 ideas for your web. These can be single words or short phrases.
3. Remember not to include any concrete details. To help you think of ideas, ask yourself, "What does it mean to the character to _____?"
4. Create your concluding sentence, using one or more ideas from your web. The only thing you can't use is the idea in the middle circle since you've already written that in your topic sentence.

WEB OFF THE WORD™

Web Off the Topic Sentence for the Concluding Sentence



CS: _____

The diagram illustrates the structure of an analytical paragraph, organized into five distinct sections from top to bottom:

- TS** (Topic Sentence): Represented by an inverted trapezoid shape.
- CD** (Concrete Detail): Represented by a rectangle shape.
- 1ST CM** (1st Commentary): Represented by an oval shape.
- 2ND CM** (2nd Commentary): Represented by an oval shape.
- CS** (Concluding Sentence): Represented by a trapezoid shape.

Each section contains a label on the left and a corresponding shape with the section name centered inside it.

PARAGRAPH FORM

[illegible]

STAGES IN THE TEACHING SEQUENCE OF WRITING

Argumentation, Expository / Informational, Narrative, Response to Literature

1.	Teacher Model “Guided Writing” “I Do”	➤ Teacher gives the class a completed example--from the writing prompt to the prewriting to the shaping to the final draft. ➤ Equipment and Materials: ○ hard graphic organizers and pens for each student and teacher (students copy as teacher presents each step and the thinking behind each step) ○ hard copy of the model from start to finish for all students (give this clean copy of all steps after the students copy and submit for grade) ○ chalkboard, dry erase board, interactive whiteboard, or document camera ○ if digital, use Google Docs, JSWP App, BYOD, laptop, digital graphic organizers ➤ Assessment: Credit is given for copying precisely the model either on paper or digitally; ▪ on-task behavior, focus ▪ asking questions, clarification ▪ color-coding correctly ▪ correct grammar, mechanics, usage
2.	Class Collaborative “Shared Writing” “We Do”	➤ The teacher and the students write collaboratively in class. ➤ The teacher guides a thoughtful and multimedia discussion. Shared resources. ➤ Everyone is writing on the same, specific topic. Mutual goal. ➤ Equipment and Materials: see above (no model; hard copies or digital graphic organizers) ➤ Assessment ○ Everyone offers two comments for each part of the process through the final draft. ○ Teacher frequently assesses individuals and group (definitions, colors, purpose) ○ Group processing after each step in the process: “reflecting on the group’s work to clarify and improve the effectiveness of the members in working together to achieve the group’s goals by (a) describing what member actions were helpful and unhelpful and (b) making decisions about what actions to continue or change” (Johnson, et.al). ○ Everyone submits entire process (after each step).
3.	Small Group “Shared Writing” “You Do Together”	➤ Students write in pairs. Use same materials as “We Do.” Analog* only. ➤ Promotive interaction: “Students promote each other’s learning by helping, sharing, and encouraging efforts to learn. Students explain, discuss, and teach what they know to classmates. Teachers structure the groups so that students sit knee-to-knee and talk through each aspect of the assignment” (Johnson, Johnson, & Holubec). ➤ Interpersonal and small group skills: leadership, decision-making, trust-building, communication, conflict management ➤ Assessment: Combining individual accountability with positive interdependence ○ Teacher evaluates ▪ Content – Individual accountability • CDs – list CDs separately; then decide best one(s) together • CMs – list CMs separately; then create sentences together • Student 1 – TS; Student 2 – CS ▪ Interpersonal dynamics and 12-inch voices ○ Each student self-evaluates (positive comments; critique for improvement)
4.	Independent Writing “I Do”	➤ Provide rubric with prompt before process begins ➤ Each student completes the process from start to finish ➤ Publish on walls or in clouds ➤ Assessment – See rubric

*Analog will be used in this document to mean anything not digital

ENGLISH LANGUAGE ARTS

Steps in Teaching the One-Chunk Response to Literature Paragraph Ratio 1:2+

You will be doing a one-chunk paragraph on the following prompt:

Write a one-chunk paragraph (1:2+) that discusses how Cecilia feels about her life in the second half of the story.

- ☐ **Step 1:** Complete the Gathering CDs and CMs.

To do that, think of 3 or more CDs from the story that fit the prompt. Make sure that they show action. Circle the strongest one. Then think of at least 4 CM thoughts, using the CM helpers if you want.
- ☐ **Step 2:** Write your topic sentence in BLUE on your T-chart.
- ☐ **Step 3:** Copy your CM1 and CM2 ideas to the T-chart in GREEN in the right order.
- ☐ **Step 4:** On your 1st CM webbing page, copy your CM1 word in the middle circle in GREEN. Then Web off the Word and write your CM1 sentence in GREEN at the bottom, using any ideas from your web.
- ☐ **Step 5:** On your 2nd CM Web off the Word page, copy your CM2 word in the middle circle in GREEN. Then Web off the Word and write your CM2 sentence in GREEN at the bottom.
- ☐ **Step 6:** On your Web off the Topic Sentence page, copy the CM word(s) in BLUE from your topic sentence in the middle circle. Then Web off the Topic Sentence to create ideas for the concluding sentence (CS). Write your concluding sentence in BLUE at the bottom.

- ☐ **Step 7:** Write your topic sentence as a complete sentence in BLUE on the T-chart.
- ☐ **Step 8:** Copy your quotation CD in RED on the T-chart.
- ☐ **Step 10:** Create a lead-in to your quote. The lead-in says what happens in the story right before the quotation.
- ☐ **Step 11:** Copy your CM1 and CM2 ideas in GREEN on your T-chart in the right order.
- ☐ **Step 12:** Web off the Word for your CM1 idea. Then use one or more of your ideas to create your 1st CM sentence and write it in GREEN at the bottom of the page.
- ☐ **Step 13:** Web off the Word for your CM2 idea. Then use one or more of your ideas to create your 2nd CM sentence and write it in GREEN at the bottom of the page.
- ☐ **Step 14:** Write your concluding sentence in BLUE at the bottom of the T-chart.
- ☐ **Step 15:** Now copy your topic sentence, concrete detail, 1st CM sentence, 2nd CM sentence, and concluding sentence on your shaping sheet.
- ☐ **Step 16:** Get a piece of butcher paper and one set of colored pens. Copy your paragraph in color-coding on the butcher paper and post it on the wall. Make it look like a paragraph with the topic sentence indented. Put everyone's names on the paper. This is your first draft.

- ☐ **Step 7:** **Now complete the Shaping Sheet. You will transfer your topic sentence, concrete detail sentence, two commentary sentences, and concluding sentence to the shaping sheet. Follow your teacher's directions.**

- ☐ **Step 8:** **Write your first draft of the paragraph in color-coding on butcher paper. Make It look like a paragraph with only the topic sentence indented, and put everyone's names at the bottom.**

GATHERING CDS AND CMS ONE-CHUNK RESPONSE TO LITERATURE PARAGRAPHS

Think of 3 or more CDs that would fit the prompt and write them below. Then circle, underline, or star the one CD you think is the best.

-
-
-
-

Now think of 4 or more CMs you can use for your CD and write them below. Then pick the best 3. Label the biggest, most important idea *TS* in blue. Label the *CM1* and *CM2* ideas in green. It may make it easier for you to use one of these CM helpers:

- _____ feels ___ on the inside.
- _____ feels like _____.
- Why does the character do this?

-
-
-
-

PREWRITING FOR RESPONSE TO LITERATURE

RATIO: 1:2+

1. Write your topic sentence here:



2. Complete the following T-chart:

CDs
What does the character do? What happens in the story?

CMs
_____ feels/felt ____.
_____ feels/felt like a ____.
Why...?

•

• CM1:

• CM2:

WEB OFF THE WORD™

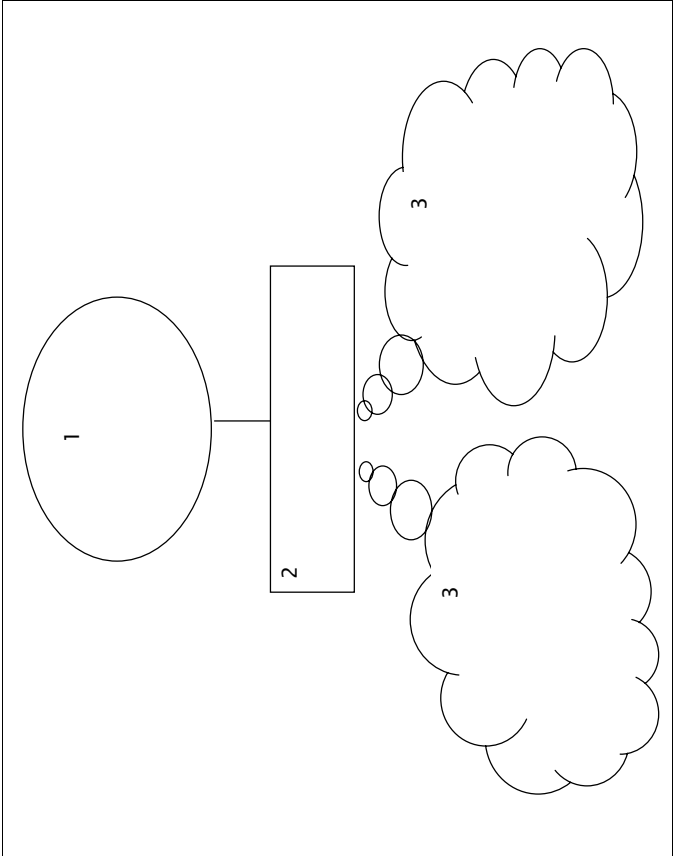
Commentary Sentences

Sequence to fill out the Web off the Word page:

1. In the #1 circle in the middle, copy the *CM* idea from your T-chart.
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 - Phrases are 2 or more “meaty” words.
 - Remember not to include any concrete details.
 - To help you think of phrases, ask yourself, “What does it mean to the character to _____?”
4. Create your *CM* sentence, using one or more ideas from your web.

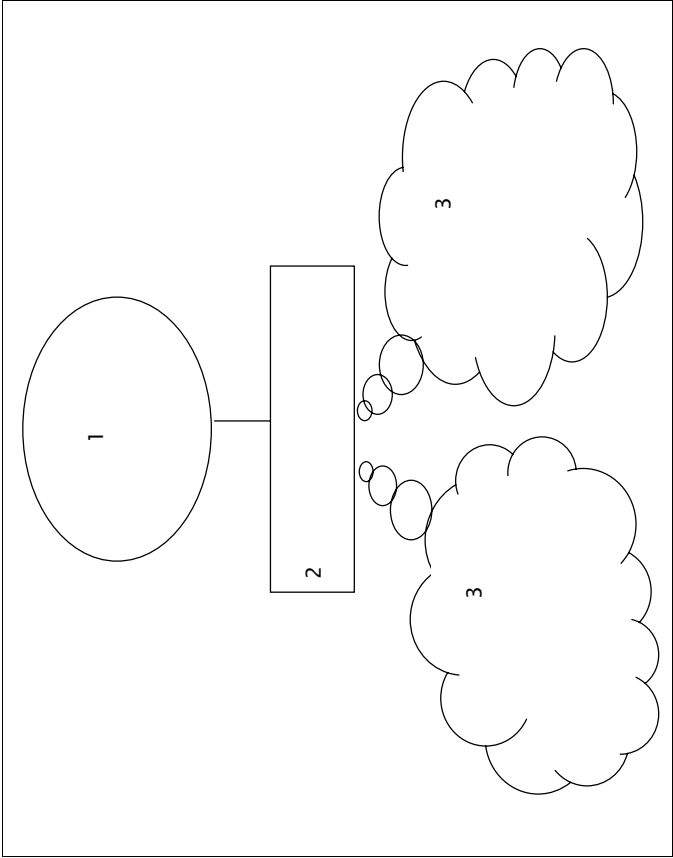
WEB OFF THE WORD™
1st COMMENTARY SENTENCE

CD: _____



CM #1: _____

WEB OFF THE WORD™
2nd COMMENTARY SENTENCE



CM #2: _____

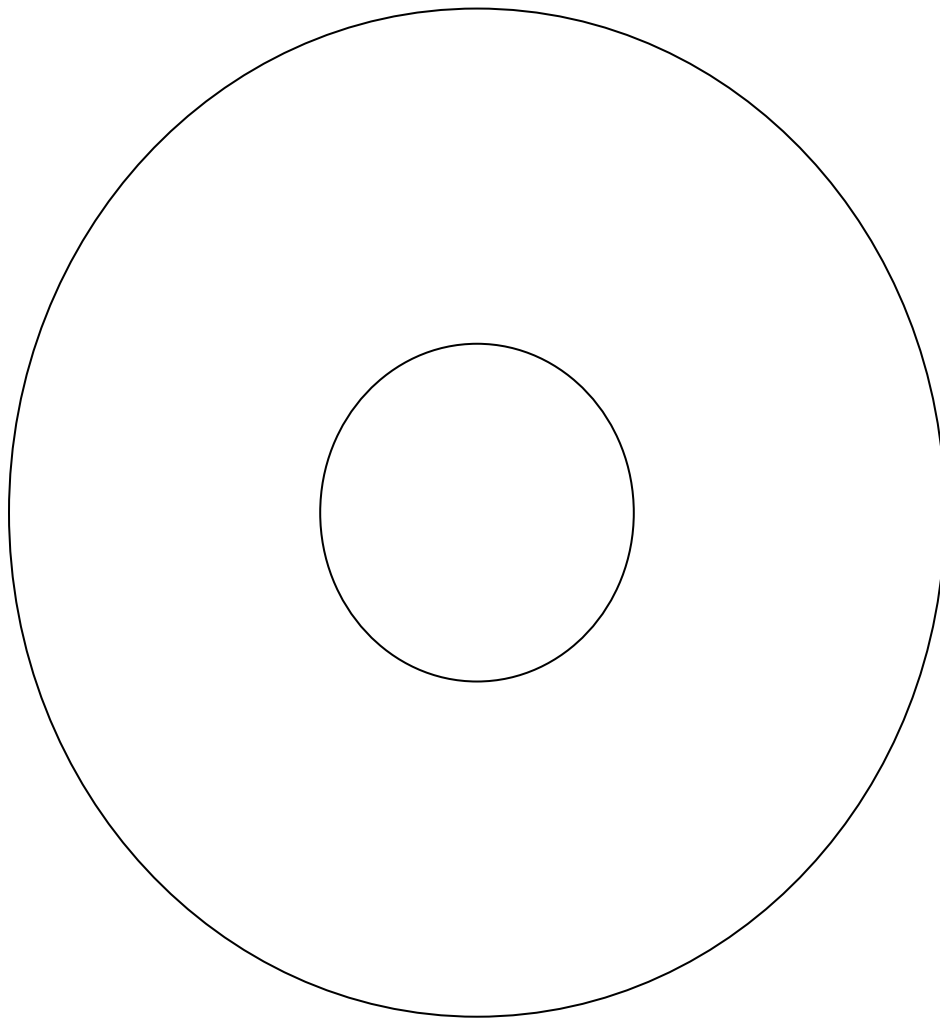
WEB OFF THE TOPIC SENTENCE TO CREATE THE CONCLUDING SENTENCE

Sequence to fill out the Web off the Topic Sentence page:

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4. Create your concluding sentence, using one or more ideas from your web. The only thing you can't use is the idea in the middle circle since you've already written that in your topic sentence.

WEB OFF THE WORD™

Web Off the Topic Sentence for the Concluding Sentence



CS: _____

The diagram illustrates the structure of an analytical paragraph, organized into five distinct sections from top to bottom:

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- 2ND CM** (2nd Commentary): Represented by an oval shape.
- CS** (Concluding Sentence): Represented by a trapezoid shape.

Each section is labeled with its corresponding acronym on the left and its full name inside the shape.

99

THESIS CONSTRUCTION FRAMED AND OPEN

1. Framed:

This is a fill-in-the-blank thesis for those students who need it.

"To Sleep Under the Stars" by Carol Shaw Graham, Cecilia
In _____ by _____, _____ is/was/feels/felt
(title) (author) (character)
_____ isolated _____ in the beginning but _____ connected _____ at the end.
(CM word) (CM word)

Example of framed thesis:

In *Romeo and Juliet* by William Shakespeare, Friar Laurence is optimistic in the beginning but devastated at the end.

2. Open:

This is an unstructured thesis for those students who are ready for it.

"To Sleep Under the Stars" by Carol Shaw Graham, Cecilia
In _____ by _____, _____
(title) (author) (character)
_____ learns the importance of family.

(CM thoughts to finish the sentence)

Example of open thesis:

In *Romeo and Juliet* by William Shakespeare, Friar Laurence does not consider the consequences for his foolish optimism.

SHAPING FOR INTRO PARAGRAPH RESPONSE TO LITERATURE MODEL

Your introduction will have one sentence—the thesis. Write it in the box below, using the Web off the Theme for ideas.

WHAT IT DOES	SENTENCE
▪ your thesis ▪ names the book and author ▪ has 2 or more CM words in it ▪ Starts this way: <i>In ___ (title) by ____ (author), _____ (character)...</i>	In _____ (title) by _____, (author) _____ is/feels _____ (character) (CM) at first but _____ at the end. (CM)

WRITING THE THESIS
4th, 7th, and 10th GRADES
RESPONSE TO LITERATURE WRITING
TWO CHOICES

Overview:

- A one-sentence (thesis only) introductory paragraph is acceptable.
- Number of CM words in the thesis and each topic sentence:
 - 4th grade: 2 CM words in the thesis, 1 CM word in each topic sentence
 - 7th and 10th grades: 2 or more CM words in both the thesis and the topic sentences

FIRST CHOICE:

If students are writing about ONE character, describe how that character feels/felt at the beginning (or in the first half of the story) and at the end (or in the second half of the story).

In *Stellaluna* by Janell Cannon, Stellaluna felt scared at the beginning but happy at the end.

In *Hatchet* by Gary Paulsen, Brian felt scared at first but proud at the end.

In *Romeo and Juliet* by William Shakespeare, the parents are smug at the beginning but devastated at the end.

SHAPING FOR CONCLUDING PARAGRAPH RESPONSE TO LITERATURE

Your concluding paragraph will have one sentence. Use the CM helper below to get you started in writing it. Then cross out the helper.

CM HELPER	SENTENCE
(In this story, the author wanted us to realize that)...	Family comes first.

CECILIA ESSAYS, THREE VERSIONS

1 In "To Sleep under the Stars" by Carol Graham, Cecilia is upset at first but happy at the end.

In the beginning, Cecilia is angry. She doesn't get to go on the field trip. She worries that she will miss out on the fun. She feels sorry for herself. Cecilia knows that life is unfair.

At the end, though, Cecilia feels content. She receives a quilt from her grandmother. She inherits a treasure. She is part of a legacy now. Cecilia feels connected to her family again.

Sometimes something we don't want to do turns out to be the right thing after all.

2 With time and maturity, people can learn the value of sacrifice. In "To Sleep under the Stars" by Carol Graham, Cecilia is upset at first but happy at the end.

In the beginning, Cecilia is angry. She doesn't get to go on the field trip. She worries that she will miss out on the fun. She feels sorry for herself. Cecilia knows that life is unfair.

Although Cecilia feels put upon at first, she feels content by the end. She receives a quilt from her grandmother. She inherits a treasure. She is part of a legacy now. Cecilia feels like a part of her family again.

Although we don't always get what we want, we discover something wonderful. Connecting with family can often bring unexpected rewards.

3 With time and maturity, people can learn the value of sacrifice. Sometimes giving up something important is itself a gift and even becomes a blessing. In "To Sleep under the Stars" by Carol Graham, Cecilia appreciates the serendipity that enters her life.

In the beginning, Cecilia resents the unexpected change in plans. She doesn't go on the field trip because her mother says they are going to visit Grandma. Worried that she will miss out on the fun and not share a grand adventure with her friends, she pleads to be excused from family obligations and allowed to participate in an adolescent rite of passage. She values her friends over family and sees no reason to sacrifice for others. To Cecilia, life is grossly unfair.

Although Cecilia originally thinks her mother ignores her wishes, her contentment in the end is far greater than she imagined. After talking with Gran about her past, Cecilia receives a quilt full of stars. Instead of missing out on an exciting discovery, she embarks on an even grander one. Part of a long tradition binding one generation to another, she knows she shares a legacy now, one that she will treasure far longer than any trip she takes. Cecilia knows she is an integral member of the family.

We may not always get what we want, but we discover something wonderful anyway. We learn the unexpected satisfaction of putting others first. Connecting with family can often bring surprising rewards.

STAGES IN THE TEACHING SEQUENCE OF WRITING

Argumentation, Expository / Informational, Narrative, Response to Literature

1.	Teacher Model “Guided Writing” “I Do”	➤ Teacher gives the class a completed example--from the writing prompt to the prewriting to the shaping to the final draft. ➤ Equipment and Materials: ○ hard graphic organizers and pens for each student and teacher (students copy as teacher presents each step and the thinking behind each step) ○ hard copy of the model from start to finish for all students (give this clean copy of all steps after the students copy and submit for grade) ○ chalkboard, dry erase board, interactive whiteboard, or document camera ○ if digital, use Google Docs, JSWP App, BYOD, laptop, digital graphic organizers ➤ Assessment: Credit is given for copying precisely the model either on paper or digitally; ▪ on-task behavior, focus ▪ asking questions, clarification ▪ color-coding correctly ▪ correct grammar, mechanics, usage
2.	Class Collaborative “Shared Writing” “We Do”	➤ The teacher and the students write collaboratively in class. ➤ The teacher guides a thoughtful and multimedia discussion. Shared resources. ➤ Everyone is writing on the same, specific topic. Mutual goal. ➤ Equipment and Materials: see above (no model; hard copies or digital graphic organizers) ➤ Assessment ○ Everyone offers two comments for each part of the process through the final draft. ○ Teacher frequently assesses individuals and group (definitions, colors, purpose) ○ Group processing after each step in the process: “reflecting on the group’s work to clarify and improve the effectiveness of the members in working together to achieve the group’s goals by (a) describing what member actions were helpful and unhelpful and (b) making decisions about what actions to continue or change” (Johnson, et.al). ○ Everyone submits entire process (after each step).
3.	Small Group “Shared Writing” “You Do Together”	➤ Students write in pairs. Use same materials as “We Do.” Analog* only. ➤ Promotive interaction: “Students promote each other’s learning by helping, sharing, and encouraging efforts to learn. Students explain, discuss, and teach what they know to classmates. Teachers structure the groups so that students sit knee-to-knee and talk through each aspect of the assignment” (Johnson, Johnson, & Holubec). ➤ Interpersonal and small group skills: leadership, decision-making, trust-building, communication, conflict management ➤ Assessment: Combining individual accountability with positive interdependence ○ Teacher evaluates ▪ Content – Individual accountability • CDs – list CDs separately; then decide best one(s) together • CMs – list CMs separately; then create sentences together • Student 1 – TS; Student 2 – CS ▪ Interpersonal dynamics and 12-inch voices ○ Each student self-evaluates (positive comments; critique for improvement)
4.	Independent Writing “I Do”	➤ Provide rubric with prompt before process begins ➤ Each student completes the process from start to finish ➤ Publish on walls or in clouds ➤ Assessment – See rubric

*Analog will be used in this document to mean anything not digital

ENGLISH LANGUAGE ARTS

Steps in Writing the One-Chunk Response to Literature Paragraph Ratio 1:2+

- ☐ Step 1: Think of a story you will be teaching. Choose one character to discuss in your paragraph and write that character's name here:

You won't do steps 2-4 today. We complete them as appropriate when we are planning lessons for our classes.

- ☐ Step 2: Which state standard(s) are you addressing?

- ☐ Step 3 : From all the sub-standards/strands, choose one for the assignment and copy it here: -----

- ☐ Step 4: From that sub-standard/strand, choose one concept and copy it here: -----

- ☐ Step 5: You will be writing a paragraph for the prompt you just wrote.

Copy your prompt here:

Write a one-chunk response to literature paragraph, 1:2+ ratio, that -----

- ☐ Step 6: Complete the Gathering CDs and CMs page.

- ☐ **Step 6:** On your 2nd CM Web off the Word page, copy your CM2 word in the middle circle in GREEN. Then Web off the Word and write your CM2 sentence in GREEN at the bottom.
- ☐ **Step 7:** On your Web off the Topic Sentence page, copy the CM word(s) in BLUE from your topic sentence in the middle circle. Then Web off the Topic Sentence to create ideas for the concluding sentence (CS). Write your concluding sentence in BLUE at the bottom.
- ☐ **Step 8:** Now complete the Shaping Sheet. You will transfer your topic sentence, concrete detail sentence, two commentary sentences, and concluding sentence to the shaping sheet. Follow your teacher's directions.
- ☐ **Step 9:** Write your first draft of the paragraph in color-coding on butcher paper. Make It look like a paragraph with only the topic sentence indented, and put everyone's names at the bottom.

ALBERTO AND JUAN lived in two houses that stood side by side outside a small pueblo. Although both houses were much alike, Alberto had a splendid apple tree, puffed with pink blossoms each spring and bent low each autumn with fruit both red and ripe.

His neighbor, Juan, had little and nothing, except his family and his good nature.

Each day Alberto would brag about his apple tree. "It bears the finest blossoms and the finest apples," he declared. "That makes me the finest man in the pueblo."

"It is a beautiful tree," Juan agreed. "I'm glad you let us enjoy its beauty as well."

Somehow the thought that others benefited from his tree lessened Alberto's enjoyment. The tree was his, after all. Alberto decided to build a high fence so that he alone could enjoy the tree's blossoms and bounty.

Townsfolk shook their heads at his foolishness and left him to his pride.

One spring, however, Alberto was unhappy to see that a branch of his tree extended over the fence into his neighbor's yard.

"I can't cut it off," Alberto decided. "To damage so fine a tree would be wrong. Still, why should Juan receive any benefit from a tree that is clearly mine?"

He fretted and fumed through the pink-blossomed spring. He pondered and puzzled through the green-leaved summer. Then fall came, and with it a moment of truth.

While Alberto could pick the apples on his own land, and gather the windfalls so not even squirrels could enjoy them, he could not set foot on the other side of the fence.

He pretended it didn't matter. But it did.

Then, one day, Alberto discovered an apple cake on his doorstep.

"*Gracias*," read the note. It was signed "Juan."

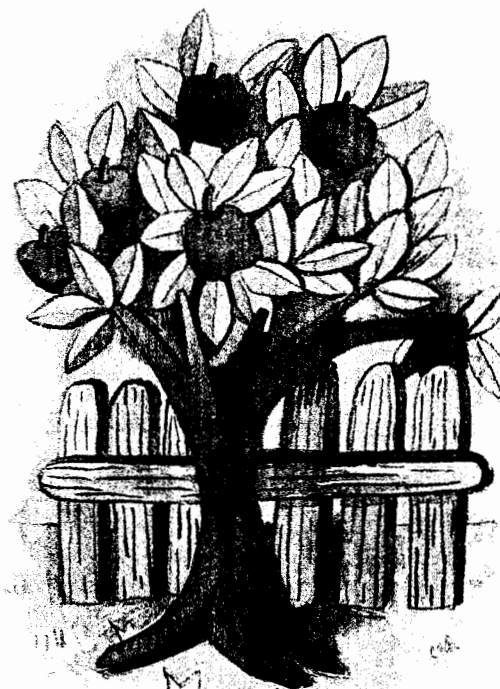
Alberto was furious. His apples were being used without his permission, and he considered Juan's note a slap in the face.

"I must have justice!" Alberto declared. He hurried to the home of the mayor, bringing the cake along as evidence.

"See here," Alberto declared, plunking the cake down.

Both Sides of the Fence

by Teresa Bateman



Illustrated by Ruth Arceli

© 2003 by Teresa Bateman

PUEBLO IS SPANISH FOR TOWN OR VILLAGE.



"This was made with apples from *my* tree. Juan is guilty of stealing and left proof of it on my doorstep! He's probably sitting in his house, eating my apples and laughing at me even as we speak."

The mayor helped himself to a piece of cake while reading the note.

"A branch of your tree goes over the fence," the mayor pointed out. "Surely these apples are from that branch?"

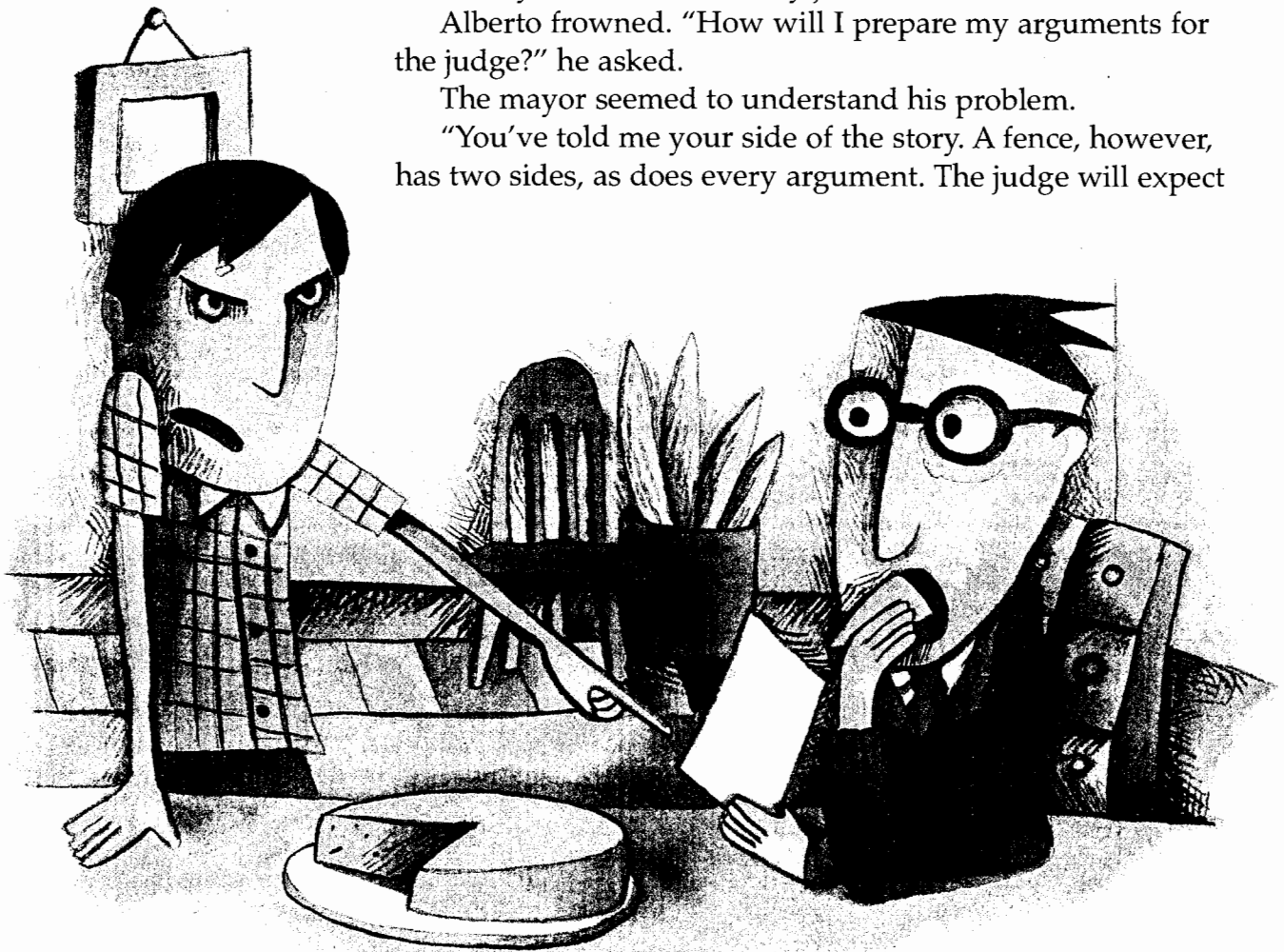
"It doesn't matter," Alberto fumed. "My father planted that tree on property that's been in my family for years. The land and the tree are mine. The apples are mine as well."

The mayor considered the problem from all angles. "Four days from now a judge will visit our pueblo," he said at last. "Present your case, and surely justice will be done."

Alberto frowned. "How will I prepare my arguments for the judge?" he asked.

The mayor seemed to understand his problem.

"You've told me your side of the story. A fence, however, has two sides, as does every argument. The judge will expect



you to understand both. A clever man knows his opponent's thoughts. Come back tomorrow and present me with Juan's point of view."

Alberto headed home, absently nibbling on the cake as he considered the arguments he would present to the judge. He tried to imagine what Juan might say. The branch *did* extend over the fence, and Juan had so little that any food would be welcome. Still, "It's *my* tree," Alberto said firmly to a passing dog.

The next morning Alberto returned to the mayor and presented what he imagined to be Juan's side of the case.

"He will say the apples fell onto his property and that makes them his," Alberto stated. "But if a dog wandered into his yard, the dog would not become his." (He was very proud of this argument.)

The mayor frowned. "Why, then, did Juan give you the apple cake?"

"Why? To rub my nose in his theft!" Alberto declared.

"Perhaps," the mayor said. "Yet Juan can ill afford to give food away. You are missing something. A fence has two sides, as does every argument. Perhaps you need another day to consider. You don't want to appear uninformed before the judge."

Alberto returned home and stared out at the tree and the fence. He thought of his own argument—the tree was his; therefore its fruit was his. He thought of Juan's probable argument—that the apples had fallen into his yard and, therefore, belonged to him. But why did Juan give him the cake? That night Alberto tossed and turned.

Early the next day he marched to the mayor's house. "How can I know why Juan gave me the cake?" he said angrily. "Who can know what is in another man's heart?"

"Juan knows," the mayor quietly replied. "Remember—things can look quite different from the other side of the fence."

"Very well," Alberto said grudgingly. "I will talk to Juan myself. It can only make my case against him stronger." He hurried from the mayor's door and soon arrived at Juan's house.

Alberto pounded on Juan's door, anxious to gather the evidence he needed.

**"Who can know
what is in another
man's heart?"**

Juan smiled when he opened the door. "Did you like the cake?" he asked.

Alberto opened his mouth, but before he could get out a word, Juan continued. "I had to thank you," he said. "My family so enjoyed the branch of your tree that comes over the fence—blossoms in the spring, shade in the summer. I knew the man who owns the finest apple tree in the pueblo must surely be the most generous man as well, but the apples, of course, were yours. We got so much joy out of your tree, it would be poor repayment to simply give you the apples, so my wife baked all of them into a cake. I hope you enjoyed it."

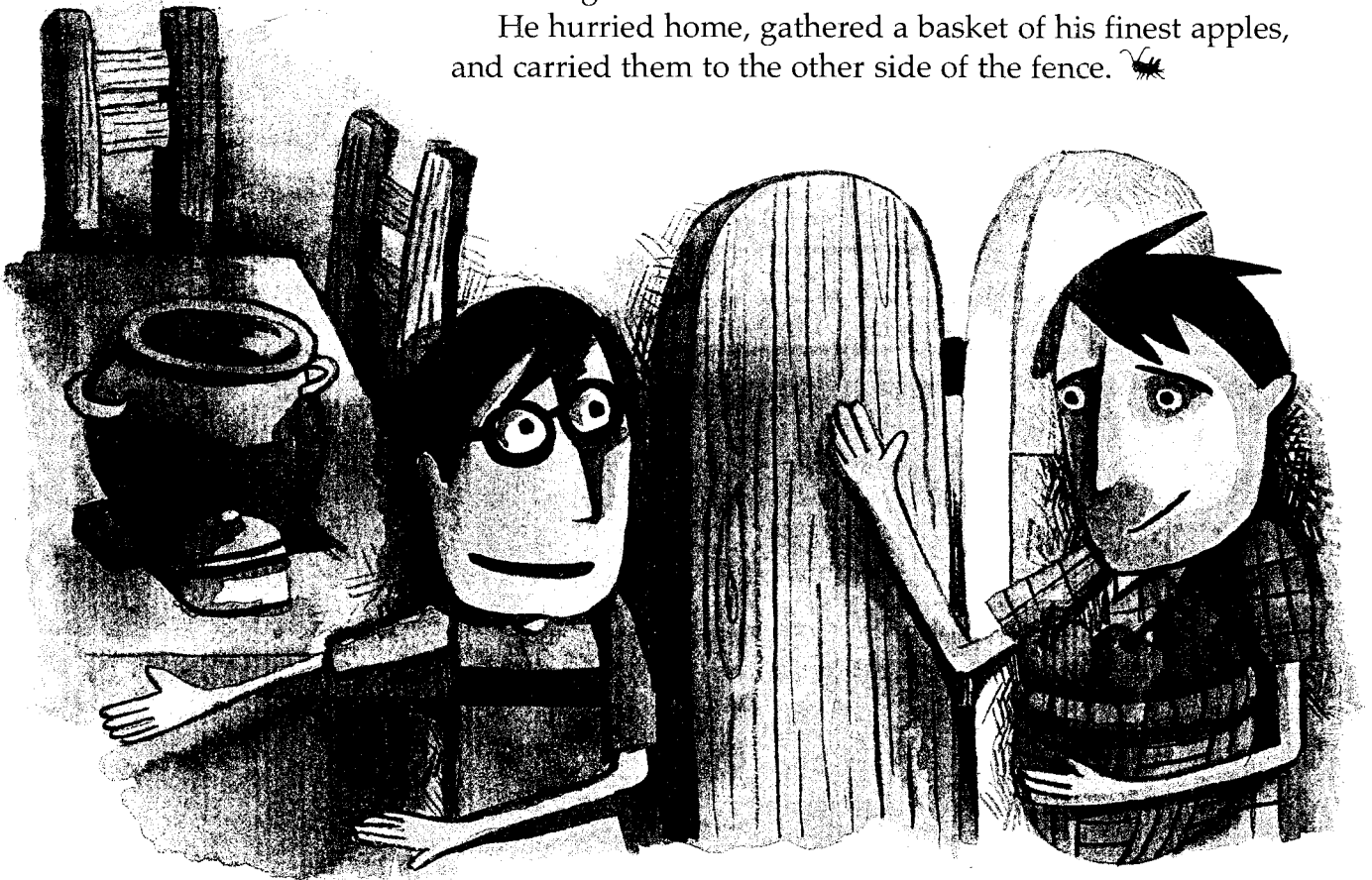
Alberto felt no taller than an ant. His arguments dissolved like sugar in water.

"Will you join us?" Juan asked. He motioned to the table set with a simple meal of beans, rice, and tortillas.

Alberto knew at once he would not be presenting any case before the judge the following day.

"With pleasure," he said, "if you will allow me to add something to the meal."

He hurried home, gathered a basket of his finest apples, and carried them to the other side of the fence. 





Title: The Tragedy of Romeo and Juliet

Author: William Shakespeare

In a novel or play, a character may be considered someone in whom secrets are confided or with whom private matters and problems are discussed. In William Shakespeare's *The Tragedy of Romeo and Juliet*, Friar Laurence is this type of character who plays an integral role in the drama. Read the drama carefully. Then, in a well-written paragraph (2 chunks; 1:2+), explain how Friar Laurence is optimistic in the beginning but devastated at the end.

Title: "The Confrontation" (an excerpt from *The Plum Pickers*)

Author: Raymond Barrio

Writing Prompt: Justice and injustice are subjects discussed in many literary works and are developed into themes by many authors. In "The Confrontation," a migrant farm worker realizes his own worth. Read the excerpt carefully. Then, in a well-written essay (two paragraphs; two chunks each; 1:2+), trace the protagonist's realization.

Titles: "Priscilla and the Wimps" (an excerpt from *Sixteen*, ed. Don Gallo) and "The Confrontation" (an excerpt from *The Plum Pickers*)

Authors: Richard Peck and Raymond Barrio, respectively

Writing Prompt: Justice and Injustice are subjects addressed in many literary works and developed into themes by many authors. Read carefully "Priscilla and the Wimps" and "The Confrontation." Then, in a well-written two-chunk paragraph (1:2+), compare the main characters. Use evidence from the stories to support your comparison.

Title: To Kill a Mockingbird

Author: Harper Lee

Writing Prompt: Harper Lee published *To Kill a Mockingbird* (1960) at the beginning of the period in American history when the civil rights movement was gaining momentum. Lee selected a five year-old girl, Scout Finch, as the narrator of this Pulitzer Prize winning novel. Please read the novel carefully. Then, in a well-written multi-paragraph essay (1:2+; 2-3 chunks per paragraph), analyze the importance of the title of the novel as it relates to the narrator and other characters in the novel. Support your opinions with evidence from the novel.

Title: "A White Heron"

Author: Sarah Orne Jewett

Read the following passage carefully. Then write an essay showing how the author dramatizes the young heroine's adventure. Consider such literary elements as diction, imagery, narrative pace, and point of view.

Title: Beowulf

Author: Anonymous

Beowulf is the longest epic poem in Old English, the language spoken in Anglo-Saxon England before the Norman Conquest. More than 3,000 lines long, *Beowulf* relates the exploits of its eponymous hero, and his successive battles with a monster named Grendel, with Grendel's revengeful mother, and with a dragon which was guarding a hoard of treasure. Read the excerpts of the poem carefully. Then, in a well-written essay, characterize Grendel.



TWO-CHUNK PARAGRAPH FORMULA/STRUCTURE

- 1) Cinderella feels mistreated.
- 2) After her father's death, she "does all the cooking, cleaning, and sewing by herself." She has no one to share her burdens.
- 4) She is treated like a second-class citizen.
- 5) Later, even though her stepsisters leave for the ball in the dresses Cinderella has made, she "is told she has to stay home."
- 6) She isn't welcome there.
- 7) Her family doesn't even consider her worth inviting.
- 8) Cinderella is ignored and unwanted.

TWO-CHUNK PARAGRAPH WEAVING

- 1) Cinderella feels mistreated.
- 2) With no one to share her burdens, she is doomed to "do all the cooking, cleaning, and sewing by herself."
- 3) She is treated like a second-class citizen.
- 4) Cinderella is taken for granted.
- 5) Even when her stepsisters are invited to the ball, she is not welcome and "is told she cannot attend."
- 6) Her family doesn't even consider her wishes.
- 7) Cinderella is ignored and unwanted.

PARAGRAPH CONSTRUCTION, 1:2+

1. Prompt: Write a two-chunk paragraph that compares Cinderella's feelings at the beginning and the end of the story.

2. Complete the following T-chart:

CDs What does Cinderella do? What happens in the story?	CMs Character feels ____ Cinderella feels like a ____ Why?
1st chunk	1st chunk
• She does all the cooking, cleaning, and sewing by herself.	▪ lonely ▪ mistreated ▪ ignored
2nd chunk	2nd chunk
• She marries the prince.	▪ special ▪ cherished ▪ appreciated

TOPIC SENTENCE: **Cinderella feels mistreated at first but special at the end.**

TWO-CHUNK MODEL (8 sentences)

1) Friar Laurence is partly responsible for the tragic and senseless deaths of the star-crossed lovers. 2) When Romeo asks him for help after meeting Juliet at the Capulets' party, the Friar marries them without telling their parents. 3) He hopes to stop the generations-long feud that has been plaguing and poisoning the town, but his secrecy dooms his plan. 4) Troubled by the animosity between the warring houses and determined to unite the families, he does not anticipate the tragic consequences of his decision. 5) After he sends a letter to Romeo explaining his plan to give Juliet a potion, he leaves her in the tomb when he realizes Romeo is dead. 6) Afraid for his own reputation, he is willing to abandon Juliet rather than stop further tragedy. 7) His selfish desire to save his own skin leads to the grievous loss of an innocent and heartbroken girl and the boy who loved her. 8) Friar Laurence must accept part of the blame for the devastation that occurs.

"The Confrontation"

By Raymond Barrio

from *THE PLUM PLUM PICKERS*

No matter which way he turned, he was trapped in an endless maze of apricot trees, as though forever, neat rows of them, neatly planted, row after row, just like the blackest bars on a jail.

There had to be an end. There had to be. There—trapped. There had to be a way out. Locked. There had to be a respite. Animal. The buckets and the crates kept piling up higher. Brute. He felt alone. Though surrounded by other pickers. Beast. Though he was perspiring heavily, his shirt was powder dry. Savage. The hot dry air. The hot dry air sucking every drop of living moisture from his brute body. Wreck. He stopped and walked to the farthest end of the first row for some water, raised the dented dipper from the brute tank, drank the holy water in great brute gulps so he wouldn't have to savor its tastelessness, letting it spill down his torn shirt to cool his exhausted body, to replenish his brute cells and animal pores and stinking follicle and pig gristle, a truly refined wreck of an animal, pleased to meetcha. Predator.

Lunch.

Almost too exhausted to eat, he munched his cheese with tortillas, smoked on ashes, then lay back on the cool ground for half an hour. That short rest in the hot shade replenished some of his humor and resolve. He felt his spirit swell out again like a thirsty sponge in water. Then up again. The trees. The branches again. The briary branches. The scratching leaves. The twigs tearing at his shirt sleeves. The ladder. The rough bark. The endlessly unending piling up of bucket upon box upon crate upon stack upon rack upon mound upon mountain. He picked a mountain of cots automatically. An automaton. A beast. A ray of enemy sun penetrated the tree that was hiding him and split his forehead open. His mind whirled. He blacked out. Luckily

he'd been leaning against a heavy branch. His feet hooked to the ladder's rung. His half-filled bucket slipped from his grasp and fell in slow motion, splattering the fruit he'd so laboriously picked. To the ground. Roberto happened by and shook his head. "Whatsamatter, can't you see straight?" Manuel was too tired even to curse. He should have had some salt pills.

Midafternoon.

The summer's fierce zenith passed overhead. It passed. Then dropped. It started to light the ocean behind him, back of the hills. Sandy dreams. Cool nights. Cold drinks. Soft guitar music with Lupe sitting beside him. All wafting through his feverish moments. Tiredness drained his spirit of will. Exhaustion drained his mind. His fingers burned. His arms flailed the innocent trees. He was slowing down. He could hardly fill his last bucket. Suddenly the whistle blew. The day's work was at last ended.

Ended!

The contratista Roberto Morales stood there.

His feet straddled. Mexican style. A real robber. A Mexican general. A gentlemanly, friendly, polite, grinning, vicious, thieving brute. The worst kind. To his own people. Despite his being a fellow Mexican, despite his torn, old clothing, everyone knew what kind of clever criminal he was. Despite his crude, ignorant manner, showing that he was one of them, that he'd started with them, that he grew up with them, that he'd suffered all the sordid deprivations with them, he was actually the shrewdest, smartest, richest cannibal in forty counties around. They sure couldn't blame the güeros for this miscarriage. He was a crew chief. How could anyone know what he did to his own people? And what did the güeros care? So the anglo growers and güero executives, smiling in their cool filtered offices, puffing their elegant thin cigars, washed their clean blond bloodless dirtless hands of the whole matter. All they did was hire Roberto Morales. Firm, fair, and square. For an agreed-upon price. Good. How he got his people down to the pickings was no concern of theirs. They were honest, those güeros. They could sleep at night.

They fulfilled their end of the bargain, and cheated no one. Their only crime; their only soul crime indeed was that they just didn't care how that migratory scum lived. It was no concern of theirs. Their religion said it was of no concern of theirs. Their wives said it was no concern of theirs. Their aldermen said it was no concern of theirs. Their—

Whenever Roberto Morales spoke, Manuel had to force himself not to answer. He had to keep his temper from flaring.

"Now," announced Morales at last, in his friendliest tone. "Now. I must take two cents from every bucket. I am sorry. There was a miscalculation. Everybody understands. Everybody?" He slid his eyes around, smiling, palms up.

The tired, exhausted pickers gasped as one.

Yes. Everyone understood. Freezing in place. After all that hard work.

"Any questions, men?"

Morales grinned, knowing everyone realized that he had the upper hand, that that would mean a loss of two or three dollars out of each picker's pay that day, a huge windfall for Morales.

"You promised to take nothing!" Manuel heard himself saying. Everyone turned in astonishment to stare at Manuel.

"I said two cents, hombre. You got a problem or what?"

"You promised."

The two men, centered in a huge ring of red-ringed eyes, glared at each other. Reaching for each other's jugular. The other exhausted animals studied the tableau through widening eyes. It was so unequal. Morales remained calm, confident, studying Manuel. As though memorizing his features. He had the whole advantage. Then, with his last remaining energy, Manuel lifted his foot and clumsily tipped over his own last bucket of cots. They rolled away in all directions around everyone's feet.

Roberto Morales' eyes blazed. His fists clenched. "You pick them up, Gutierrez."

So. He knew his name. After all. For answer, Manuel kicked over another bucket, and again the fruit rolled away in all directions.

Then an astonishing thing happened.

All the other pickers moved toward their own buckets still standing beside them on the ground awaiting the truck gatherer, and took an ominous position over them. Without looking around, without taking his eyes off Manuel, Roberto Morales said sharply, "All right. All right, men. I shall take nothing this time."

Manuel felt a thrill of power course through his nerves.

He had never won anything before. He would have to pay for this, for his defiance, somehow, again, later. But he had shown defiance. He had salvaged his money savagely and he had earned respect from his fellow slaves. The big bosses would never know of this little incident, and would probably be surprised, and perhaps even a little mortified, for a few minutes. But they wouldn't care. It was bread, pan y tortillas out of his children's mouths. But they still wouldn't give a single hoot. Manuel had wrenched Morales' greedy fingers away and removed a fat slug of a purse from his sticky grasp. And in his slow way, in his stupid, accidental, dangerous way, Manuel had made an extravagant discovery, as Don Gaspar had also made two centuries before, in almost exactly the same spot. And that was—that a man counted for something. For men, Manuel dimly suspected, are built for something more important and less trifling than the mere gathering of prunes and apricots, hour upon hour, decade upon decade, insensibly, mechanically, antlike. Men are built to experience a certain sense of honor and pride.

Or else they are dead before they die.

GATHERING CDS AND CMS TWO-CHUNK RESPONSE TO LITERATURE PARAGRAPHS

PROMPT: Write a two-chunk response to literature paragraph (1:2+)
that _____

GATHERING CDS:

Think of 4 or more CDs that would fit the prompt and write them below. Then circle the two CDs you think are the best and label them *CD1* and *CD2*.

-
-
-
-

GATHERING CMS:

Now brainstorm 4 or more CMs for each CD and write them below. Then pick the biggest, most important thought for each CD and label them *TS* in blue. Next, choose the 2 best CMs for each CD and label them *CM1* and *CM2* in green. It may make it easier for you to use one of these CM helpers:

- _____ feels ____ on the inside.
- _____ feels like _____.
- Why does the character do this?
-

4 CMs, 1st CD:

-
-
-
-

4 CMs, 2nd CD:

-
-
-
-

PARAGRAPH CONSTRUCTION, 1:2+

TS

CDs
What does the character do?
What happens in the story?

CMs
_____ feels _____.
_____ feels like a _____.
Why?

1st chunk

●

2nd chunk

●

1st chunk

■

■

■

2nd chunk

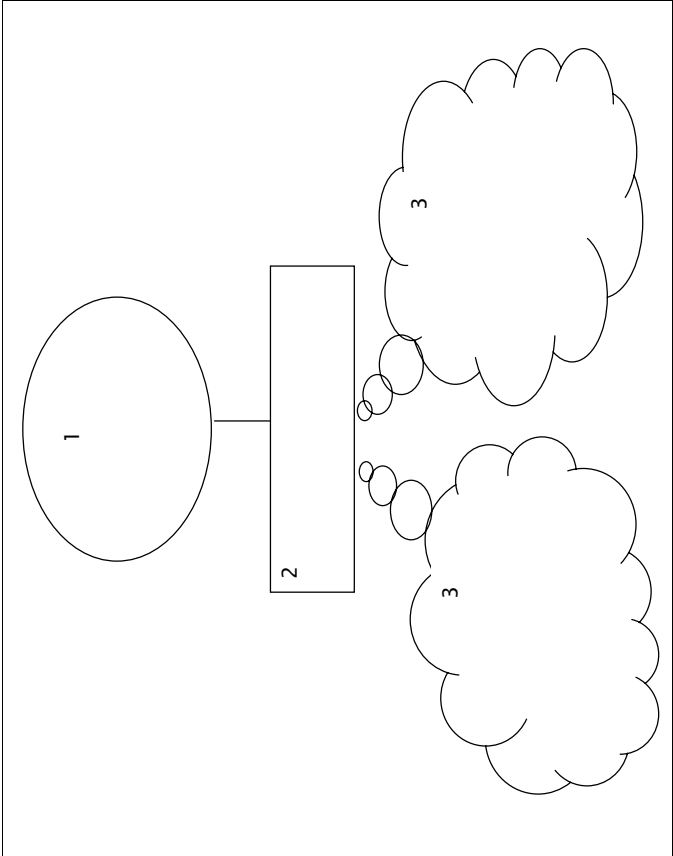
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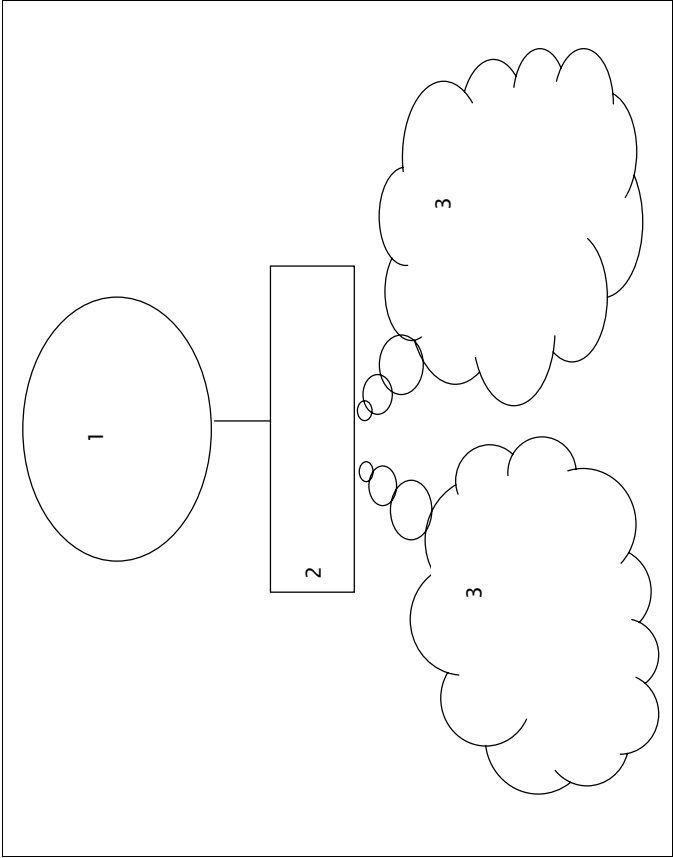
WEB OFF THE WORD™
1st COMMENTARY SENTENCE

CD: _____



CM #1: _____

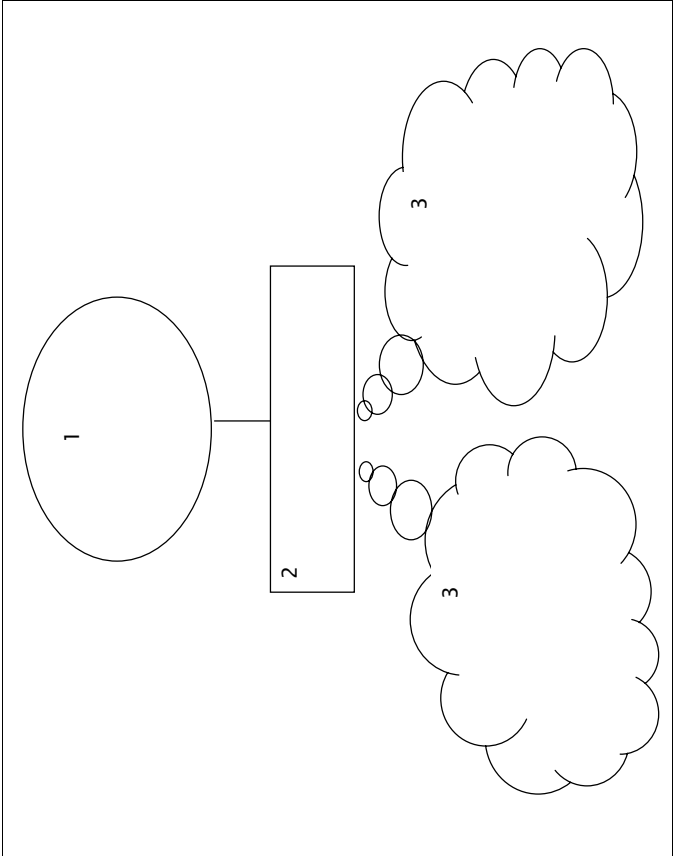
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2nd COMMENTARY SENTENCE



CM #2: _____

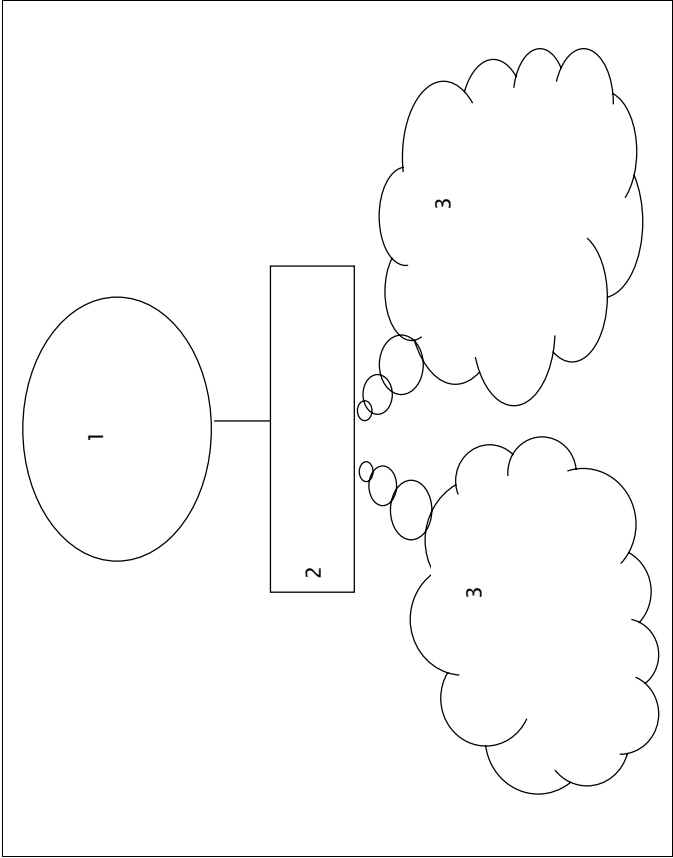
WEB OFF THE WORD™
1st COMMENTARY SENTENCE

CD: _____



CM #1: _____

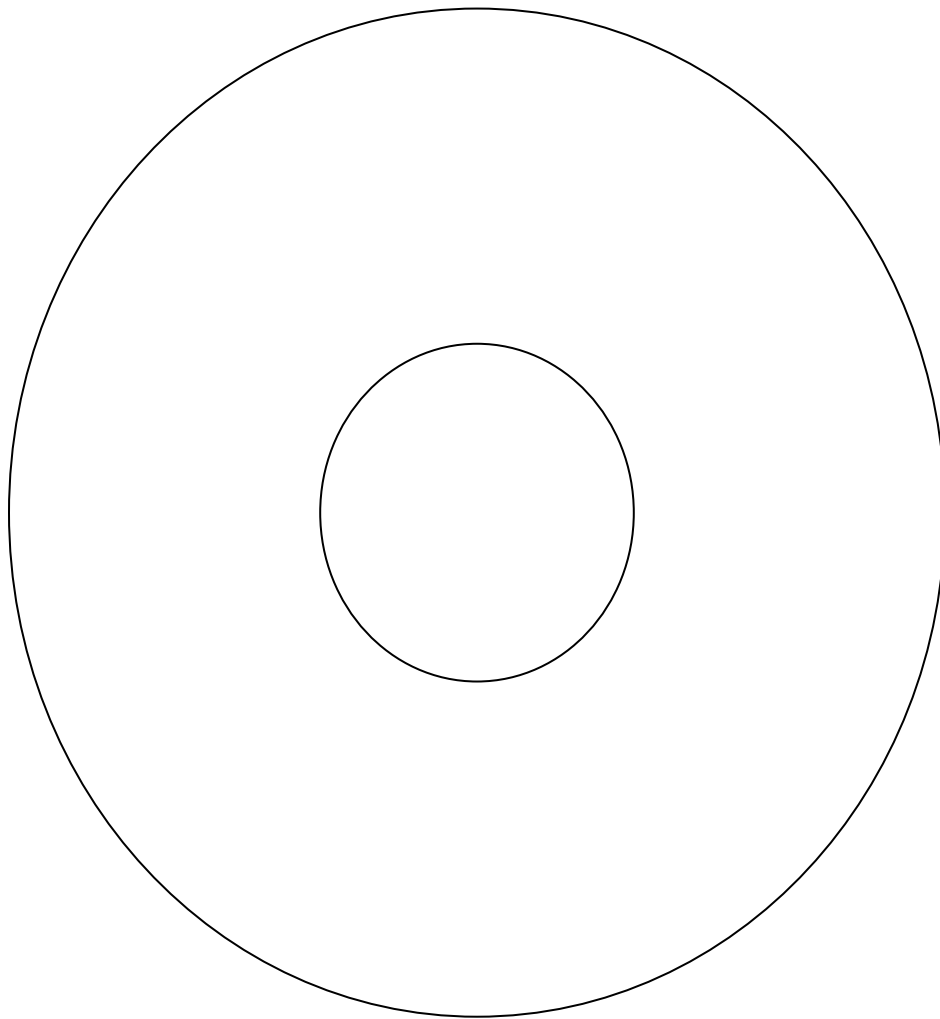
WEB OFF THE WORD™
2nd COMMENTARY SENTENCE



CM #2: _____

WEB OFF THE WORD™

Web Off the Topic Sentence for the Concluding Sentence



CS: _____

SHAPING SHEET 1:2+ RATIO

TOPIC SENTENCE

1ST CHUNK
CD

2ND CHUNK
CD

1ST CM

1ST CM

2ND CM

2ND CM

CONCLUDING SENTENCE

PARAGRAPH FORM

[illegible]

GATHERING CDS AND CMS TWO-CHUNK RESPONSE TO LITERATURE PARAGRAPHS

PROMPT: Write a two-chunk response to literature paragraph (1:2+)
that _____

GATHERING CDS:

Think of 4 or more CDs that would fit the prompt and write them below. Then circle the two CDs you think are the best and label them *CD1* and *CD2*.

- "
- "
- "
- "

GATHERING CMS:

Now brainstorm 4 or more CMs for each CD and write them below. Then pick the biggest, most important thought for each CD and label them *TS* in blue. Next, choose the 2 best CMs for each CD and label them *CM1* and *CM2* in green. It may make it easier for you to use one of these CM helpers:

- _____ feels ___ on the inside.
- _____ feels like _____.
- Why does the character do this?
-

4 CMs, 1st CD:

-
-
-
-

4 CMs, 2nd CD:

-
-
-
-

The Dialectical Journal

CDs	CMs

TLCD and LCD

Model of TLCD: *Transition/Lead-in/Concrete Detail*:

For example, after her father dies, she “is ordered to do all the cooking, cleaning, and sewing” (2).

Model of LCD: *Lead-in/Concrete Detail*:

After her father dies, she “is ordered to do all the cooking, cleaning, and sewing” (2).

Directions for students:

1. Choose your quotation CD and write it on the *Quotation* lines on your T-chart.
2. Think of the lead-in by asking yourself, “What happens in the story right before the quote?”
3. Use one of these starter words to begin the lead-in and write it on the *Lead-in* lines on your T-chart:

After

Although

As

Before

Since

When

While

QUOTING MATERIAL FROM SOURCES

Embedding Quotations

Instructions:

1. Choose your quotations (CDs) wisely. They must support your argument.
2. Don't just drop a quote in your writing out of nowhere! Think of a Lead-in.
 - a. Would this CD be more powerful if I introduce it with the name of the publisher and/or author to add more credibility to the source and my argument?
 - b. Do I need to give my reader an understanding of an event or situation that was taking place?
3. Your goal is to make sure that your audience understands your logic in thinking, so you must place the quotation in your sentence in a manner that helps your audience and furthers your point.

Sample Lead-ins (underlined) that introduce quotations:

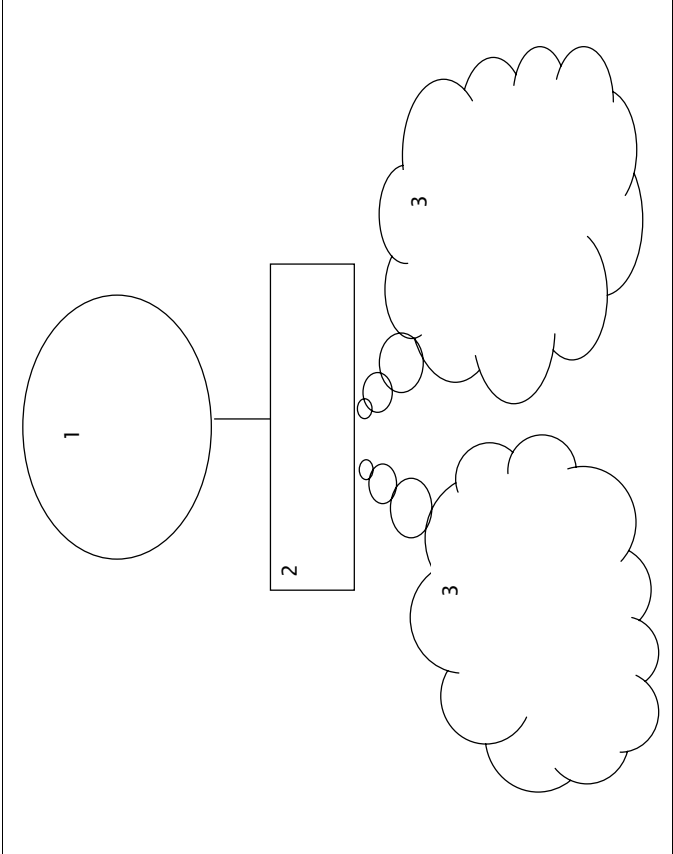
1. The tardy policy stipulates that a student late to class will be rounded up in a tardy sweep and “locked out of class for the first ten minutes” (“Tardy”).
2. In a *USA Today* article, reporter Janet Loehrke discusses the obesity epidemic among children caused by poor food choices. According to Loehrke, “[e]xtra pounds put kids at a higher risk of developing Type Two diabetes, high blood pressure, high cholesterol, and other health problems.”
3. Recently, in a brief by the National Governors Association, “a total of 36 states currently have policies that provide school districts and schools with some flexibility for awarding credit to students based on mastery of content and skills as opposed to seat time” (“State Strategies” 1).
4. To briefly review C.G. Jung’s definition of the collective unconscious and archetypes, the collective unconscious is a “second psychic system of a collective, universal, and impersonal nature which is identical in all individuals” (*CW* 9i, para. 90).
5. The young Siddhartha is born into “dharma, the moral order of the world” (Zimmer 14), yielding virtuous men and women who “devote their lives to the fulfillment of the duties and tasks divinely ordained by Dharma” (Zimmer 14).
6. In *Time Magazine*, however, journalist Steve Jones reveals that “47 percent of . . .” (2).
7. If a student reaches three tardies, he or she receives an “automatic detention of thirty minutes” (“Tardy”).
8. A recent *Sports Illustrated* article indicated that the “winning team members of Super Bowl XLV received \$83,000” (Alder 2).
9. In his preface, Momaday discusses the book as a journey and delineates the journey into what he considers “an evocation of three things in particular: a landscape that is incomparable, a time that is gone forever, and the human spirit, which endures” (4).
10. Based on historical records, the probability of either Tituba or her ancestors being from Africa is very slim. Evidence from sources such as Elaine Breslaw’s acclaimed American Series text, *Tituba, Reluctant Witch of Salem*, suggests that “all extant Massachusetts references to [Tituba] clearly specify that she was an American Indian” (12).

T-CHART FOR RESPONSE TO LIT PARAGRAPH
QUOTATION CDS

	CDs What happens in the story? What does the character do?	CMs (...) feels/felt _____ on the inside. (...) feels/felt like a _____. Why....?
Lead-in After Although As Before Since When While	1ST CHUNK: _____ _____ _____ _____ “ _____ _____ _____ _____” (_____).	
Lead-in After Although As Before Since When While	2ND CHUNK: _____ _____ _____ _____ “ _____ _____ _____	

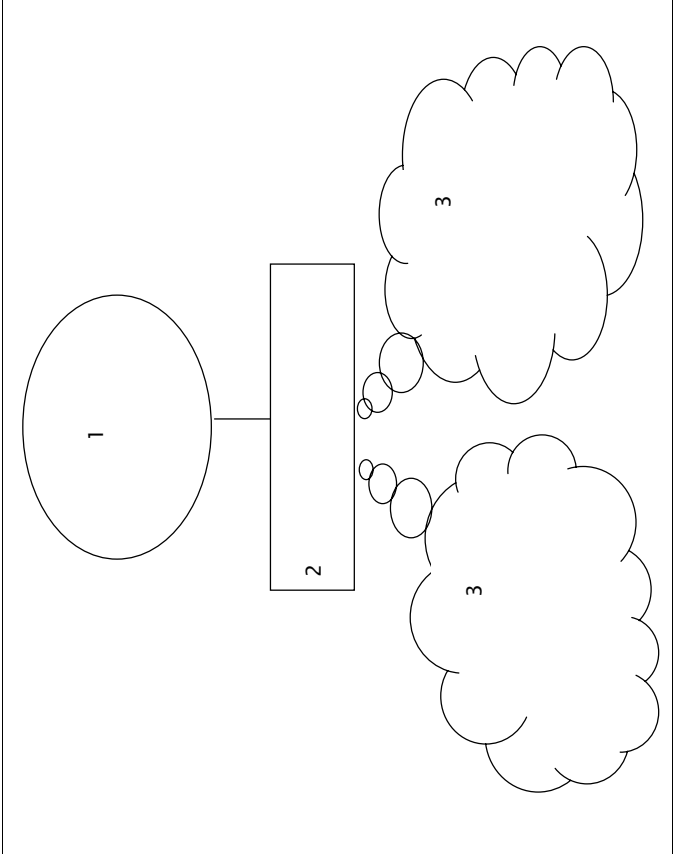
WEB OFF THE WORD™
1st COMMENTARY SENTENCE

CD: _____



CM #1: _____

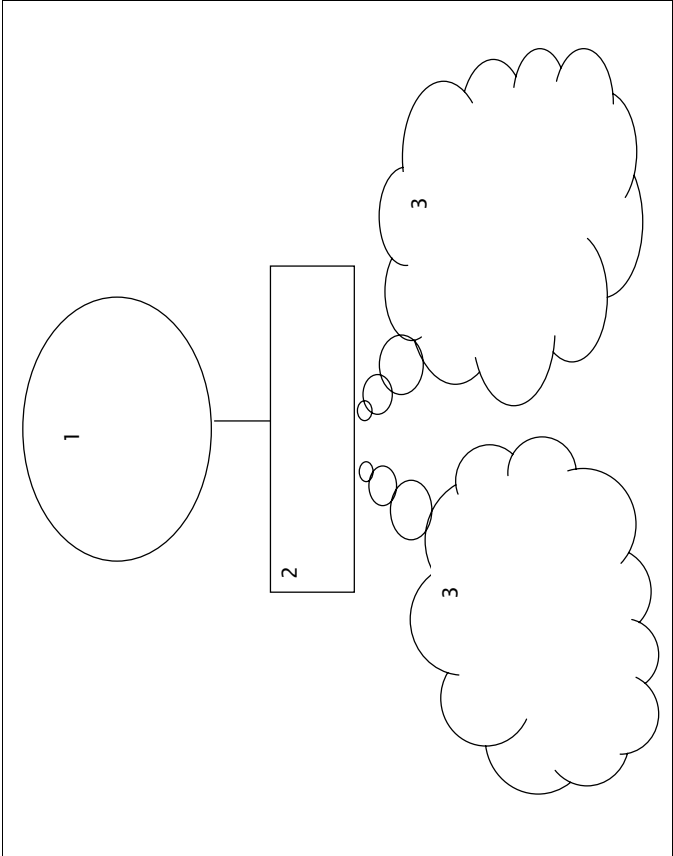
WEB OFF THE WORD™
2nd COMMENTARY SENTENCE



CM #2: _____

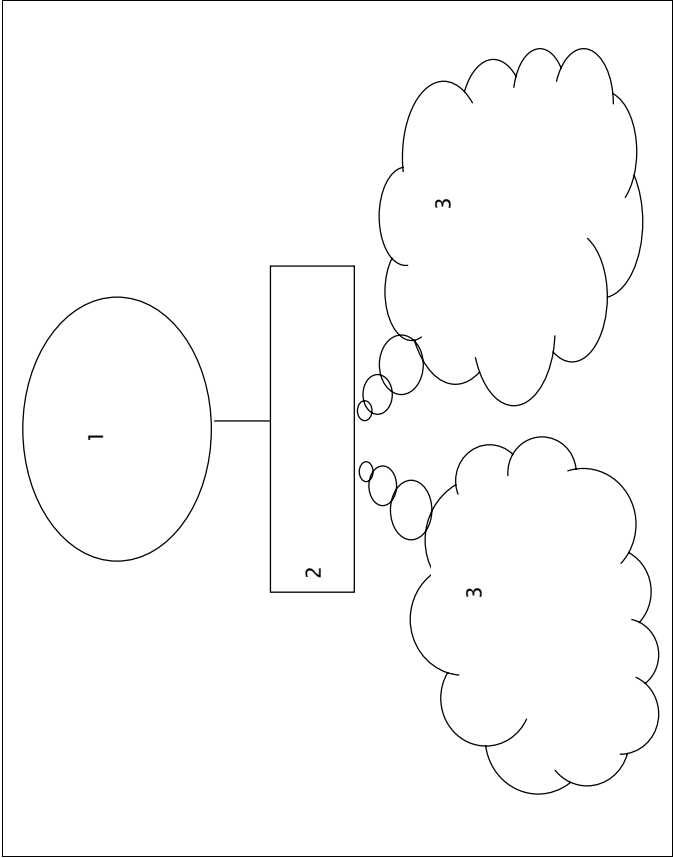
WEB OFF THE WORD™
1st COMMENTARY SENTENCE

CD: _____



CM #1: _____

WEB OFF THE WORD™
2nd COMMENTARY SENTENCE



CM #2: _____

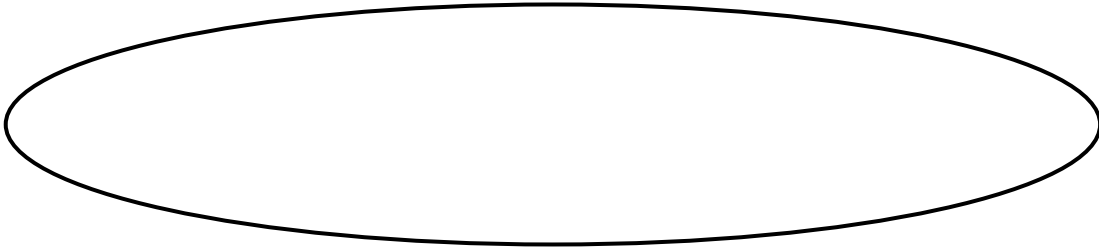
TS



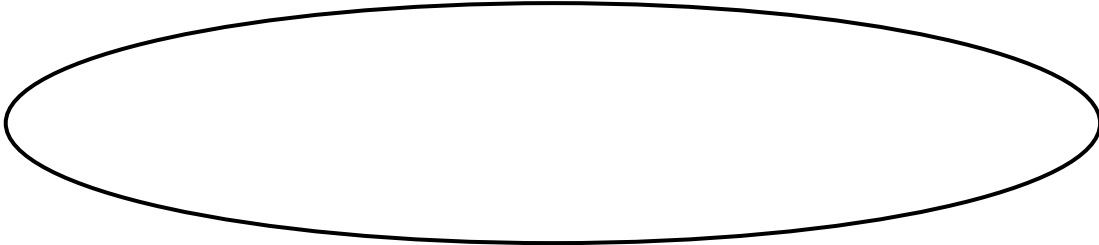
CD



**1ST
CM**



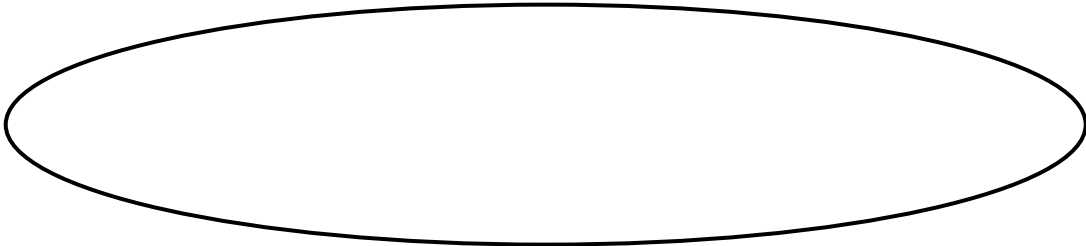
**2ND
CM**



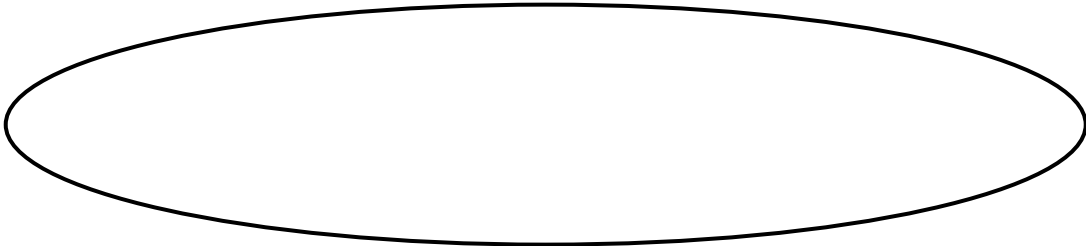
CD



**1ST
CM**



**2ND
CM**



CS



This image shows a blank sheet of primary-ruled paper. It features a series of horizontal dashed lines for writing, with a solid line at the top. A small black dot is positioned at the beginning of the first dashed line, serving as a starting point for handwriting practice. The paper is otherwise empty, with no text or other markings.

“Priscilla and the Wimps” by Richard Peck (from *SIXTEEN*, ed. Don Gallo)

Listen, there was a time when you couldn't even go to the rest room around this school without a pass. And I'm not talking about those little pink tickets made out by some teacher. I'm talking about a pass that could cost anywhere up to a buck, sold by Monk Klutter.

Not that Mighty Monk ever touched money, not in public. The gang he ran, which ran the school for him, was his collection agency. They were Klutter's Kobras, a name spelled out in nailheads on six well-known black plastic windbreakers.

Monk's threads were more...subtle. A pile-lined suede battle jacket with lizard-skin flaps over tailored Levis and a pair of ostrich-skin boots, brassed-toed and suitable for kicking people around. One of his Kobras did nothing all day but walk a half-step behind Monk, carrying passes, a cashbox, and a switchblade that Monk gave himself manicures with at lunch over at the Kobra's table.

Speaking of lunch, there were a few cases of advanced malnutrition among the newer kids. The ones who were a little slow in handing over a cut of their lunch money and were therefore barred from the cafeteria. Monk ran a tight ship.

I admit it, I'm five foot five, and when the kobras slithered by, with or without Monk, I shrank. And I admit this, too: I paid up on a regular basis. And I might add: so would you.

This school was old Monk's Garden of Eden. Unfortunately for him, there was a serpent in it. The reason Monk didn't recognize trouble when it was staring him in the face is that the serpent in the Kobras' Eden was a girl.

Practically every guy in school could show you his scars. Fang marks from Kobras, you might say. And they were all highly visible in the shower room: lumps, lacerations, blue bruises, you name it. But girls usually got off with a warning.

Except there was this one girl named Priscilla Roseberry. Picture a girl named Priscilla Roseberry, and you'll be light years off. Priscilla was, hands down, the largest student in our particular institution of learning. I'm not talking fat. I'm talking big. Even beautiful, in a bionic way. Priscilla wasn't inclined toward organized crime. Otherwise, she could have put together a gang that would turn Klutter's Kobras into garter snakes.

Priscilla was basically a loner except she had one friend. A little guy named Melvin Detweiler. You talk about the Odd Couple. Melvin's one of the smallest guys above midget status ever seen. A really nice guy, but, you know--little. They even had lockers next to each other, in the same bank as mine. I don't know what they had going. I'm not saying it was a romance. After all, people deserve their privacy.

Priscilla was sort of above everything, if you'll pardon a pun. And very calm, as only the very big can be. If there was anybody who didn't notice Klutter's Kobras, it was Priscilla.

Until one winter day after school when we were all grabbing our coats out of our lockers. And hurrying, since Klutter's Kobras made sweeps of the halls for after-school shakedowns.

Anyway, up to Melvin's locker swaggers one of the Kobras. Never mind his name. Gang members don't need names. They've got group identity. He reaches down and grabs little Melvin by the neck and slams his head against his locker door. The sound of skull against steel rippled all the way down the locker row, speeding the crowds on their way.

"Okay, let's see your pass," snarls the Kobra.

"A pass for what this time?" Melvin asks, probably still dazed.

"Let's call it a pass for very short people," says the Kobra, "a dwarf tax." He wheezes a little Kobra chuckle at his own wittiness. And already he's reaching for Melvin's wallet with the hand that isn't circling Melvin's windpipe. All this time, of course, Melvin and the Kobra are standing in Priscilla's big shadow.

She's taking her time shoving her books into her locker and pulling on a very large-sized coat. Then quicker than the eye, she brings the side of her enormous hand down in a chop that breaks the Kobra's hold on Melvin's throat. You could hear a pin drop in that hallway. Nobody's ever laid a finger on a Kobra, let alone a hand the size of Priscilla's.

Then Priscilla, who hardly ever says anything to anybody except to Melvin, says to the Kobra, "Who's your leader, wimp?" This practically blows the Kobra away. First he's chopped by a girl, and now she's acting like she doesn't know Monk Klutter, the Head Honcho of the World. He's so amazed he tells her. "Monk Klutter."

"Never heard of him," Priscilla mentions. "Send him to see me." The Kobra just backs away from her like the situation is too big for him, which it is.

Pretty soon Monk himself slides up. He jerks his head once and the Kobras slither off down the hall. He's going to handle this interesting case personally. "Who is it around here that doesn't know Monk Klutter?"

He's standing inches away from Priscilla, but since he'd have to look up at her, he doesn't. "Never heard of him," says Priscilla.

Monk's not happy with this answer, but by now he's spotted Melvin, who's grown smaller in spite of himself. Monk breaks his own rule by reaching for Melvin with his own hands. "Kid," he says, "you're going to have to educate your girlfriend."

His hands never quite make it to Melvin. In a move of pure poetry, Priscilla has Monk in a hammerlock. His neck's popping like gunfire, and his head's bowed under the immense weight of her forearm. His suede jacket's peeling back, showing pile.

Priscilla's behind him in another easy motion. And with a single mighty thrust forward, frog-marches Monk into her own locker. It's incredible. His ostrich-skin boots click once in the air. And suddenly he's gone, neatly wedged into the locker, a perfect fit. Priscilla bangs the door shut, twirls the lock, and strolls out of the school. Melvin goes with her, of course, trotting along below her shoulder. The last stragglers leave quietly.

Well, this is where fate, an even bigger force than Priscilla, steps in. It snows that night, a blizzard. The whole town ices up. And school closes for a week.

TOPIC SENTENCE CONSTRUCTION
2-CHUNK RESPONSE TO LITERATURE PARAGRAPHS

COMPARE

1. Both _____

CONTRAST

2. (1ST character's name) _____
_____,
but (2ND character's name) _____

3. Although (1ST character's name) _____,
_____,
(2ND character's name) _____

TOPIC SENTENCE CONSTRUCTION
2-CHUNK RESPONSE TO LITERATURE PARAGRAPHS
MODELS

COMPARE

1. Both Priscilla and Manuel put a stop to
tyranny.

CONTRAST

2. Roberto tries to intimidate the men, but
Manuel defends himself with dignity and
honor.
3. Although Roberto tries to intimidate the
men, Manuel defends himself with dignity
and honor.

SECOND CHOICE—2 versions:

If students are writing about TWO characters, they do one of the following:

- a. Focus on the differences and describe what each character is like on the inside—one person in the first part of the sentence and the other person in the second part.

In *Charlotte's Web* by E. B. White, Charlotte's father is skeptical, but Charlotte proves him wrong. (compound)

In *Charlotte's Web* by E. B. White, although Fern's father is skeptical, she proves him wrong. (complex)

In *Holes* by Louis Sachar, the Warden was cruel, but Stanley was stubborn. (compound)

In *Holes* by Louis Sachar, even though the Warden was cruel, Stanley was stubborn. (complex)

In *To Kill a Mockingbird* by Harper Lee, the town was prejudiced, but Atticus Finch was determined. (compound)

In *To Kill a Mockingbird* by Harper Lee, although the town was prejudiced, Atticus Finch was determined. (complex)

- b. Focus on the similarities and describe what both characters have in common.

In *Amazing Grace* by Mary Hoffman, both Grace and her family believe in her ability to reach for the stars.

In *Holes* by Louis Sachar, both Stanley and Zero wanted to prove their innocence and worth to the world.

In *Romeo and Juliet* by William Shakespeare, both Friar Lawrence and Romeo's and Juliet's families pay a bitter cost for their decisions and wreak havoc on the town.

GATHERING CDS AND CMS TWO-CHUNK RESPONSE TO LITERATURE PARAGRAPHS

Think of 4 or more possible CDs, 2 for each story, that would fit the prompt and write them below. Then circle the best CD for each story. Label them *CM1* for the 1st story and *CM2* for the second story.

What does the character do?
What happens in the story?

CDs for 1 st story	CDs for 2 nd story
• •	• •

Now brainstorm 4 or more CMs you can for each CD and write them below. Then pick the biggest, most important thought for each CD and label them *TS* in blue. Next choose the 2 best CMs for each CD and label them *CM1* and *CM2* in green. It may make it easier for you to use one of these CM helpers:

- _____ feels ___ on the inside.
- _____ feels like _____.
- Why does the character do this?

CMs for 1 st story	CMs for 2 nd story
• • • •	• • • •

PREWRITING FOR RESPONSE TO LITERATURE

RATIO: 1:2+

1. Write your topic sentence here:



2. Complete the following T-chart:

CDs
What does the character do? What happens in the story?

CMs
_____ feels/felt ____ _____ feels/felt like a ____ Why...?

1ST CHUNK:

Lead-in: _____

Quotation: _____

2ND CHUNK:

Lead-in: _____

Quotation: _____

• CM1:

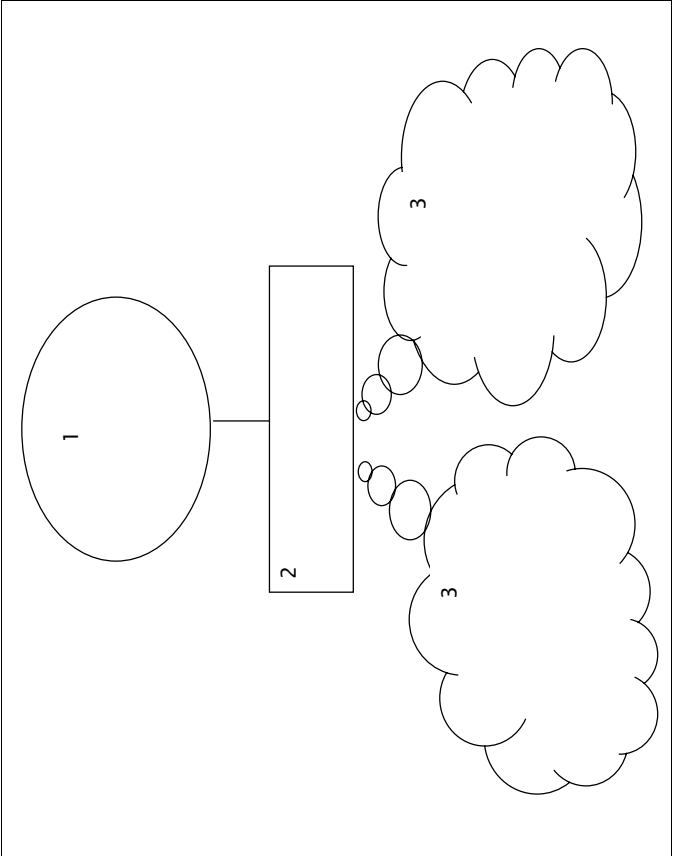
• CM2:

• CM1:

• CM2:

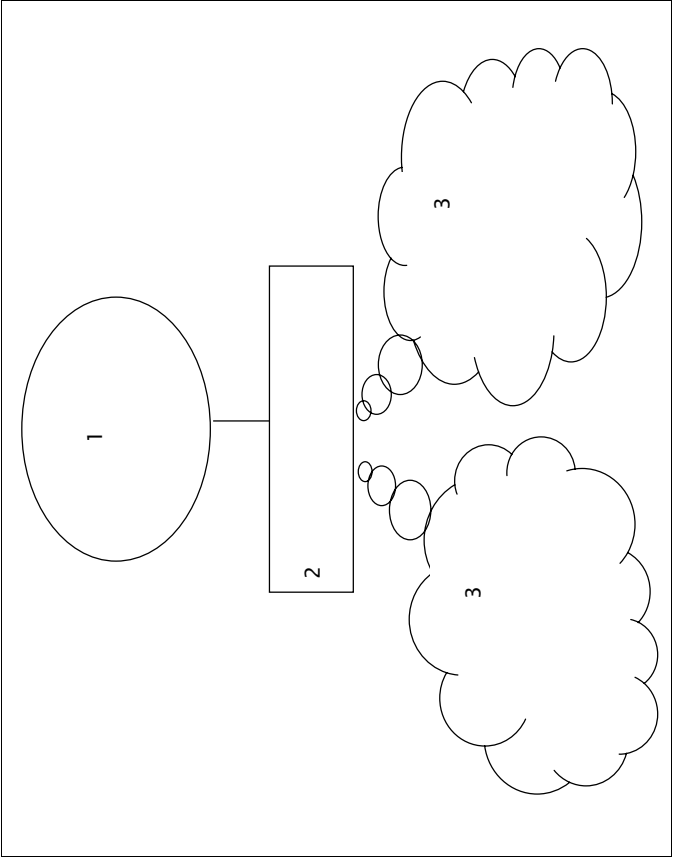
**WEB OFF THE WORD™
1st COMMENTARY SENTENCE**

CD: _____



CM #1: _____

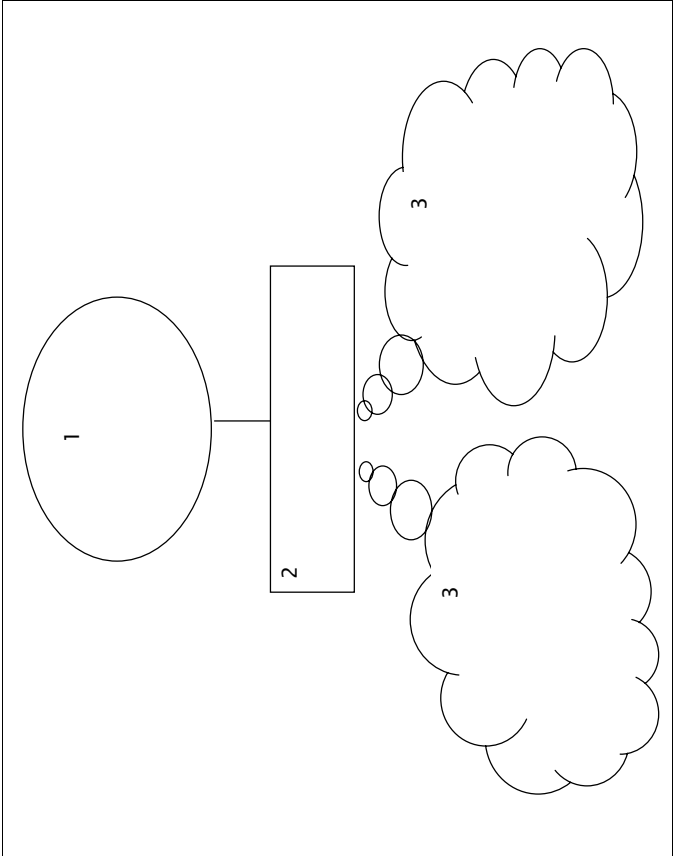
**WEB OFF THE WORD™
2nd COMMENTARY SENTENCE**



CM #2: _____

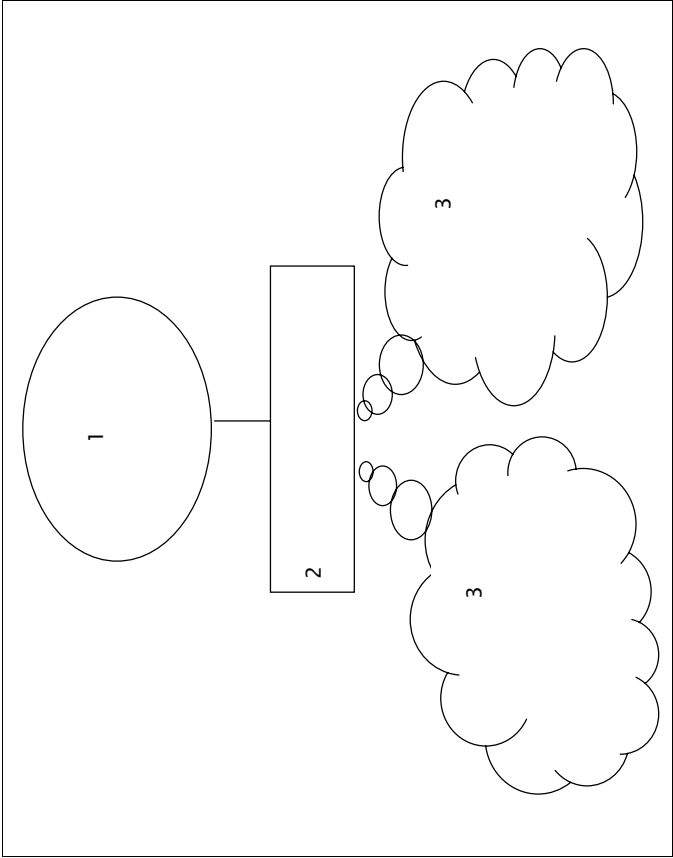
WEB OFF THE WORD™
1st COMMENTARY SENTENCE

CD: _____



CM #1: _____

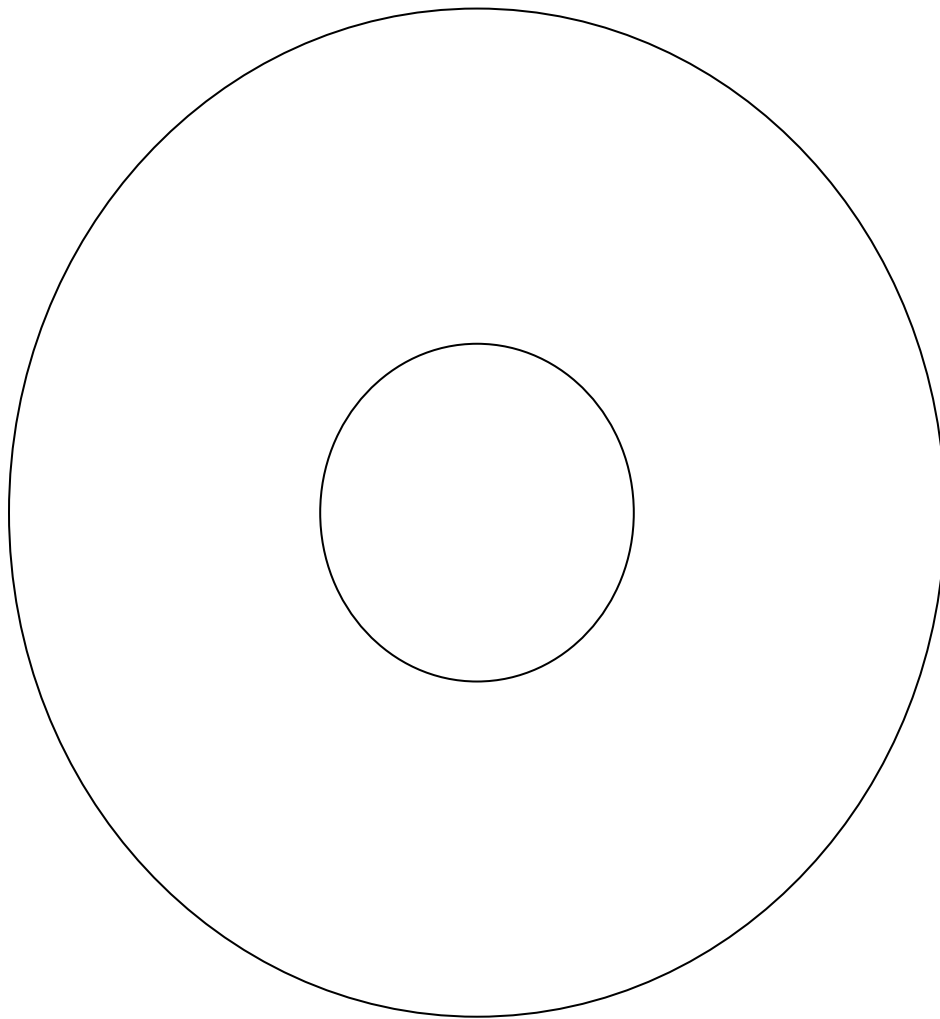
WEB OFF THE WORD™
2nd COMMENTARY SENTENCE



CM #2: _____

WEB OFF THE WORD™

Web Off the Topic Sentence for the Concluding Sentence



CS: _____

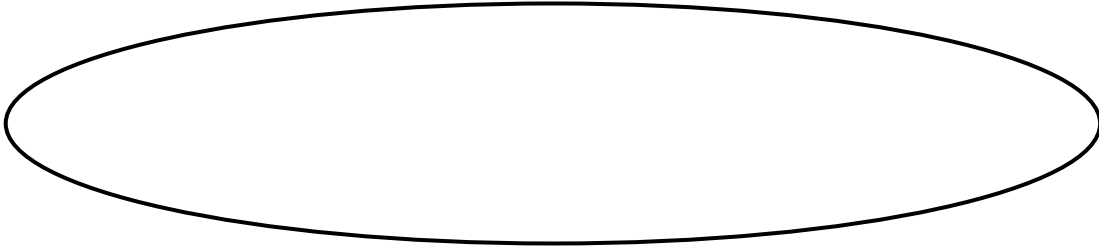
TS



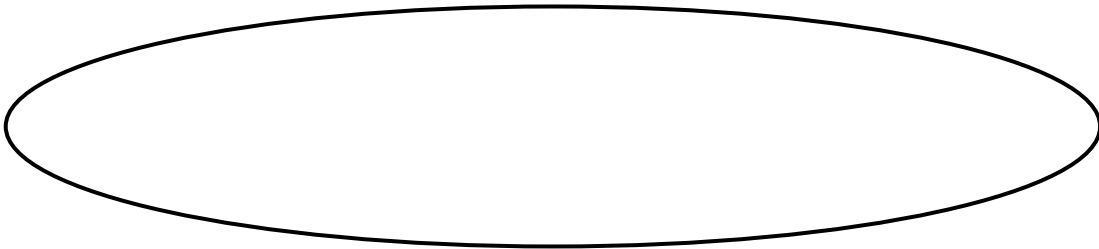
CD



**1ST
CM**



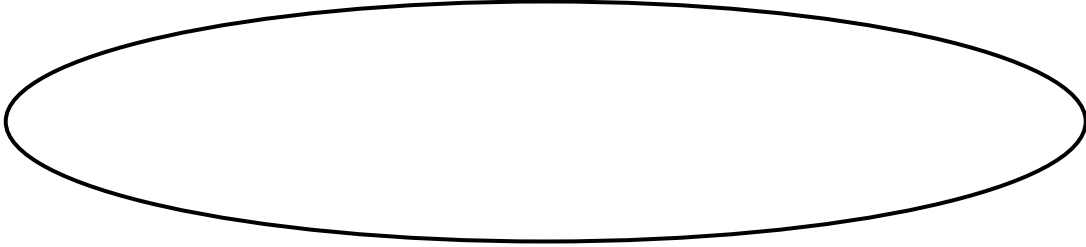
**2ND
CM**



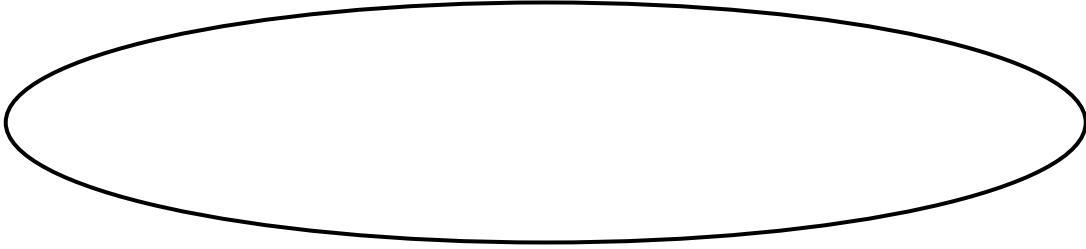
CD



**1ST
CM**



**2ND
CM**



CS



146

Half a mile from home, at the farther edge of the woods, where the land was highest, a great pine-tree stood, the last of its generation. Whether it was left for a boundary mark, or for what reason, no one could say; the wood choppers who had felled its mates were dead and gone long ago, and a whole forest of sturdy trees, pines and oaks and maples, had grown again, But the stately head of this old pine towered above them all and made a landmark for sea and shore miles and miles away. Sylvia knew it well. She had always believed that whoever climbed to the top of it could see the ocean; and the little girl had often laid her hand on the great rough trunk and looked up wistfully at those dark boughs that the wind always stirred, no matter how hot and still the air might be below...

There was the huge tree asleep yet in the paling moonlight, and small and silly Sylvia began with utmost bravery to mount the top of it, with tingling, eager blood coursing the channels of her whole frame, with her bare feet and fingers, that pinched and held like a bird's claws to the monstrous ladder reaching up, up, almost to the sky itself. First she must mount the white oak tree that grew alongside, where she was almost lost among the dark branches and the green leaves heavy and wet with dew; a bird fluttered off its nest, and a red squirrel ran to and fro and scolded pettishly at the harmless housebreaker. Sylvia felt her way easily. She had often climbed there, and knew that higher still one of the oak's upper branches chafed against the pine trunk, just where its lower boughs were set close together. There, when she made the dangerous pass from one tree to the other, the great enterprise would really begin.

She crept out along the swaying oak limb at last, and took the daring step across into the old pine-tree. The way was harder than she thought; she must reach far and hold fast, the sharp dry twigs caught and held her and scratched her like angry talons, the pitch made her thin littler fingers clumsy and stiff as she went round and round the tree's great stem...

The tree seemed to lengthen itself out as she went up, and to reach farther and farther upward. It was like a great main-mast to the voyaging

earth; it must truly have been amazed that morning through all its ponderous frame as it felt this determined spark of human spirit creeping and climbing from higher branch to branch. Who knows how steadily the least twigs held themselves to advantage this light, weak creature on her way! The old pine must have loved his new dependent. More than all the hawks, and bats, and moths, and even the sweet-voiced thrushes, was the brave, beating heart of the solitary gray-eyed child. and the tree stood still and held away the winds that June morning while the dawn grew bright in the east.

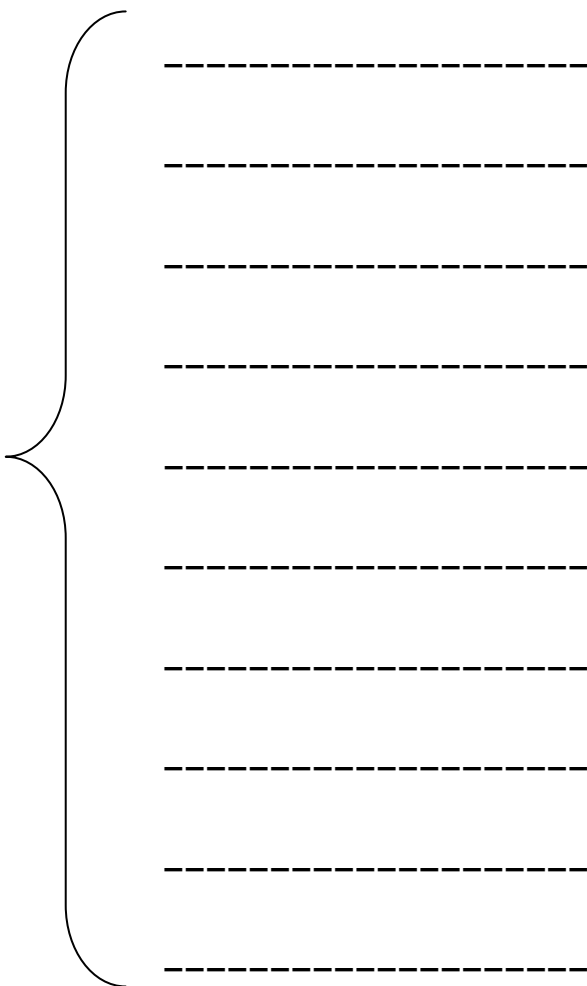
Sylvia's face was like a pale star, if one had seen it from the ground, when the last thorny bough was past, and she stood trembling and tired but wholly triumphant, high in the tree-top. Yes, there was the sea with the dawning sun making a golden dazzle over it, and toward that glorious east flew two hawks with slow-moving pinions. How low they looked in the air from that height when before one has only seen them far up, and dark against the blue sky. Their gray feathers were as soft as moths; they seemed only a little way from the tree, and Sylvia felt as if she too could go flying away among the clouds. Westward, the woodlands and farms reached miles and miles into the distance; here and there were church steeples, and white villages; truly it was a vast and awesome world.

from "A White Heron" by Sarah Orne Jewett
from *THE COUNTRY OF THE POINTED FIRS*
AND OTHER STORIES
1896

DISCOVERING THEME

Fill in the blank as many times as you have thoughts:

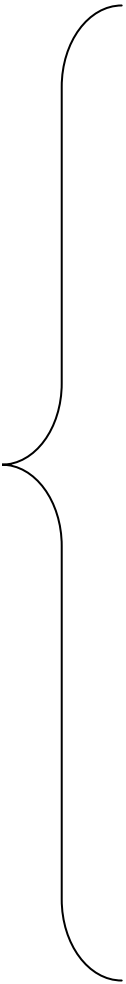
_____ is a story about



DISCOVERING THEME

Fill in the blank as many times as you have thoughts:

the excerpt from *A White Heron* is a story about



- overcoming challenges
- perseverance
- determination
- achieving a goal
- testing herself
- overcoming odds
- new experiences
- breaking away from the routine
- breaking out
- daring to be different
- struggle
- becoming one with nature
- having a vision

WEB OFF THE THEMES

Perseverance

- working at it till it's done
- undeterred by obstacles
- motivation comes from the inside, not imposed on her by others

Curiosity

- wants to find out what is out there
- the unexplored
- stretches beyond the comfort zone

Achieving a goal

- proving to herself that she can do whatever she chooses
- has a new perspective on the world
- thrilled she has taken the risk and won

WEB OFF THE THEMES

Perseverance

- working at it till it's done
- undeterred by obstacles
- motivation comes from the inside, not imposed on her by others

Curiosity

- wants to find out what is out there
- the unexplored
- stretches beyond the comfort zone

Achieving a goal

- proving to herself that she can do whatever she chooses
- has a new perspective on the world
- thrilled she has taken the risk and won

Risk-taking

- accepts possible danger or failure
- dares to be different
- opening up to new experiences

WEB OFF THE THEMES

Excerpt from *A White Heron*

Perseverance

- working at it till it's done
- undeterred by obstacles
- strong-willed -- not giving up
- tenacious -- seeing things through till the end
- motivation comes from inside, internal, not imposed on her by others
- having a vision

Achieving a goal

- proving to herself that she can do whatever she chooses to do
- brings a vision to reality
- internal strength, believes in herself, unstoppable
- personal growth, has new perspectives on the world, elated that she has overcome obstacles
- allowed herself to be helped by someone or something else

Curiosity

- wants to find out things
- what's out there
- the unexplored
- wants to understand explanations she's heard
- endless possibilities
- stretches beyond the comfort zone

Risk-taking

- accepts the possibility of danger and injury
- accepts the possibility of failure
- doesn't accept things the way they are
- intrinsic rewards
- dares to be different
- breaking away from routine
 - breaking out, opening up to new experiences, trying something new
- being adventurous, taking chances, a thrill
- growth only comes through uncomfortable situations

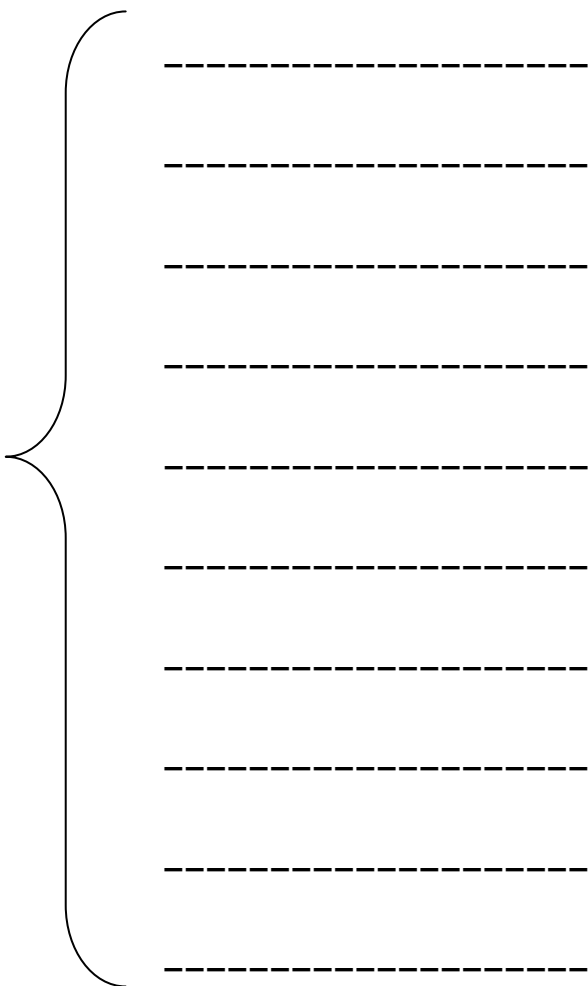
Becoming one with nature

- appreciation for nature
- respect for nature
- recognizes the grandeur
- inside of nature
 - not an observer but a participant
- nature helps her achieve her goal but tests her first, passes the test
- she and nature become one

DISCOVERING THEME

Fill in the blank as many times as you have thoughts:

_____ is a story about



WEB OFF THE THEMES

A diagram consisting of a small rectangular box on the left and a larger rectangular box on the right. A horizontal arrow points from the right side of the small box to the left side of the large box.

A diagram consisting of a small rectangular box on the left and a larger rectangular box on the right. A horizontal arrow points from the right side of the small box to the left side of the large box.

A diagram consisting of a small rectangular box on the left and a larger rectangular box on the right. A horizontal arrow points from the right side of the small box to the left side of the large box.

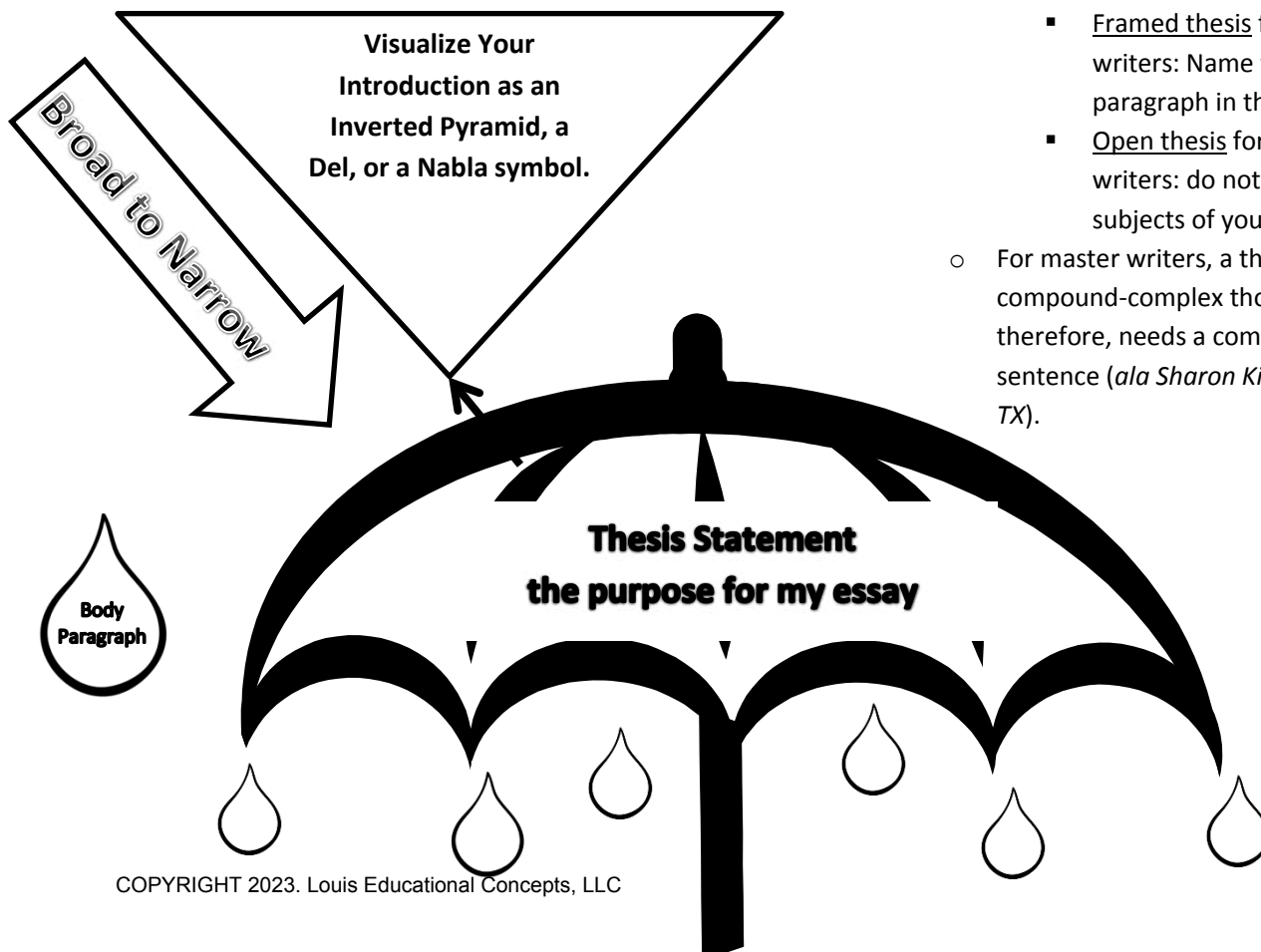
Building an Introduction for the Literary Essay

General Information: One of the main goals to achieve with the title and the introduction of an essay is to engage the reader's mind from the outset. A good rule of thumb is to estimate that 10% of your essay belongs to the introduction. If the teacher asks for a 1500-word essay, then estimate about 150 words toward the intro. If your professor asks for a 15-page document, then about 1.5 pages will go to the intro. In the first case, and in the majority of timed writings, a good idea is to place the thesis statement as the last sentence of your introductory paragraph. In the second case, with an introduction that extends to almost two pages, the thesis statement will usually appear in the intro but probably not the first paragraph. Granted, different instructors have different rules, so pay attention to their guidelines.

Options for How to Begin:

- Begin with a theme in mind; in other words, what is this literary work "really" about –
 - Elementary and Middle School – What is the lesson you have learned?
 - High School –
 - What does this work tell us about human nature or the human psyche?
 - What universal truth is presented?
 - What is the author's purpose?
- A quotation related to a theme in the work

- ◆ Start by capturing your reader's attention with interesting observations about a theme without naming the title or the author.
- ◆ Like the del or nabla symbol, the top or beginning of an introduction should be somewhat broad. This means to begin your introduction with broad statements about life – that's why we read literature: to learn about our complex selves.
- ◆ End with a Thesis Statement:
 - One complete sentence
 - The thesis answers this question: What is the purpose of this essay? What is this essay going to present, explain, argue.
 - Two options:
 - Framed thesis for beginning writers: Name the topic of each paragraph in the thesis
 - Open thesis for developing writers: do not name the subjects of your paragraphs
 - For master writers, a thesis statement is a compound-complex thought and, therefore, needs a compound-complex sentence (*ala Sharon Kingston. Lubbock, TX*).



SHAPING FOR THE INTRODUCTION RESPONSE TO LITERATURE MODEL

SENTENCE NUMBER	WHAT IT DOES	SENTENCE
1	▪ a theme sentence that introduces one or more themes from the story ▪ all commentary ▪ no CD from the story	
2	▪ your thesis ▪ names the book and author ▪ has 2 or more CM words in it	

SHAPING FOR THE INTRODUCTION RESPONSE TO LITERATURE

SENTENCE NUMBER	WHAT IT DOES	SENTENCE
1	▪ a theme sentence that introduces one or more themes from the story ▪ all commentary ▪ no CD from the story	
2	▪ says more stuff about the first sentence ▪ remembers where the thesis is going	
3	▪ your thesis ▪ names the book and author ▪ has 2 or more CM words in it	

INTRODUCTION CHOICES

1 SENTENCE	2 SENTENCES	3 SENTENCES
In <i>HARRY POTTER AND THE SORCERER’S STONE</i> by J. K. Rowling, Harry is unsure at the beginning but confident at the end.	Bravery cannot exist where defense of the weak is easy. In <i>HARRY POTTER AND THE SORCERER’S STONE</i> by J. K. Rowling, Harry risks much so that he can be a champion for the underdog.	Bravery cannot exist where defense of the weak is easy. Often, in order to help others, a hero must be willing to act in ways that are scary. In <i>HARRY POTTER AND THE SORCERER’S STONE</i> by J. K. Rowling, Harry risks much so that he can be a champion for the underdog.

Building a Conclusion for the Literary Essay

General Information: The purpose of a conclusion is threefold:

- 1) to reflect on the major points of the essay without renaming them or adding new information;
- 2) to provide a finished feeling to the essay; and
- 3) to leave your reader thinking about your idea(s) and even wanting to find and read more writing by you!

For academic essays, a good rule of thumb is to estimate that 10% of your essay belongs to the conclusion.

- ◆ Start by restating your thesis statement – do not repeat it; restate the idea or purpose of the essay
- ◆ Elementary/Middle School: What are you trying to show your reader?
- ◆ High School: You are going to gradually move from the narrowness of the topic to the significance of the topic – broader view

Options for How to End:

- How does knowing what you have written improve another person's life or outlook or journey?
- Reflect on the significance of this topic as it relates to the human condition; in other words, what can we say about how people "really" are?

Restate the Purpose of your Essay
WITHOUT REPEATING THE THESIS

Visualize Your
Conclusion as a
Pyramid or
Delta Symbol

Narrow to Broad

The gift is your essay . . .

. . . the bow is your conclusion



SHAPING FOR THE CONCLUSION RESPONSE TO LITERATURE

SENTENCE NUMBER	CM HELPERS	SENTENCE
1	(In this story, the author wanted us to realize that)...	
2	This sentence gives a finished feeling to the whole essay. Use one of the following CM helpers to think of ideas: <i>(and)...</i> <i>(because)...</i> <i>(because)...(and)...</i> <i>(and)...(because)...</i> OR Answer this questions to think of ideas for this sentence: <i>What does sentence #1 mean?</i>	

SHAPING FOR THE CONCLUSION RESPONSE TO LITERATURE

SENTENCE NUMBER	CM HELPERS	SENTENCE
1	(In this story, the author wanted us to realize that)...	
2	(and)... (because)... (because)...(and)... (and)...(because)...	
3	(In the final analysis,...) OR (In the big picture,...)	

CONCLUSION CHOICES

1 SENTENCE	2 SENTENCES	3 SENTENCES
When faced with adversity, any of us can be a hero.	When faced with adversity, any of us can be a hero. We can look for solutions rather than run away and stand up for what is right.	When faced with adversity, any of us can be a hero. We can look for solutions rather than run away and stand up for what is right. Each of us can stretch beyond our “little boy” fears and do the unexpected



How to Write a Literary Response Seniors' Collaboration Two-Chunk Paragraph

Thesis Statement

Topic Sentence

Concrete Detail

Commentary

Concluding Sentence

Restatement of Thesis in the Conclusion

Grendel is the personification of evil.

Grendel proves himself a brutal demon by his unholy slayings and heartless battery on the brave men of Herot. As sleeping men dream, Grendel “[. . .] smash[es] them/Unknowing in their beds and r[uns] out with their bodies” (*Beo.* 37-38). Grendel thrives on blood and gore and then shows gleeful emotion after he dishonorably preys on the Danes’ weakness. Grendel turns a man’s peaceful dream into a bloody nightmare. When the Geats arrive to rid Herot of Grendel, the monster grabs and

[. . .] snatch[es] at the first Geat

He [comes] to, rip[s] him apart, cut[s]

His body to bits with powerful jaws,

Dr[inks] the blood from his veins and bolt[s]

Him down, hands and feet [. . .]. (*Beo.* 263-66)

The description of this scene creates a horrific picture in the reader’s mind; within only a matter of seconds Grendel demonstrates rage and destruction. After he ravages their bodies, he leaves the Geats writhing in their own pools of remaining blood and agony. Grendel leaves pain, death, and destruction wherever he goes.

Not only does Grendel’s loathsome behavior illustrate his innate evil, but also the murky environment in which he lives reflects his sinful lifestyle. “In the darkness [. . .] Grendel [. . .] haunt[s] the moors, the wild/Marshes, and [makes] his home in a hell/Not hell but earth” (*Beo.* 2, 17-18). Dwelling in such a horrific and opaque Hell, Grendel’s malicious soul cannot survive anywhere other



than the ominous and sinister terrains hidden from all that is good. When Beowulf encounters Grendel and rips off his arm, Grendel drags himself back to his lair where

The water was bloody, steaming and boiling

In horrible pounding waves, heat

Suck[s] from his magic veins; but the swirling

Surf [covers] his death, hidden

Deep in murky darkness his miserable

End, as hell open[s] to receive him. (*Beo.* 369-74)

As Grendel begins to die, his home boils over with evil from years of wickedness and immorality. Within his murky grave Grendel's wretched soul is finally merged with his surroundings. Grendel's devilish dwellings reflect all that is evil.

In the epic poem *Beowulf*, iniquity is innate in the character of Grendel.

Without highlighting and With an Introduction

Today, violence and evil is an every day occurrence. No where is that more obvious than in the nightly news and the weekly films presented in our newspapers or on the internet. In contemporary film and literature, one does not have to search far to discover a violent scene. Violence and evil, however, have always existed as demonstrated in the Old English epic poem *Beowulf*. In *Beowulf*, the character Grendel is the personification of evil.

Grendel proves himself a brutal demon by his unholy slayings and heartless battery on the brave men of Herot. As sleeping men dream, Grendel “[. . .] smash[es] them/Unknowing in their beds and r[uns] out with their bodies” (*Beo.* 37-38). Grendel thrives on blood and gore and then shows gleeful emotion after he dishonorably preys on the Danes’ weakness. Grendel turns a man’s peaceful dream into a bloody nightmare. When the Geats arrive to rid Herot of Grendel, the monster grabs and

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Him down, hands and feet [. . .]. (*Beo.* 263-66)

The description of this scene creates a horrific picture in the reader’s mind; within only a matter of seconds Grendel demonstrates rage and destruction. After he ravages their bodies, he leaves the Geats writhing in their own pools of remaining blood and agony. Grendel leaves pain, death, and destruction wherever he goes. Not only does Grendel’s loathsome behavior illustrate his innate evil, but also the murky environment in which he lives reflects his sinful lifestyle. “In the darkness [. . .] Grendel [. . .] haunt[s] the moors, the wild/Marshes, and [makes] his home in a hell/Not hell but earth” (*Beo.* 2, 17-18). Dwelling in such a horrific and opaque Hell, Grendel’s malicious soul cannot survive anywhere other than the ominous and sinister terrains hidden from all that is good. When *Beowulf* encounters Grendel and rips off his arm, Grendel drags himself back to his lair where

The water was bloody, steaming and boiling

In horrible pounding waves, heat
Suck[s] from his magic veins; but the swirling
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As Grendel dies, his home boils over with evil from years of wickedness and immorality. Within his murky grave Grendel's wretched soul is finally merged with his surroundings. Grendel's devilish dwellings reflect all that is evil.

In the epic poem *Beowulf*, iniquity is innate in the character of Grendel. As with most good stories, however, good wins over evil. Hopefully, that trend will continue.

MASTER

2001 Advanced Placement® Literature and Composition – Question 1

In this timed free response, the writers of the test ask the students to compare two passages that describe the sirens of Homer’s *Odyssey* – from Odysseus’ perspective and from one of the sirens’ perspective

Homer’s *Odyssey* and Margaret Atwood’s “Siren Song.”

The Scarlet Letter by Nathaniel Hawthorne

The following passage is titled “The Prison Door.” It is chapter one of Nathaniel Hawthorne’s *The Scarlet Letter*. Read it carefully. Then analyze the speaker’s tone through the author’s use of diction, selection of detail, imagery, and/or allusion.

“My Papa’s Waltz” by Theodore Roethke

One of the most important elements of any poem is its imagery – the words and phrases that appeal to one or more of the five senses. In addition to re-creating sensory experiences, however, imagery calls upon particular ideas and emotions. Carefully read the poem “My Papa’s Waltz” by Theodore Roethke. Then, in a well-developed 2-chunk paragraph (1:2+), analyze how the imagery in the poem creates two different but complementary tones of the poem.

Title of Piece: **The Odyssey**

Speaker: **A man, Odysseus, the hero, brave, strong, masculine, telling the tale of *his* adventure, describing the Sirens**

Occasion: **Classical Greek, epic poem – adventure, heroism**

Odysseus is describing his journey, the challenges along the way

Audience: **Odysseus's people**

Purpose: **To describe this great adventure and his courage**

Subject: **bravery, courage, strength, will power, conquering temptations**

Tone: **Poetic, romantic, picturesque, melodic, lyrical**

dramatic, exaggerated

Diction

"my strength"

Imagery

**"strong hands"
"a man's shout"
"heart [. . .] throbbed
"steadfast crew"
"honeyed voices pouring from
our lips"
"burst into their high thrilling
song"**

Title of Piece: “Siren Song”

Speaker: A mythical bird with the head of a woman; one of the three sirens whose objective is to destroy sailors and their ships

Occasion: Modern interpretation of the siren myth; she’s on the island with two other sirens and says she wants off

Audience: A man, a sailor, moving closer to her

Purpose: To persuade him to rescue her from this life she hates, to tell him the secret of the song, to appeal to his manhood

Subject: Seduction, appearance vs. reality, gullibility

Tone: Cynical, sarcastic, cunning, helpless, laconic, devious

pointed, sharp, terse, mock-serious, feisty

Diction

“dead”
repetition of “the song”
“squatting”
“feathery maniacs”
“boring song” “Help me!”
“works every time”

Imagery

“beached skull”
“bird suit”



2001 Q1 Free Response

AP Literature and Composition

By Deborah E. Louis for Jane Schaffer Writing Program®

While both literary works describe the famous Sirens of Greek mythology, Homer's version romanticizes and idealizes these extraordinary creatures while Atwood depicts the Siren in "Siren Song" with no romantic or idealistic overture.

Odysseus portrays the Sirens as melodic, mythical creatures whose euphonic song can only be resisted by the strongest and bravest of men. In this famous epic poem, the hero of The Odyssey, demonstrating his "strength" of mind and body, molds beeswax in his "two strong hands," and places the wax in his "comrades" ears to prevent them from falling under the spell of the Sirens' "thrilling" song. Odysseus describes his dramatic encounter with the Sirens and his ability to only resist their tempting melody through his brute strength and intelligence. Only the strongest men of great will power are able to conquer the temptation of the Sirens. Odysseus romanticizes the Sirens' "honeyed voices pouring from [their] lips" as they "burst into their high thrilling song, and "the heart inside [him] throbbed to listen longer." He emotionally views the Sirens as creatures of beauty and delight. The speaker reveals his journey of the past to his Greek listeners and presents himself as the hero conquering the Sirens, creating an adventure greater than life with creatures beyond one's imagination. Odysseus's portrayal of the Sirens is one of awe and respect.

On the other hand, in Atwood's modern commentary on this Greek classic, the speaker, one of the three Sirens, does not conform to the picture that Odysseus paints;



instead, she is a no-nonsense, laconic creature who appears to need help in order to leave the terrible island. At the beginning of the poem, this Siren concedes that “everyone would like to learn “this song “that forces men to leap overboard,” the song nobody knows because anyone who has heard it is dead.” Unlike Odysseus’s version, there is neither poetry nor melody, nothing lyrical about this bird woman’s plight in life. Her cynicism and pointed explanation has no sexually seductive or romantic appeal as does Odysseus’s depiction. She wants to “get [. . .] out of [her] bird suit” and away from the other two “feathery maniacs,” so she cries for help, a damsel in distress, one would think. In a helpless, cunning tone, she appeals to the sailor or the ship approaching her island. But her appearance belies the reality of the situation, and her “boring song,” as she calls it, is anything but boring as she entices and destroys another unsuspecting mariner. The Siren speaking in Atwood’s poem presents a mock-serious, devious approach to her prey.

Atwood’s illustration of the speaker in “Siren Song” is that of a ruthless man-eater, while Odysseus chooses to idealize the beautiful Sirens and their song, both of which could never capture the strong, brave king as long as he’s tied hand and foot to the ship.

Paragraph “Think” Sheet

This Essay’s

Thesis Statement: _____

This Paragraph’s Topic (word or phrase): _____ **Allusions**

Topic Sentence: Hawthorne’s allusions in this passage demonstrate the irony of a new world flawed from its outset with human depravity.

Concrete Detail 1:

Although “the founders of a new colony” envision a “Utopia[n]” society as they plan their new world, they first decide to build two necessary structures: a “prison” and a “cemetery.”

Commentary:

Realizing that sin and death are the realities of any world where people co-exist, Hawthorne’s allusion to Thomas More’s *Utopia*, the Latin translation of which means “no place,” presents an ironic and dismal world.

Commentary:

Like the beauty and perfection of a long-stemmed rose, an ideal society does not exist without its thorns.

Concrete Detail 2:

Hawthorne also alludes to the “sainted Ann Hutchinson,” a historical figure of the 17th century who was exiled from Boston for opposing the austerity of Puritan dogma.

Commentary:

That Hawthorne saints Hutchinson is ironic because of her infamous character and her excommunication from the Calvinistic church by Puritan icons such as John Cotton and Governor John Winthrop.

Commentary:

What this implies is that Hawthorne aligns himself with her beliefs and her repudiation of the Puritan religion.

Concrete Detail 3:

However, among the harsh realities of the world and her people, Hawthorne does find some respite in “the deep heart of Nature,” who shows “pity” and “kind[ness]” to the criminal in this new, albeit dystopian society.

Commentary:

The personification of “Nature” alludes to the literary era of Romanticism, using Nature as a symbol of the spirit.

Commentary:

Thus, a kind and sympathetic external Nature symbolizes a kind and sympathetic human nature which, “let us hope,” exists in all of us.

Concluding Sentence: _____

While a Utopian society cannot exist because of the flaws inherent in human nature, there still exists some hope of redemption through the sympathy of Nature.



Advanced Placement Style Analysis
Nathaniel Hawthorne's *The Scarlet Letter*
Chapter One: "The Prison Door"

Sample Three-Chunk Paragraph
Dr. Deborah E. Louis for Jane Schaffer

Hawthorne's allusions in this passage demonstrate the irony of a new world flawed from its outset with human depravity but nurtured by the Hope that our Nature might provide. Although "the founders of a new colony" envision a "Utopia[n]" society as they plan their new world, they first must build two necessary structures: a "prison" and a "cemetery." Realizing that sin and death are the realities of any world where people co-exist, Hawthorne's allusion to Thomas More's *Utopia*, the Latin translation of which means "no place," presents an ironic and dismal tone and place. Like the beauty and perfection of a long-stemmed rose, an ideal society does not exist without its thorns. Hawthorne also alludes to the "sainted Ann Hutchinson," a historical figure of the 17th century who was exiled from Boston for opposing the austerity of Puritan dogma. That Hawthorne saints Hutchinson is ironic because of her infamous position in history: her excommunication from the Calvinistic church by Puritan icons such as John Cotton and Governor John Winthrop. What this implies is that Hawthorne aligns himself with her beliefs and her repudiation of the Puritan dogma. However, among the harsh realities of the world and her people, Hawthorne does find some respite in "the deep heart of Nature," who shows "pity" and "kind[ness]" to the criminal in this new, albeit dystopian, society. The personification of "Nature" alludes to the literary era of Romanticism, using Nature as a symbol of the spirit. Thus, a kind and sympathetic external Nature symbolizes a kind and sympathetic human nature which, "let us hope," exists in all of us. While a Utopian society cannot exist because of the "darker aspects" inherent in human nature, there still exists some light of redemption through the sympathy of Nature.



“My Papa’s Waltz” by Theodore Roethke

One of the most important elements of any poem is its imagery – the words and phrases that appeal to one or more of the five senses. In addition to re-creating sensory experiences, however, imagery calls upon particular ideas and emotions. Carefully read the poem, “My Papa’s Waltz” by Theodore Roethke. Then, in a well-developed 2-chunk paragraph (1:2+), analyze how the imagery in the poem creates two different but complementary tones of the poem.

Step One: Gather the imagery CD’s.

CD’s

- “whiskey on your breath” (line1)
- “hung on” (line 3)
- “romped pans slid from kitchen shelf[.]” (line 5-6)
- “mother’s [frowning]countenance” (line 8)
- “hand that held my wrist” (line 9)
- “battered on one knuckle” (line10)
- “right ear scraped a buckle” (line 12)
- “beat time on my head” (line 13)
- “palm caked hard by dirt” (line 14)
- “waltzed me off to bed” (line 15)
- “clinging to your shirt” (line 16)

Step Two: sort the CD’s into relevant categories.

Caring

- “romped pans slid from kitchen shelf[.]” (line 5-6)
- “hung on” (line 3)
- “hand that held my wrist” (line 9)
- “waltzed me off to bed” (line 15)
- “clinging to your shirt” (line 16)

Concern

- “whiskey on your breath” (line1)
- “mother’s [frowning]countenance” (line 8)
- “battered on one knuckle” (line10)
- “right ear scraped a buckle” (line 12)
- “beat time on my head” (line 13)
- “palm caked hard by dirt” (line 14)

Step Three: Create a “working” Topic Sentence

TS = Subject + Opinion

Subject = The imagery in “My Papa’s Waltz” **Opinion** = the tone (s) created

Working Topic Sentence

In the poem “My Papa’s Waltz” Theodore Roethke’s imagery creates a critical and loving tone while describing the complexity of a father son relationship.

Step Four: Select the best cd's from your list.**Caring**

- “romped pans slid from kitchen shelf[.]” (line 5-6)
- “hung on” (line 3)
- “hand that held my wrist” (line 9)
- “waltzed me off to bed” (line 15)
- “clinging to your shirt” (line 16)

Concern

- “whiskey on your breath” (line1)
- “mother’s [frowning]countenance” (line 8)
- “battered on one knuckle” (line10)
- “right ear scraped a buckle” (line 12)
- “beat time on my head” (line 13)
- “palm caked hard by dirt” (line 14)

Step Five: Brainstorm the Commentary. Using key words and/or phrases brainstorm how the concrete detail is important to your topic sentence. It is important to remember that the commentary should NOT paraphrase or explain the CD but rather analyze how the specific CD supports or proves your topic sentence

Concrete Detail	Commentary Brainstorm
“hung on” (line 3)	He enjoys the ride, it is like a hug, having fun with father. He is devoted to his father.
“clinging to your shirt” (line 16)	Doesn’t want to let go, is desperate to spend time, willing participates, boisterous fun
“whiskey on your breath” (line1)	Alcoholism, dangerous, not in control,
“battered on one knuckle” (line10)	Father is rough, has been in fights, a tough guy

Step 6: Write the rough draft of your paragraph

In the poem “My Papa’s Waltz” Theodore Roethke’s imagery creates a caring and concerned tone while describing the complexity of a father son relationship. In the first two stanzas of the poem the father has “whiskey on [his] breath” (line1) and a battered [. . .] knuckle” (line 10). These images illustrate a father with some troubling issues. The boy appears mistreated through the depiction of a rough and drunken father whose physical domination and rough demeanor causes the youngster concern. However, in Roethke’s innocent narrator there is also an underlying tone of love and care, as the son “[hangs] on” (line 3) to his father and “[clings] to [his] shirt” (line 16). Loving and tender images, such as these, depict a devoted son having fun with his rough and boisterous father. The fact that he will not let go of his father indicates that the boy willingly participates in the horseplay between the two, and they feel love for one another. The imagery in this poem creates a memorable scene of a happy time fused with the reality of a harsh life.

Step 7: Edit your work



2-Body Paragraph Essay

Life is filled with both good and bad memories. Those memories usually begin in our childhood when we think of the years spent with our parents. Sometimes a memory might include both good and bad feelings. In the poem “My Papa’s Waltz” Theodore Roethke’s imagery reveals a child who is both critical of his father while at the same time shows great love.

In the poem, Roethke’s narrator is a young boy who depicts a moment in time in which he realizes his father’s flaws. In the first two stanzas of the poem the father has “whiskey on [his] breath” (line 1) while the son’s mother looks on with an expression that “[c]ould not unfrown itself.” (line 8) These images give the poem a troubling edge. The boy and mother live with a rough and drunken father. The concerned tone is strengthened by the image of the mother who disapproves of the father’s rowdy behavior, primarily caused by his drunken state. Similarly, the description of the father’s “[...] battered . . . knuckle” (line 10) and the boy’s “[...] right ear scrap[ing] a buckle” (line 12) reveals that he is no stranger to fighting even though he is teaching his son what is normally an elegant form of dance. With each misstep, the boy realizes both his father’s inability to function as well as his father’s inward flaws. Even though a very young, the child understands the frailties of the man.

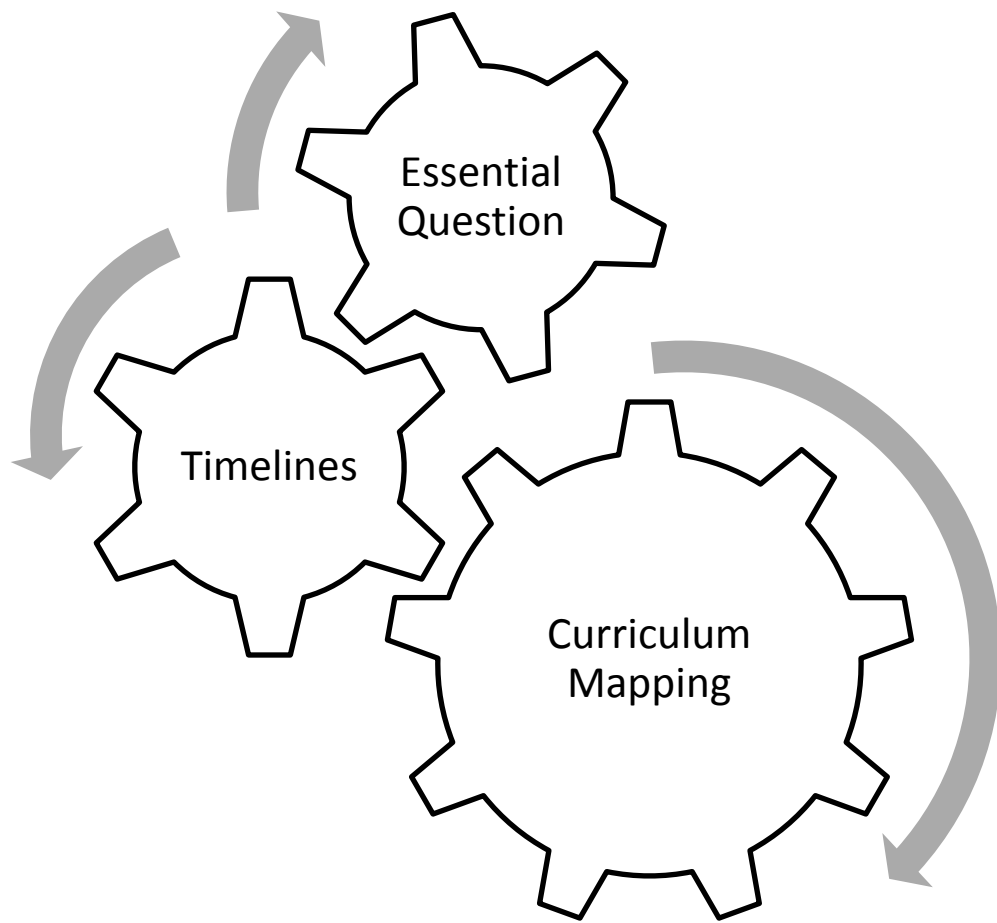
Even though Roethke’s narrator sees that his father is not perfect, in the son’s memory of the waltz is also a child who cherishes the moment of his father’s love. Throughout the poem the boy “[hangs] on” (line 3) to his father and “[clings]” to [his] shirt (line 16). These loving and tender images depict a devoted son having fun with his rough and boisterous father. The fact that he will not let go indicates that the boy willingly participates in the horseplay with his father and feels love for him. The rough-and-tumble play between father and son is a scene which most children hope to experience with their fathers. As they “[romp]” during their dance, “pans” slide off the kitchen shelves (lines 5-6). Their boisterous play finally ends when his father “[waltzes him] off to bed” (line 15). The jaunty images of a playful father-son experience demonstrate an affectionate relationship between the two. The son cherishes the love his father displays toward him even if that sort of play also reveals to the boy a darker side of the father. The child relishes the fun and affection as he waltzes to his room to sleep with a happy memory. The images of play in the poem depict a delightful moment between a father and son in which their rowdy play expresses the care they feel for one another.

The imagery in “My Papa’s Waltz” illustrates that a moment in time can have different feelings associated with it. As children grow up, they remember the memories with their parents who turn out to be not as perfect as once we had once thought. Parents are human, and as humans we have great moments and not so great ones.



A Teacher's Toolbox

Analytical Response to Literature



JSWP™ Mapping**Unit: Response to Literature**

Essential Question(s)	Content	Strategy	Skills	Teacher Materials/Resources	Student Handouts	Assessment
How can I become a good writer? Do professional writers struggle like I do? How do I start? What is a paragraph?	Concept: Well-written essays contain paragraphs with certain structural elements to make meaning. 1.1-4 Color-Coding a Paragraph	Model	1.1 Apply blue color to first sentence in a model paragraph 1.2 Apply red color to second sentence in a model paragraph 1.3 Apply green color to third and fourth sentences in a model paragraph 1.4 Apply blue color to fifth sentence in a model paragraph	1.1-4 Cinderella, one-chunk response to literature, formula version, color-coded model	Class set of blue, red, green, black ball-point ink pens will be needed for all of the following lessons 1.1-4 Paragraph Form	Copy a graphic organizer
How do I speak like a writer?	Terminology	Model	2.1 Identify and define the following terminology: • response to literature • writing prompt • essay • prewriting • key high frequency words (examine, infer, analyze, etc.) • paragraph • indent • T-chart • topic sentence • concrete details • commentary • Web-off-the-Word • Web-off-the-Topic Sentence • concluding sentence • ratio	2.1-2 Cinderella, one-chunk response to literature, formula version, color coded and labeled (VC2) JSWP – terminology definitions 2.2 Concrete detail/commentary synonym chart	2.1-2 Use completed exercise from above JSWP – terminology definitions	Label parts of above graphic organizer Take a short-answered constructed response quiz on terminology Explain to paired person what each term means and its purpose in a paragraph Correct and frequent use of terms in written work and orally

			• chunk • weaving • shaping • introduction • thesis • conclusion • proofreading • revising • draft			
Why must I know the difference between fact and opinion? How can I effectively express my own ideas and the ideas of others?	Concrete Details (CDs) Commentary (CMs) Web-off-the-Word Topic Sentence (TS) Concluding Sentence (CS)	Model	3.1 Think of 3 or more CDs that would fit the prompt and write them. Then circle, underline, or star the one best CD 3.2 Think of 4 or more CMs you can use for your CD and write them. Then pick the best 3. Label the biggest, most important idea <i>TS</i> in blue. Label the <i>CM1</i> and <i>CM2</i> ideas in green. It may make it easier to use CM helpers. 3.2a Transfer your information to a T-Chart 3.4a-c Web-off-the-Word™ to create commentary 3.5 Web-off-the-Topic Sentence™ to create concluding sentence 3.6 Revise your Topic Sentence to include more commentary words	3.1-2 Cinderella, Gathering CDs and CMs, color coded 3.2a Cinderella, T-chart, blank and color coded 3.3 Web off the Word™, steps to follow 3.4a Cinderella, webbing, 1 synonym with 2 clouds, simplest version for special education and ELL students, color coded 3.4b Cinderella, webbing, 2 synonyms with 2 clouds each for general students, color coded 3.4c Cinderella, webbing, 3 synonyms with 2 clouds each for honors/gifted students, color coded 3.5 Cinderella, Web off the Topic Sentence™ for the concluding sentence, blank and color coded, side by side 3.5 Web off the Topic Sentence™ to create the concluding sentence, steps to follow 3.6 Constructing Topic Sentences	3.1-2 Gathering CDs/CMs 3.2a T-chart, blank 3.4a-c Cinderella, blank Web off the Word™ form, single webs, side by side 3.5 Web off the Topic Sentence™, blank	

What is the best way to arrange my ideas to make logical sense?	Shaping	Model	4.1 Organize your sentences onto a shaping sheet, proofing and revising as you go	4.1 Cinderella, shaping sheet, completed, color coded (18)	4.1 Shaping Sheet	
	Review		5.1 Summarize to your partner the parts of a one-chunk body paragraph	1.1-4 Cinderella, one-chunk response to literature, formula version, color-coded model Level One Harry Potter paragraph	1.1-4 Paragraph Form Blank Paragraph Form	Color-code and label the five parts of a paragraph
	The Writing Process	Shared Writing	Follow steps 1-5 to analyze how Cinderella feels in the second half of the story.	Blank organizers for a one-chunk paragraph in transparency form for overhead projector or hard copies for document camera	Student Packet of blank organizers for a one-chunk paragraph	Discuss and agree upon sentences to compose a second one-chunk body paragraph
	First half of Story of your choice	Paired Writing	Compose a paragraph		Student Packet for the pair	Write a one-chunk (1:2+) response to literature paragraph that discusses how a character feels in the first half of the story.
	Second Half of Story	Individual	Compose a paragraph		Individual Student Packet	Write a one-chunk (1:2+) response to literature paragraph that discusses how a character feels in the second half of the story.
	Thesis	Model, Individual	Construct a Thesis Statement using the template provided	Cinderella model, second story	Introduction shaping sheet (119) Introduction Paragraph Form	Copy model onto Introductory Paragraph form Independently compose an introductory paragraph for story provided by teacher
	Concluding Paragraph	Model, Individual	Construct a one-sentence Concluding paragraph using the template provided	Cinderella model, second story	Concluding Paragraph shaping sheet Concluding Paragraph	Copy model onto Concluding Paragraph form Independently compose a concluding paragraph for story provided by teacher
	Composition	Individual	Compose a 3 paragraph essay that includes an introduction, one one-chunk body paragraph, and a conclusion	Writing prompt for a story the students have read	Student Packet	Constructed response that assesses the student's ability to compose a 3 paragraph essay

TIMELINE FOR MASTERY

	YEAR 1	YEAR 2	YEAR 3
Special education and ELL students	Mastery: expository paragraph, narrative essay	Review: - expository paragraph, narrative essay Mastery: - expository essay Introduce: - response to lit paragraph	Review: - response to literature paragraph, expository, and narrative essay Mastery: - response to lit essay
Regular students	Mastery: - narrative essay, expository essay Introduce: - response to lit essay	Review: - expository, narrative paragraph and essay Mastery: - response to literature essay Introduce: - argumentative essay	
Honors/Gifted/ Pre-AP and AP students	Mastery: - response to literature, expository essay - narrative essay	Review: - response to literature, expos, narrative essay Introduce and mastery: - argumentative essay	

SAMPLE TIMELINE

Overview

This is a sample timeline for general/on-level high school classes. It is too fast for special education and ELL students and too slow for honors/gifted/AP/Pre-AP classes. We recommend that you teach our writing program at the start of school or as soon as you receive the teacher's guide.

Day 1 • Rules • Diagnostic writing assignment • Writing folders	Day 2 • Model • <i>Cinderella</i> paragraph • Quiz	Day 3 • Model • <i>Cinderella</i> • Steps in the process • Quiz	Day 4 • Shared Writing • <i>To Sleep Under the Stars</i> • 1st half of the story • Quiz	Day 5 • Shared Writing • <i>To Sleep Under the Stars</i> • 2nd half of the story • Quiz
Day 6 • Shared Writing • Excerpt from <i>A White Heron</i> • 1st half of the story • Quiz	Day 7 • Shared Writing, with some pair/small group work • Excerpt from <i>A White Heron</i> • 2nd half of the story • Quiz	Day 8 • Pair/small group • Excerpt from <i>A White Heron</i> • 2nd half of the story • Quiz	Day 9 • Pair/small group • Excerpt from <i>A White Heron</i> • 2nd half of the story • Quiz	Day 10 • Pair/small group • Excerpt from <i>A White Heron</i> • 2nd half of the story • Quiz

Day 11 • Essay model • Quiz	Day 12 • Pair/small group • <i>Both Sides of the Fence</i> • 1st half of the story • Quiz	Day 13 • Pair/small group • <i>Both Sides of the Fence</i> • 2nd half of the story • Quiz	Day 14 • Shared Writing • Introduction • Quiz	Day 15 • Shared Writing • Conclusion • Works cited • Quiz
Day 16 • Independent • Story TBA • 1st half of the story • Quiz	Day 17 • Independent • Story TBA • 2nd half of the story • Quiz	Day 18 • Independent • Introduction • Quiz	Day 19 • Independent • Conclusion • Works cited • Quiz	Day 20 • Change-up day
Day 21 • Independent • Revision • Begin work on final draft	Day 22 • Independent • Continue work on final draft	Day 23 • Independent • Finish final draft • Package everything and turn it in	Day 24 • Change-up day • Review day	Day 25 • Unit test

TEACHING THE MULTIPARAGRAPH ESSAY

SAMPLE TIME LINE

Day 1 Introduction Essay layout form "Big Picture" lesson Terminology Thesis	Day 2 Pre-writing #1 & #2 (concrete detail) Bubble clusters and spider diagrams	Day 3 Pre-writing #3 (concrete detail) Outlining	Day 4 Pre-writing #4 (concrete detail) Line clusters	Day 5 Pre-writing #5 (concrete detail) Columns
Day 6 Introduce commentary	Day 7 Commentary practice	Day 8 Commentary practice	Day 9 Commentary practice	Day 10 Review thesis, pre-writing, and commentary; Quiz
Day 11 Begin literary analysis paper Read and discuss the short story, "The Scarlet Ibis"	Day 12 Finish discussing "The Scarlet Ibis"	Day 13 Begin first essay Prompt Thesis and group pre-write	Day 14 Shaping the essay	Day 15 Shaping the essay

TEACHING THE MULTIPARAGRAPH ESSAY SAMPLE TIME LINE

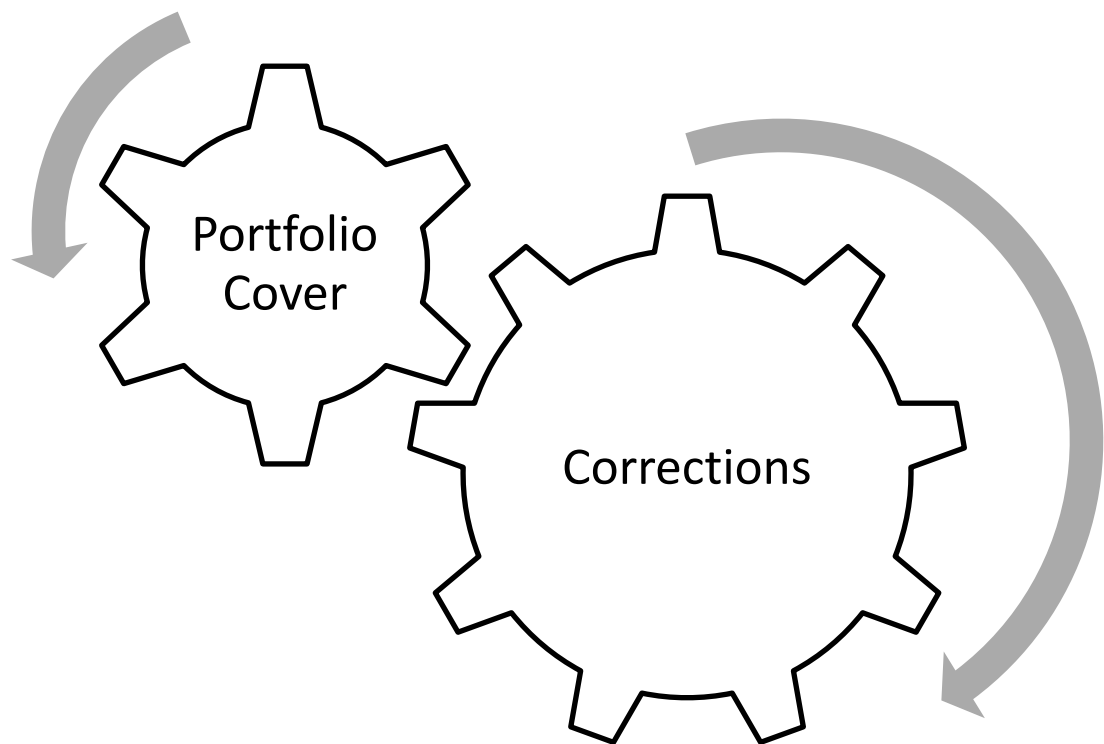
Day 16 Finish shaping the essay, if necessary Change-up day; see students individually about mistakes in shaping sheets	Day 17 Change-up day See students individually about mistakes in shaping sheets	Day 18 Begin first draft (without introductory paragraph) Thesis and paragraph #2 due at end of hour	Day 19 Continue first draft Paragraph #3 due halfway through the hour Class does concluding paragraph together on the board (paragraph #4)	Day 20 Change-up day Review day
Day 21 Teach the literature introduction and do one as a class	Day 22 Self-response on first draft	Day 23 Begin final draft	Day 24 Finish final draft	Day 25 Change-up day if necessary

TEACHING THE MULTIPARAGRAPH ESSAY SAMPLE TIME LINE

Day 26 Begin personal essay Thesis and pre-writing due at end of hour	Day 27 Shaping the essay	Day 28 Shaping the essay	Day 29 Change-up day See students individually about mistakes in shaping sheets	Day 30 Change-up day See students individually about mistakes in shaping sheets Finish first draft
Day 31 Begin first draft Thesis and paragraph #2 (1st body paragraph) due at end of hour	Day 32 Paragraph #3 (2nd body paragraph) and #4 (concluding paragraph) due at end of hour	Day 33 Teach introductory paragraphs #1 and #2 (anecdote and dialogue)	Day 34 Teach introductory paragraphs #3 and #4 (startling statement and all-commentary) Students write own introductory paragraph for their essays	Day 35 Self-response on first draft Begin final draft

TEACHING THE MULTIPARAGRAPH ESSAY SAMPLE TIME LINE

Day 36 Continue final draft	Day 37 Finish final draft	Day 38 Change-up day	Day 39 Begin peer response Instruction Read short story	Day 40 Write body paragraph
Day 41 Teacher model of peer response	Day 42 Students trade papers Partner #1 peer response	Day 43 Students trade papers again Partner #2 peer response	Day 44 Begin revision Incorporate peer response suggestions into final draft	Day 45 Complete final draft of body paragraph



Jane's #9 Non-Negotiable: One-to-one Conferencing

As a department, we decided to institute this one-to-one conferencing as a standard teacher tool in all of our classes. Its impact surpassed our greatest expectations. Without one-to-one conferencing, we could not elicit the quality and quantity of thought that appear in our students' papers.

Description

One-to-one conferencing means seeing students individually either in or outside of class. We have developed two versions, one we call *Row Running (RR)* and another called *Table Talks (TT)*.

With Row Running (RR), the talk is public and informal. It deals with only one or two steps in the writing process, so it is quick, fewer than thirty seconds per student. As its name implies, the teacher is on his or her feet, walking up and down the rows, checking work all the while – not sitting at the teacher's desk but out keeping things moving. Desks must be arranged so that the teacher can move easily in and out without retracing steps. It can be a quick five seconds of praise or thirty seconds of direction, always positive. Good work is recognized, and those who need help are going to get it.

With Table Talks (TT), students come up to the teacher's desk or table for approximately two to five minutes to discuss a thornier, lengthier problem. The teacher can sit across from or next to the student. It is private and more intense than RR. We use a timer if we tend to run over. If the issue can't be addressed in two to five minutes, the student meets with us later or arranges a time before or after school. If it works better for the class, TT can be done quietly with the teacher sitting in a student desk to confer instead of up front. This is a good idea when some students might disrupt others just by walking up to our table.

There are two schools of thought regarding conferencing: in-class and outside of class. Our preference is in-class at specified checkpoints and other points that students request.

No student is allowed to ask, "Would you look at my paper?" That person wants us to catch every mistake so the paper receives the "A" that the writer feels it's entitled to.

Purpose

RR is for us to check for understanding at certain points in the process and re-teach as necessary. Sometimes we can do the re-teaching right there at the moment; sometimes we need to see the student for a longer period of time or at a TT. And sometimes, we notice that a problem applies to many students, so we re-teach the point to the entire class.

TT's are designed for a more relaxed conversation. Each student has our undivided attention for approximately two to five minutes. We also implement differentiated instruction here. Each student receives the individual help he or she needs.

Audience

For RR, we see all students' current work at their desks as we walk around.

For TT, we give ourselves two choices, voluntary or mandatory. Both approaches work. With younger students or less experienced writers, we tend to require TT; with older, more advanced students, we more often call for voluntary sign-ups.

All students must arrive with something written down to start. We don't allow blank papers with one exception: special education and English Language Learners (ELL) students who may need help just getting the first pre-writing words down on paper.

Frequency

We use RR to check every step of the process, from prompt to final draft, until we decide that students don't need as much monitoring. This means checking early and checking often; as long as we don't look at more than one or two points, RR goes quickly as it should. Once students have internalized the writing process, we check less frequently, but we never completely stop RR. We catch too many mistakes and re-direct students before the paper goes too far wrong. For example, a student may have not done the pre-writing pages as thoroughly as we want and may choose a weak concrete detail that isn't productive or is so closely related to another concrete detail that the commentary will be repetitive. The writing will be affected by this choice, so we return the student to revisit his/her pre-writing and do a more thoughtful job.

Every teacher has thought, "If I had caught this paper earlier, I could have stopped the problems I'm seeing now." To address that concern, we do TT with every major paragraph and essay assignment -- without fail. The most common first TT is the first draft, but you can do TT for earlier steps, depending on the class's needs. Students may come up for "second helpings" if you have time. Sometimes we limit a student to one or two conferences, regardless of how much time we have available, so that we aren't essentially writing the paper for him or her.

For RR, we can reach thirty-five to forty students in fifteen minutes. With TT, we need two days to see everyone once, but we have to move quickly and watch our time. Getting through a large class is challenging but feasible.

Record Keeping

For RR, students earn credit for completion, so we take a copy of our class list or the seating chart to record work and later transfer it to our computers.

For TT, the record-keeping is more complicated. We have a dated sign-in sheet up front for both mandatory and voluntary TT. At the end of the class period, we collect the sheet and save it for the current year and the next year for reference. It has helped us when parents question the student's grade and ask when or if we gave individual help. Students sign their own names.

Teachers may annotate the list as they wish with comments about the contents of the conference, but it isn't required.

Sample Questions We Ask in a Conference

Questions and comments can apply to anything we notice in the paper. Here is a representative sample:

- “You wrote the word *yearn* on your WOW page for *Of Mice and Men* but didn’t complete the page. What does it mean for people like George and Lennie to *yearn* for something?” Or the same question in different words: “When people like George and Lennie *yearn* for something, they.... – now complete the thought for me with some commentary ideas.”
- See video samples on our website of Deborah Louis providing TT. They are longer than the normal 2-5 minutes so that you will see the various questions asked of a student.

Scribing

For both RR and TT, *scribing* means writing down what a student says. It’s like taking dictation. We learned to do this when students were working so hard to think a thought that they didn’t remember what they said even thirty seconds before. Taking notes while students talk through their writing concerns solves this problem. We use student papers or 4x6 post-it pads or have students take their own notes. They are often surprised and pleased when they read what they said. When we show our notes to them, we often hear reactions such as “I said that? I sound smart!”

For TT, scribing can be done on a computer as the student talks. We can print our notes to be included with the final draft.

Classroom Management

For both RR and TT, we have never once had a class stay completely on task, and that applies to Pre-AP® and AP® classes as well. The teacher is not standing in front of the class, and students tend to misbehave. They know our attention is diverted. It’s like a toddler who knows that when his mother is on the phone, it’s time to turn on the water in the tub.

In order to address classroom management when providing TT, we always have a parallel assignment operating at the same time as conferences, based on the class’s needs and one that is subject to assessment at any moment. These assignments are nicknamed *autopilot*. Our job is to keep students engaged with an assignment that reinforces some aspect of the curriculum (i.e. writing, vocabulary work, or projects).

The concept and implementation of Blended Learning, however, has saved us. With student assignments delivered via online courses, digital content, and other technology applications, students seem to focus much better. If you have a 1:1 laptop program, create a webquest or have the students working on an online self-paced project while you are giving TT. If your department has a technology budget, request noise-canceling headphones for students to use as they work on the computer. The Silence will be Golden!

Even with blended learning and autopilot, though, we are no longer surprised that we sometimes still have to tell our students to get back to work. It’s the nature of the beast. We tend not to have parallel assignments for RR; students are working on their papers or waiting

briefly for us to get around, but sometimes we choose to create a short one for the minutes involved.

One Final Caveat and a General Observation

A warning: On conferencing days, we are more tired than we believed was possible. We are not one teacher with thirty-five students; we are thirty-five different teachers because we are giving each student something tailored to him or her. We don't recommend doing one-to-one conferencing more than twice a day until teachers gain a sense of their stamina doing it. Furthermore, your fatigue will affect your conferencing skills. Stagger your class table talks:

<i>Traditional Schedule: 45 – 55 minute periods*</i>	<i>A/B 90-minute Block Schedule*</i>
• Week 1: ○ Monday, Tuesday: Periods 1, 4 ○ Wednesday, Thursday: Periods 2, 5 ○ Friday – Second Helpings • Week 2: ○ Monday, Tuesday: Periods 3, 6 ○ Wednesday, Thursday: Period 7 ○ Friday – Second Helpings	• Week 1: ○ A Day: Blocks 1, 3 ○ B Day: Blocks 2, 4 ○ A Day: Blocks 1, 3 ○ B Day: Blocks 2, 4 • Week 2: ○ A Day: Blocks 5, 7 ○ B Day: Blocks 6, 8 ○ A Day: Blocks 5, 7 ○ B Day: Blocks 6, 8

*with more than one prep (which we all usually have), pair the same prep for each day.

One-to-one conferences also address a point mentioned earlier: talking is the missing link in writing. It allows students to say what's in their heads. Done consistently over a period of weeks and months, they learn to trust themselves and believe in their ability to think thoughts without our prompting them. Moreover, they start to hear you ask the same questions or provide the same comments, and they begin to assimilate those questions and comments as they write individually, and the TT's become shorter and more concise. We cannot express the total impact, both tangible and intangible, that your one-to-one teaching can have on a child's life.

See Chart #2 for our one-to-one student request.

Writing Workshop: A Helping Hand

I am writing my essay on _____
_____.

and I need advice on my

Students must choose one for today's conference:

Parts of an Essay

- ☐ Introduction
 - ☐ Thesis statement
- ☐ Body Paragraph # ____
 - ☐ Topic Sentence
 - ☐ Concrete Detail
 - ☐ Commentary
 - ☐ Concluding Sentence
- ☐ Conclusion

My specific question is

- ☐ How do I start? _____
- ☐ I seem to be repeating myself.
- ☐ I do not know how to say what I'm trying to say.
- ☐ I do not know how to _____
- ☐ I cannot tell the difference between concrete detail and commentary.
- ☐ What can I do to make this part sound more convincing?
- ☐ Is my writing logical in this paragraph based on my topic sentence?
- ☐ Can you see any no-no words in this section?
- ☐ I struggle with _____ . Would you check that in this section?

☐ Would you check one of these grammar components in this section?

☐ Punctuation ☐ Capitalization ☐ Agreement ☐ Spelling ☐ Possessive Case

☐ Would you check my syntax in this section?

☐ Sentence Beginnings Vary ☐ Sentence Types Vary ☐ A Sentence's Parallel Structure

☐ Literary Analysis Questions

☐ When do I use the word “speaker” and when do I use the word “author?”

☐ How do I quote lines from a poem?

☐ I am struggling with embedding quotations. Would you help me embed this particular quotation?

☐ Research Questions

☐ Parenthetical citations format

☐ Works Cited Question

☐ Narrative Questions

☐ I need help writing dialogue.

Jane's #10 Non-Negotiable: For each student we have multiyear, cumulative writing folders that we pass on to the next teacher each fall.

We can't say enough about writing folders. They have helped the writing lives for our students and for us in ways almost too numerous to describe. No one reads writing folders from beginning to end; that's not our purpose in keeping them.

Our five purposes are:

1. *Storage*
Students lose papers; teachers don't. We store the folders in a safe place in each teacher's classroom, often behind the teacher's desk or in file cabinets not easily accessible to students. They are immediately available for one of the other four purposes.
2. *Parent conferences*
We take them to every parent conference in case they are helpful in answering questions. One parent of a sophomore said that her son hadn't done any essays in ninth grade. We showed her the four essays that he had completed in freshman year (of the required six we had agreed on) and the two cover sheets that showed non-completion. Those papers answered any questions she might have had. The conversation was over. Without the writing folder, it would have been the "he said, she said" conversation with which we are familiar. We don't let "live" papers leave the folder because they have occasionally been lost in transit when the student took them home. We offer to photocopy the paper if the family would like a copy sent home.
3. *Student self-reflection*
Students do a self-analysis of their folders twice a year at the end of each semester. We've included the self-reflection form on our website. We don't need a lesson plan on these days. Students are ghoulishly curious about their earlier work and often say, "I can't believe how much I've learned!" It warms our hearts.
4. *Teacher reference*
If teachers want to look at previous papers, they can do so without delay. For example, if the current teacher is having difficulty teaching the introduction, she may skim last year's essays to glean ideas and see what the student wrote previously. Teachers can also contact last year's teacher listed on the cover sheet.
5. *Teacher accountability*
If the department has agreed on the number of paragraphs and essays to be done in a given year, they should all be in the writing folder. If they are not, we check to see what happened: Did the student transfer after ninth grade began? Did the teacher do all the required papers? This can sometimes lead to

an administrator entering the conversation to confirm that the teacher is adhering to department policies and, if not, help the teacher do so.

What Writing Folders Include and What They Don't

Writing folders (also called *portfolios*) show a student's writing life at our school. They contain all major process paragraphs and essays, all timed writings (on-demand papers), and any local assessments. We also add any papers we inherit from another school. We pass the folders on to the next teacher in the fall and give them to seniors before they graduate.

Our folders are a collection, not a selection. If students are allowed to select which papers to delete, they will often omit a paper that teachers wish were there later on. If it's a lower grade that been deleted, teachers don't have a comparison to show how far the student has come. One folder has been large enough to serve students well during four years of high school, even with each process paper including all the steps that students have completed.

Small assignments like vocabulary quizzes and quickwrites aren't included. We call this group of work *Small Stuff*.

We tend to receive 1/3 of the writing folders from our feeder schools, which we read and either return them to their owners or file the contents into their high school folders. To ignore what students have written before high school strikes us as rude and disrespectful to our colleagues and students alike. We can learn what kinds of assignments they did and what grades they earned.

- We provide the student name labels, printed by our registrar. Students don't label their own. Too often, they do it incorrectly, giving their first names first or writing illegibly.
- We use multi-colored file folders, a different color for each year. It's worth the money.
- Some schools pre-print folders with an index or a table of contents by grade level.

End of Semester and Year

- Students do a self-analysis of their folders twice a year at the end of each semester. We've included the self-reflection form on our website.
- We don't give students their folders to review over the summer. It's a good and worthy idea, but it hasn't worked. Some students will scrutinize every comma, but they are rarely the ones who need to, and the ones who should, don't. In the fall, in addition, many forget to return with their folders in the fall and have to be reminded more than once.

Moving Them to the Next Teacher (Pass-Along Folders)

Overview. We use three approaches to moving the folders to the next teacher. Folder Swap #1 and #2 to transfer the folders to the next teacher. The previous June, teachers arrange

their folders in boxes alphabetically by period or by a compilation of all of their students, whichever is easier for them.

E-Portfolios. These days, some schools have purchased enough bandwidth to house their students' portfolios electronically. Students upload their final drafts into their personal folders: a .pdf of the final draft with the teacher's comments and the final score (secured); and corrections of the final draft in Word (especially narratives for accumulating college essay topics).

Hard-Copy Portfolios: Two Options

- *Folder Swap #1.* In the fall on a given Wednesday (the highest attendance day of the week for both students and teachers), students go to the last year's English teacher, collect their folders, and return to class. This takes about ten minutes per period. We have learned to alert administration so they know that these students are not out of class without permission at the beginning of each period.

For teachers who are no longer with the school or out on leave, we assign their boxes to another teacher and tell students. For example, we say, "If you had Mrs. Schaffer last year, she's on leave. Mrs. Smith has her folders in room E-1."

The unclaimed folders are sent then to the department chair who groups them by year and stores them until the year after those students would have graduated. If we know where the student has transferred, we contact the new school about sending the folder on.

- *Folder Swap #2.* Some schools use Folder Swap #2 to monitor students more easily during the folder pick-up. They take all the boxes identified on the outside by teacher to a central location like an unused classroom or a spare storage room. Each class goes there with its teacher to retrieve their folders. Departments organize a schedule and accomplish the job over a week or two. This method is less chaotic for some schools.

Our goal is to have the folders re-distributed within six weeks from the beginning of school, but that is up to each site to decide what is most workable. Schools with little transiency can disseminate the folders earlier; schools with higher transiency rates usually need to wait a bit for class lists to settle down.

COVER SHEET PARAGRAPHS AND ESSAYS

NAME: _____

DATE: _____

FORMAT: ☐ **PROCESS PAPER (2 or more drafts)**
☐ **TIMED WRITING**
☐ **ONE-CHUNK PARAGRAPH**
☐ **TWO-CHUNK PARAGRAPH**

PROMPT: _____

CLASS/LEVEL: _____

TEACHER: _____

**IF YOU DID NOT DO THIS ASSIGNMENT, COMPLETE
THIS SECTION AND SIGN BELOW:**

I did not do this assignment because

SIGNED: _____

_____ **SCHOOL**

Essay Cover Sheet

Grade Level: **6** **7** **8** **9** **10** **11** **12**

NAME _____

DUE DATE: _____

FORMAT: (Circle one.)

PROCESS PAPER

TIMED WRITING

_____ minutes

ESSAY TOPIC: _____

ESSAY CHOICE: (if applicable) _____

MODE: _____

MY ORIGINAL TITLE: _____

(underlined or quotation marks?)

CLASS / PERIOD: _____

TEACHER:

M _____

=====

THIS STUDENT TURNED IN THE ESSAY LATE.

DATE TURNED IN: _____

LATE POLICY: (1st day, minus ____; 2nd day, minus ____; 3rd day, minus ____)
(reserved for teacher)

_____ **THIS STUDENT CHOSE NOT TO DO THE ESSAY.**

(Student Signature)

REASON: _____

REFLECTION SHEET

This page is due with your corrections. Attach it to the back of your paragraph/essay packet.

1. What is the most important skill you learned by doing this assignment?

2. What did you enjoy about this assignment?

3. What did you find most difficult about this assignment?

4. Finish one of the following 3 sentence starters:
 - a. I now know that . . .

 - b. I never knew that . . .

 - c. I realize that . . .

- 1) ... Manuel must face the unexpected, and both, ...
- 2) During his vacation at the seashore, ...
- 3) ... he sees that he cannot perform the same ...
- 4) ... leaving his mother because although the adventure's exciting, and he enjoys to go off and explore it's also scary ...
- 5) ~~he~~ makes him feel secure.
- 6) ... and they all had each other but, ...
- 7) it was as though he had no one because he wasn't used to being on his own, and with strangers

Stone 1

Ms. Schaffer
English 1C
24 October 2000

People often take risks because they feel the need to prove themselves to others. They accomplish their goals and meet challenges before them. In "Through the Tunnel" and "The Confrontation," both Jerry and Manuel must face the unexpected and both emerge victorious.

During his vacation at the seashore, Jerry challenges himself to achieve a difficult goal and matures as a result of his accomplishment. For example, when he goes by himself to the rocks near the beach, he sees that he cannot perform the same diving feats as the older boys (34). He feels a bit unsure about leaving his mother because although it's exciting to go off and explore, it is also scary to be away from the only person who makes him feel secure. He is lonely and out of place with the English boys because he is different, and they all had each other, but without his mother it was as though he had no one. In addition, after he practices holding his breath and puts on his goggles, he finds a way through the tunnel and emerges on the other

- 8) He can ~~stay~~ stay under the water just as long as the other boys do
- 9) and that when he is on his own he can be just as successful as he was...
- 10) as successful as he was with his mother ~~and~~
- 11) He doesn't want to...
- 12) He doesn't want to rely on her anymore, because he's growing up.
- 13) He is focused on being on his own and finding...
- 14) ... finding out what is...
- 15) ... finding out what is...
- 16) what is in the ocean that...
- 17) that when he finishes, he feels...
- 18) feels a sense of achievement that he...
- 19) a sense of achievement that he...
- 20) a young, independent man who knows...
- 21) for example, during...
- 22) about no one but himself and his...
- 23) his own well-being
- 24) and therefore he can...
- 25) when the others realize what...
- 26) Manuel's rebellion and are willing to back him up as their leader.
- 27) he is the intimidating boss since no...

Side (39). He can do what the other boys did ⁸ and that on his own he can be just as ¹⁰ powerful as he was with his mother. ¹² This is ¹¹ important because he doesn't want to feel ¹² dependent ¹³ anymore. He is ¹⁴ focused on being on his own ¹⁵ and finding out what ¹⁶ is in the ocean that when ¹⁷ he finishes, he feels a sense of achievement ¹⁸ that he has so greatly desired. Jerry became a ¹⁹ young, independent man ²⁰ who knows if he ²¹ tries hard enough he can do anything.

In "The Confrontation," Roberto, the crew chief, tries to make the men feel inferior and worthless, but Manuel and the others defend their honor and integrity in the face of humiliation and embarrassment. For example, during the afternoon break, Roberto says that he wants two cents from every bucket (479). ²² Roberto is a greedy, power-hungry man who ²³ cares about no one but himself ²⁴ and his own well-being. He feels ²⁵ that though he is above the workers, and there ²⁶ for he can treat them without respect. In addition, when the ²⁷ men realize what Roberto wants, Manuel kicks over his bucket of apricots and the other pickers stand over their own pails of fruit (479). ²⁸ All the men agree with Manuel's rebellion ²⁹ and are willing to back him up like he was ³⁰ their leader. They are all under Roberto's control because they are the lower class, the workers, and he is the intimidating boss ³¹ and since no ³²

- 29.) now that someone has, ^{they} appreciate it.
- 30.) The men defeat the self-centered
- 31.) The men defeat the self-centered
- 32.) self-centered enemy and gain
- 33.) self-centered enemy and gain what
- 34.) what the deserved
- 35.) deserved, along with

one has been able to stand up to him before,
 now that someone has, ²⁹they appreciate it. The ³³men
 defeated ³⁰the self-centered enemy ³²and gained ³⁵
 what they ³⁴truly deserved, ³⁵along with a great
 sense of pride.

In both stories, the characters willingly
 accept the tasks before them. - Despite the odds
 they have conquered their adversaries and
 gained the respect of others. In the end, they
 have put their fears to rest.

Works Cited

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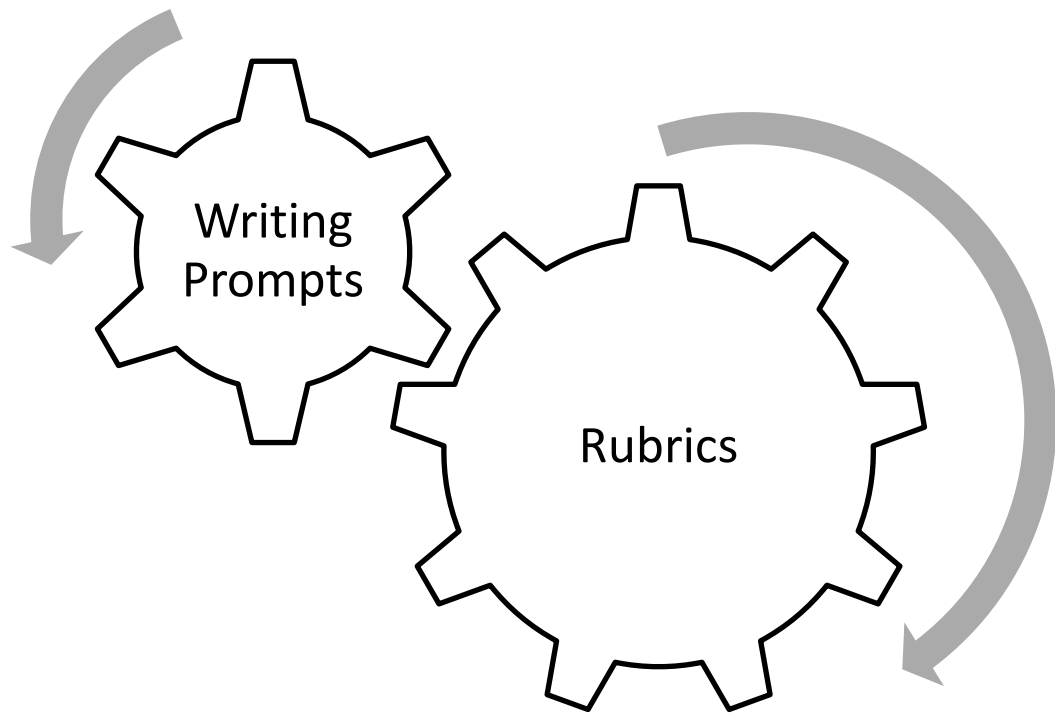
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PROMPT CONSTRUCTION

1. **Features of good prompts:**
 - a. written as statements, not questions.
 - b. quantifies the assignment (length and ratio)
 - c. uses a verb that fits your subject and the assignment (e.g., *discusses, comments on, explores, analyzes, interprets, evaluates, investigates, describes, explains, states, defines, summarizes*)
 - d. narrows the focus of the topic
2. **Model:** Write a one-chunk paragraph (1:2+) that discusses how Friar Laurence feels in the first half of the play.
4. **How to Test Your Prompts**
 - a. Do the T-chart.
 - b. Do a little more (webbing, first draft) if you think you need to.
5. **Sample prompts to discuss:**
 - a. Write an essay that analyzes bullying.
 - b. Science: Write a one-chunk 2+:1 paragraph that describes the process of natural selection and connect/apply it to real life.
 - c. Write a compare-contrast essay in which you explore the similarities and differences between two subjects of your choice.
 - d. Discuss the causes of the Civil War.
 - e. Write a one-chunk paragraph comparing and contrasting parallel and perpendicular lines.
 - f. Analyze the significance of the story of the Garden of Eden.

PROMPT WRITING PRACTICE

1. **Features of good prompts:**
 - a. written as statements, not questions.
 - b. quantifies the assignment (length and ratio)
 - c. uses a verb that fits your subject and the assignment (e.g., *discusses, comments on, explores, analyzes, interprets, evaluates, investigates, describes, explains, states, defines, summarizes*)
 - d. narrows the focus of the topic

2. Write a _____ that _____

_____.

3. Write a _____ that _____

_____.

4. Write a _____ that _____

_____.

TEACHING THE MULTIPARAGRAPH ESSAY

ESSAY SCORING GUIDE

A Excellent

- ❑ Excellent concrete detail; correct and skillful use of transitions and lead- ins
- ❑ Insightful commentary
- ❑ Finds connections
- ❑ Organization is clear and logical
- ❑ Very few, if any, mechanical errors
- ❑ Powerful vocabulary
- ❑ Excellent sentence variety
- ❑ Repeats little or not at all

B Good

- ❑ Good concrete detail; correct use of transitions and lead- ins.
- ❑ Good commentary but less so than an "A"
- ❑ Organization is clear but not as skillfully done as the "A" papers
- ❑ Some mechanical errors may be present, more than the "A" papers
- ❑ Good vocabulary
- ❑ Above- average sentence variety
- ❑ Repeats more than the "A" paper but less than the "C" paper

C Adequate

- ❑ Follows format (ratio; word counts; sentence layout, if required)
- ❑ Acceptable CD; generic CD
- ❑ Obvious, superficial, irrelevant, or generic commentary (GC)
- ❑ Organization is present but less skillfully done than the "B" papers
- ❑ Some mechanical errors present , more than a B paper
- ❑ Average vocabulary or odd word choice
- ❑ Limited sentence variety
- ❑ Repeats are a problem

D Demonstrates Problems

- ❑ Too many mechanical errors (run- ons, fragments, spelling, contractions, apostrophes)
- ❑ Did not copy correctly from the story or the board
- ❑ Uses past tense instead of literary present tense (LP)
- ❑ Does not follow the format (ratio; word counts; sentence layout)
- ❑ CD problems: weak CD (WCD); factual errors; problems with MLA citation format; problems with TLCD; no lead- in; weak lead- in.
- ❑ CM problems: weak CM (WCM); not commentary (NCM); mainly plot summary or restatement of CD; CM doesn't fit the CD, generic CM.
- ❑ Chunk doesn't fit TS (not coherent).
- ❑ Filler
- ❑ Organization is unclear.
- ❑ Simple vocabulary and word choice (WC), odd word choice; slang (SL); wrong word (WW); odd phrasing
- ❑ Little sentence variety
- ❑ Repeats are a bigger problem than with the "C" paper
- ❑ Uses no- no words, including *you, your, yours, would, should, could, may, might; I, me, my* in a literature paper

F Fails to meet standards

JANE SCHAFER WRITING PROGRAM™ SCORING GUIDE WITH 6 TRAITS

Ideas and Content

A B C D F

- Thesis/topic sentences contain commentary words
- Appropriate and significant concrete detail
- Insightful commentary that finds connections between characters, events, themes, or global perspectives
- Follows format as appropriate (ratio, sentence layout, word counts, chunking)
- Ideas are fully developed

Organization

A B C D F

- Transitions and lead-ins used skillfully
- Sequencing of ideas clear, logical, and effective
- Pacing and overall effect and smooth and balanced
- Sustained focus to each paragraph and essay as a whole
- Composition has a sense of completeness
- Intro and conclusion are meaningful and add depth to the composition
- Writer's progression of thought from sentence to sentence and paragraph to paragraph is smooth and controlled
- Logical movement from idea to idea
- Organization enhances the writer's ability to present ideas clearly and effectively

Voice

A B C D F

- Individual, expressive, and engaging concrete detail and commentary
- Appropriate for audience and purpose
- Authentic and original sound to the paper
- Shows writer's individuality or unique perspective
- Writer engages the reader

Word Choice**A B C D F**

- **Powerful, accurate, specific vocabulary**
- **Academic language as appropriate**
- **Few repeats**
- **Word choice enhances the overall effectiveness of the communication of ideas**

Sentence Fluency**A B C D F**

- **Strong, concise sentences that are smooth and fluid**
- **Sentences vary in length and structure**
- **Easy to read aloud**
- **Sentences enhance the overall effectiveness of the communication of ideas**

Conventions**A B C D F**

- **Overall strength of the conventions contributes to the effectiveness of the composition**
- **Few/no weak words: thing, something, anything, everything, nothing, you**
- **No speculative words in a literature paper (would, could, should, may, might, if, then)**
- **No personal pronouns in body paragraphs in a literature paper (I, me, my, we, us, our, ours, mine)**
- **Text looks clean, edited, and polished**

Name _____ Date _____

Essay Topic _____

#	Description of Mistake	# of times in this paper
1	awkward, choppy	
2	cliché, vocabulary	
3	fragment	
4	no-no words (would, should, could, may, if, you, your, I, me, my, we, us, our, ours)	
5	problems with concrete detail	
6	problems with commentary	
7	punctuation	
8	run-on sentence	
9	verb tense	
10	subject-verb agreement	
11	word choice	
12	repeats	
○	spelling	

Grade _____

Name: _____

Date: _____

Paragraph Topic: _____

	DESCRIPTION OF MISTAKE / BEGINNING RUBRIC	NUMBER OF TIMES IN THIS PAPER
1 .	Huh? Didn't understand (no comprendo, nie ponemaesh)	
2 .	Indenting	
3 .	Not a commentary	
4 .	Not a concrete detail	
5 .	Needs concrete details/more specifics/more information	
6 .	Problems with concrete detail Pronoun Problem (he, she, it, they, them, us, we)	
7 .	Punctuation (. ! ' ; ")	
8 .	Repeat word(s) repeated or idea(s) repeated	
9 .	Spelling (spelling/contractions/abbreviations/spell out numbers 1-100)	
10 .	Subject-verb agreement	
11 .	Verb tense (past, present, future)	
12 .	Incomplete paragraph	
13 .	Problems with thesis or no thesis	
TOTAL NUMBER OF ERRORS IN THIS PAPER:		

Name: _____

Date: _____

Essay Topic: _____

	DESCRIPTION OF MISTAKE / INTERMEDIATE RUBRIC	NUMBER OF TIMES IN THIS PAPER
1 .	Awkward/choppy/unclear/words omitted	
2 .	Filler/strays from the topic	
3 .	Problems with thesis or no thesis	
4 .	Huh? Didn't understand	
5 .	MLA problems (citation heading) title page/indenting/margins format	
6 .	No-no words (would, should, could, might, if, you, your, yours, I, me, my, we, us, our, ours in literature papers)	
7 .	Not a commentary	
8 .	Not a concrete detail	
9 .	Needs to relate to concrete detail/more specifics/more information	
10 .	Problems with concrete detail	
11 .	Pronoun antecedent (problem - he, she, it, they, them, us, we)	
12 .	Punctuation (. ! ' : ; ")	
13 .	Repeat word(s) repeated or idea(s) repeated	
14 .	Run-on sentence	
15 .	Spelling (sp/cap/contr/abb/apost)/conventions/spell out numbers	
16 .	Subject-verb agreement	
17 .	Verb tense (past, present, and future tenses)	
18 .	Word choice	
19 .	Wordy	
20 .	Wrong word	
21 .	Incomplete paragraph/essay/did not follow guidelines	
22 .	Did not address the prompt/summary	
TOTAL NUMBER OF ERRORS IN THIS PAPER:		

Name: _____

Date: _____

Essay Topic: _____

	DESCRIPTION OF MISTAKE / INTERMEDIATE RUBRIC	NUMBER OF TIMES IN THIS PAPER
1 .	Awkward/choppy/unclear/words omitted	
2 .	Cliché/trite vocabulary/dead words/slang	
3 .	Filler/strays from the topic	
4 .	Fragment	
5 .	Problems with thesis or no thesis	
6 .	Huh? Didn't understand	
7 .	Sentence fluency	
8 .	MLA problems (citation heading) title page/indenting/margins	
9 .	No-no words (would, should, could, might, if, you, your, yours, I, me, my, we, us, our, ours in literature papers)	
10 .	Not a commentary	
11 .	Not a concrete detail	
12 .	Parallel structure	
13 .	Passive voice	
14 .	Needs to relate to concrete detail/more specifics/more	
15 .	Problems with concrete detail	
16 .	Pronoun antecedent	
17 .	Punctuation	
18 .	Repeats	
19 .	Run-on sentence	
20 .	Spelling (sp/cap/contr/abb/apost)/conventions/spell out numbers	
21 .	Subject-verb agreement	
22 .	Transition language to concrete detail	
23 .	Verb tense	
24 .	Word choice	
25 .	Wordy	
26 .	Wrong word	
27 .	Introduction: anecdote, dialogue, or starting information	
28 .	Ending (new information, too long, "zinger," missing)	
29 .	Incomplete paragraph/essay/did not follow guidelines	
30 .	Did not address the prompt/summary	
TOTAL NUMBER OF ERRORS IN THIS PAPER:		